

2EQ - STAGE ONE
'THE EASY BOOK'
(ROUGH DRAFT FOR EDIT)

PREFACE

The subject of this work is a profound secret, and yet all grounded in something remarkably mundane in essence. It is also something that is, in a very real sense, standing right in front of us - which is obviously pretty strange for something so secret.

It all asks many questions once you do finally see it, but none more important than why you didn't see it beforehand. It asks questions about how it could possibly have been so concealed, and also about how it could be emerging now. It asks questions about my own qualifications in this context, and how I could - as a complete nobody - possibly know all of this. It has huge implications and ramifications in many areas of life, both in theory and in practice, and solves thousands of longstanding philosophical conundrums. And yet, none of that will be addressed here.

All we will be doing here is merely capturing the thing itself, and even then only in very brief outlines. We will, however, be doing what we can to extract the broadest weight of the thing at least, and to see what it all might mean, which is a lot. So we will need to get enough to do this, but no more.

The gravity of the whole potential it points to in practical terms, along with just the pure philosophical dominos it kicks off, are simply so far outside the boundaries of what most people expect that for the most part they won't be able to see them at first. It is just too big, too vast, and too heavy. And this will lead some to imagine that it is some kind of ultimate answer to some kind of ultimate question - but this is very far from being the case. It does not even touch upon any of the deeper or more universal questions about life in general, and does not require such in order to deliver its essential payload. It does not say what life is, or why we are here. And it does not draw upon mysticism of any kind in the way it penetrates to the core of human life.

It is simply and only a description of a problem, and in particular a problem that would otherwise remain completely hidden. This problem merely happens to be the root of most human suffering, and also - if you can look - represents the potential solution to all of that.

For my own part there is no authority required in order to lay all of this out. It is simply a description of something hidden beneath the surface of our lives, so if that thing isn't actually there, then when you look, nothing will be found. Conversely, if there really is something there, then no amount of moral heft at my end will be required to convince you of that - you will simply see it for yourself. I have no more access to that than you do, since it is all going on within you right now.

This looking part will be the key at your end. And this explains where it has all been hidden, but also what exposing it will require. It is, unavoidably, a journey into the very darkest of all human realities, and also - by the time we reach the next stage in - immensely complex in its dynamic equilibrium. But at this stage, as we seek to merely point in the general direction so to speak, it hopefully won't be too unwieldy, or difficult to grasp.

It will offer you no real power in this form, and at this level. This is sort of the point, as you will see. The aim will be to provide you with just enough to allow you to decide if you want to take the deeper journey associated, and actually meet the dragon. That will be a far more demanding path. But at this stage we will only be pointing out the cave where it lives.

INTRODUCTION

Look around. Is this honestly what you expected to find here? If it is, then this work is not for you, because in that case you have forgotten. And if you forgot, then it was because you gave up. And if you gave up, then you were defeated - and this work is simply not for the defeated.

This is going to seem like a pretty harsh place to begin here, but it is also a very important thing to understand. What we see emerging here will ultimately touch everyone, everywhere, but that will only be in its more mature and developed form. In the first instance it is most definitely not for everyone.

So imagine you are currently standing in a crowd, and that you are then instructed to split yourself into two groups. Everyone type A go and stand over here, and all those who think they might be type B please move over this way, etc.

What are these two groups, then?

There are those who are convinced that this is it, this is all we get, and that we might as well make the most of it. They are essentially happy with what they see around them, or at least resigned to things being the way they are. And as far as what's going on within them, these people generally don't even look. If it ain't broke, don't fix it, as they say. And these people are adamantly convinced they ain't broke.

Then there are those who do not believe any of this, who are just as convinced that there is definitely something not quite right about their own internal reality - that somehow there has to be something more, that there is something else to be had, and that what we see now is merely some pale and distorted version of that natural birthright. And right here we see a dividing line between two types of people.

Needless to say, this work is for the latter group, who currently live in a world dominated by the former group. It is, to be sure, addressing only a small minority of people, and there need be no apology for this. Indeed, this is a very important aspect of what you will find here, and addressing it here - right at the start - is important because the chances that you are in this minority are slim. But you can assess this for yourself in due course.

In light of which we might also ask you this: Is there a problem?

Are we going up, or are we going down? Are things screwed up, or are they basically okay? Is this the world you expected to find here, or did you expect something different?

For the most part you probably act as if everything is okay. But is it, really? I mean look around, or maybe just look in the mirror. In almost every direction we see two opposing views, two opposing realities in conflicted struggle as they each vie for attention or dominance.

In the Lego Movie we saw this great divide lampooned in the 'everything is awesome' anthem at the beginning, with the rest of the movie exploring the far more complicated and accurate reality that actually maybe everything is not quite as awesome as we might like to think.

It is a question that can be explored at many levels, and in a great many senses - all the way from the mundane to the sublime. We see it in the individual, and in the collective. On the one hand we see a

continual barrage of hopeful breakthroughs and courageous voices, and yet on the other hand the blind momentum of collective change appears to again and again bulldoze right over the top of our best intentions. Regardless of how much we might resist, we continue to gradually slide backwards. And the same is true of our individual lives - again and again we will embark on some process of positive personal change, only to be mysteriously swayed and diverted down yet another detour that often ends up as bad as the one before, or even worse.

Even here you will probably be experiencing this positive pushback at an emotional level, in response to even bringing this subject up: "Well, it's not that bad".. I hear you saying. But actually, it is. It's just that our cultural narrative does not actually fit the reality of our true collective circumstance, and yet we still embrace it openly as if it does. It is bewildering, and in the face of this mysterious and confusing situation we see an even louder need to cry out 'everything is awesome!', or "I'm okay! I'm okay! I'm okay!" etc. But if only we really were okay at an individual level, and if only we weren't hurtling headlong toward some sort of inevitable collapse as a global society.

Anyway, the result of this is a kind of dissonance between these two basic ideas - both within ourselves and in the world as a whole. From the comedian who makes everyone laugh, then goes home and kills himself - to little Gretta standing up to interrupt the myopic selfish hedonism of Glastonbury with a rant about personal responsibility - there is a big gap between the way we wish things were, and the way things really are. There is a rift between how things appear on the surface, and how they actually are at a deeper level. And in particular there is a very deep rift between the sunny persona most people uphold and the much darker inner realities they are actually dealing with.

So which view is correct? What is the actual situation? Is fictional whitewashing better than non-fictional doom and gloom?

It is a perennial argument. On the one hand we see a general characterisation of the schizoid character as being one that essentially fails to maintain at least some sense of humour about life, that takes it all a little too seriously, and fails to adapt to things as they are (See: Ernest Becker - The Denial of Death).

Just take a chill pill, etc. Relax! This is the message of the smug cheshire cats of this world. It is a condescending view, a conceited view even, especially considering the grim realities of life for most people - both individually and collectively. But for some people such inattentive blindness and personal compromise actually works. Ignorance really can be bliss if you can maintain it, and especially if reality never manages to catch up to you. For such people life as a whole becomes a gated compound - both inwardly and outwardly.

On the other hand, then, we see a searing condemnation of such apathetic blinkering and moral bankruptcy, a kind of 'how dare you look away' battle cry from all those who take the opposing view. In this view the problem is so incredibly obvious and urgent that relaxing even for a moment can be difficult for those who look, but no matter how loudly spoken they might be, such voices generally end up sinking like a stone in the face of collective inertia and avoidance. And this is especially complicated by the fact that those who do take this more sober and honest view of this often struggle to really define exactly what the real problem actually is - even though they are sure there is one, and that it is definitely big. But this failure to really pin it down in any kind of comprehensive way leaves them forever without any real traction, so all they do is noisily spin their wheels and make a lot of smoke. And yet - could they be right, even if they haven't quite fathomed the true root of the issue?

I suppose what follows will be an attempt to roughly sketch out this missing piece, and in many ways to validate this basic intuition. There really is a problem, a big one, but it's also not quite what people imagine.

In any case, our entire culture is split in this regard. At one moment, on Instagram, you will see bikini sunsets and tropical cocktails on white sandy beaches - and then, as you glance up from your phone to the TV, you will see bombed out buildings and starving children. On the one hand we are reaching for the stars, and at the same time going down the toilet.

So which is it? And which one is going to win? I mean, for all the bold talk and bravado, it certainly appears that things are getting a lot worse, rather than a lot better.

For all our frantic efforts, nothing much ever seems to fundamentally change. Even the fact that life is so much better for the few who might be able to afford such luxury is not necessarily a positive situation, even for them, as such profound dislocation from collective reality causes both moral blindness as well as very deeply conditioned weakness. The power to do 'something good' far more often expresses itself as the power to simply 'look away' instead. The tacit agreement of these privileged few is to never speak of the fact that their lives only exist at the expense of the many. And I mean, I would know, after all I live in New Zealand - where merely earning the average wage puts me well inside the top 1% of global earners.

In many ways this simple question captures the central issue of our age, or perhaps even all ages. And even if we do manage to accept that we have a problem, we almost never agree on what that might actually be.

At the political level we see the right and the left, progressive and conservative, which in the end boil down to little more than wanting things to stay the same vs wanting them to change. Hence one view sees a problem to be solved, while the other sees things as fine as they are, and that the only thing screwing everything up is this subversive desire to change it all. Of course, it is always those who already have everything who want things to stay the same, and those who have nothing who want them to change.

But once again this is simply the same elementary struggle being expressed in a different arena. There is always the very strong assertion that everything is okay, and it is always being asserted in a context where the underlying reality is very strongly indicating otherwise.

Even if you take it all up to a far more ultimate level, you see this same question being asked in every spiritual approach throughout history. At one end we see all the claims that 'everything is one-ness' or that 'atman is brahman' etc, or that we are 'already there' in some sense. "This very world, the lotus land - paradise" as Buddha said.

But then you look around, or even just breathe for a moment and feel what you are really feeling, and this view suddenly seems like madness. So on the other hand, we see the whole idea of Samsara, from the very same source. In Christianity we see the concept of 'the fall', as contrasted with the permanent and eternal redemptive singularity of salvation.

Even the very fact that religions exist in the first place seems to represent that there is - for many people - some fundamental problem in life that needs to be solved. For others, religions are themselves the problem, which really only reaches the same conclusion in reverse. But once again even this view, the totally broken and hopeless perspective, is equally hard to uphold sometimes, in

the face of even just the simplicity of a sunset, not to mention the eyes of a newborn child. Sometimes it seems just so incredibly certain that everything is fundamentally okay somehow, and always will be.

Anyway, we could go on. We could delve into all the various depths and expressions of this fundamental struggle regarding life and its bedrock reality, but in the end there is really only one final context that matters. In practical terms it all boils down to a single fork in the road.

The great question all of this asks is this:

Is all that we see now fundamentally okay? Or does it need to be fixed somehow, before we can move forward normally? And if so, what exactly is the problem, and can it even be fixed?

Is this it? Are we already here? Can we just relax, and enjoy? Or is there something else?

Basically -

Act first? Or party first?

Should we try to adapt to what we see? Or should we try to change it - and if so, how?

Once again: Is there a problem? Culture is all chewing this same essential bone.

So which is it? Is everything fundamentally okay, or is the bedrock essentially broken?

It can't be both, right?

My purpose here is simply to direct your gaze toward this deepest of questions in life. Why? Because what you see below completely answers this question. And not just philosophically - that would be easy. I mean practically speaking.

There really is a problem, a huge one, far worse than you might ever have imagined. And this outline not only identifies that issue in all its dynamic anatomy, but also provides direct and applicable insights in relation to how to reliably solve it.

Which one? I hear you ask. Which of the issues mentioned above is rooted in this so-called 'problem' we will be dragging out into the light here? After all, surely they can't all be the same problem, can they?

Sure they can, as you will see. That would actually make perfect sense, and also explain why all of those issues appear to be equally resistant to change.

All of our deepest and most resistant and mysterious afflictions are actually rooted in the exact same underlying struggle. The entire thing is a singular dynamic event, with all of those examples merely being different ways it can be expressed. And, likewise, the proposed solution to all of those afflictions turns out to be the same. Which means that you could potentially take them all out in a single sweeping stroke.

A big claim? Sure. I get it. How hard can it be, right? There must be some catch? And yes, there is. The catch is that in order to solve a problem, you must first of all accept that you have a problem, and for many people this is simply out of the question. The whole idea goes against the "I'm totally

awesome” mantra that most people are so blindly (and loudly) chanting. And here we see our first great audience elimination event. Humility is a requirement.

The core shift in perspective here is actually incredibly simple in essence, but also staggeringly dramatic in its ramifications. It all comes from a direction nobody would ever have imagined possible. It is very ‘close to home’ as they say - so incredibly close that it is hard to see at first.

It also appears to be an extremely negative view, at first anyway. But this is a profound misreading of what is being said here, and fails to get the point of it all. It is not negative at all to imagine we might be afflicted with some massively complex and incredibly damaging dynamic internal conflict - not if that entire thing has been completely concealed, and not if it can be completely removed. In that case the worse it is, the better, right? But yes, it is a lot to take in, even for me, and I have been looking at it for decades. This does not make it negative however, quite the contrary. The moment you realise that unawareness was its only power over us - and that the courage to look is itself the turning of that tide - then suddenly the entire aversion associated begins to spontaneously invert.

The anatomy is key, like knowing the locking mechanism for a safe you are trying to crack. Without that you are basically screwed, and in this context that information is not available anywhere. We will see why.

It is extremely dark, emotionally speaking. This is a key thing here. This is one of the extreme polarities you will encounter - the harrowing side of it. There is a radical negative polarity in this instance, we are caught in a fabulous trap. I would be tempted to call its detailed anatomy beautiful if its consequences weren't causing so much of the pain and struggle we see in life, not to mention also destroying the planet.

It really is very distressing. And in case it is not already obvious to you, your focus of attention is almost completely directed by constant emotional feedback. So to look at something this dark, especially to look deeply in any social context, will always be like swimming upstream in a powerful river full of people who are all floating downstream.

Which is precisely where all of this has been hidden. We have a blind spot, a big one, and right in the middle of that blind spot we find the reason for the blind spot. But we only find that if we have the courage to look.

It is, unavoidably, an inward journey. But this does not mean that we need to immediately abandon all reason in favour of a few chants and a bit of deep breathing. It is true that we will be plumbing internal depths here that will seem far beyond the reach of anything empirical or scientifically grounded, but that does not make them spiritual, and it also does not mean science cannot fathom such dimensions of experience in a direct and meaningful way.

This is what we will be seeking to demonstrate here: not only that a broadly rational and empirical approach can do this, but that it can certainly do a lot better job than all the woolly-headed fairytale bullshit that currently grows in all the ground that hard nosed science currently insists on leaving untended. Science will simply need to adapt, that's all, and scientists along with it.

I mean, I think you will agree that the foundations we lay down below - in relation to the basic mechanics of our own internal functioning - are not exactly glamorous, or very spiritual. Indeed, they are so basic that they are more like engineering than biology. And the dynamic models required in order to articulate the full complexity of what's going on will likewise probably fit best in the maths department, if not in computer science.

I am also fully aware that in using this sort of language I will immediately be losing all the scientists on the one side, and equally offending all the spiritualists on the other, but that's okay. This emerging field is certainly not for everyone, as we shall see. I will do my best to offend everyone equally by the time we are done - all in the spirit of fairness.

Let's be clear, however: science is going to win here. But perhaps not science as we presently know it. The fact is that science has a lot to answer for in this regard. And scientists in particular, for their timid avoidance of all subjective aspects of human experience. It used to be that natural science was a brave and daring adventure undertaken by true mavericks, but the apparent absence of new frontiers has left in its wake a kind of cloistered conformity that spends a lot more time and energy chasing funding than any sort of fundamental breakthroughs. But there really is one more big wilderness to explore here, and scientists haven't even touched it.

But you can't even begin to talk about this particular subject matter until you have at least a certain basic grasp of what is being proposed, and that requires a certain minimum capture. And even gaining that much, given the nature and implications associated, also requires consent. We will see why. There are some things you simply can't unsee. So it is a delicate balance.

In any case that will be the aim here in this work - what I have tended to call The Easy Book - to give you a full enough outline of the basic anatomy of the events in question, but also not so much that you see it all in the actual terms required. Just a sort of cartoon rendering of the whole thing, rather than the high resolution satellite image required in order to really be able to talk about it for real. That will be the task at the next stage up, as we get into editing what might likewise be called The Hard Book.

In any case, we have a lot of cleaning up to do in order to begin teasing apart the truth from the lies here, and for that we are going to need to go all the way back to the beginning, as well as do that in a way that entirely fits with everything we know for sure about the way things actually work in the real world, and therefore in a way that fits with the single greatest demystification science has ever gifted us with.

Which is to say - Evolution.

Part One - The Foundation

At first the outlines we will begin sketching below will seem so incredibly basic that explaining them is completely pointless, but as you will see we are actually suffering from the downstream effects of a very simple upstream cause. So we need to go right back to the most elementary principles here if we are going to root this thing out once and for all.

Where to begin, then, with any understanding of the deeper patterns and structures that govern our behaviour and subjective experience of human life? I suppose there is no better place than this: What is actually going on is nothing like what most people think is going on. And to get to the bottom of it all we will need to go right back to the roots of our historical context so as to at least be able to see the elementary basis of all of our internal functioning.

So I will just lay out the guts of it here, without all the very important details, piece by piece, starting with the most fundamental foundation -

1. We are animals.

There was a time when this was a controversial statement, but that time has now passed. There is no doubt whatsoever - we are just another animal, among the many that co-evolved alongside us, over many millions of years.

2. All animals have control hardware that is running control software.

Which is to say - They all have brains, and all brains do the same basic job.

At the most elementary level a brain processes sensory information (coming in) and responds with behavioural tendencies (going out), all in service of one basic purpose - the fulfilment of biological need.

In most higher species we see a series of biological algorithms we call 'instinct' and 'conditioned response' etc.

Instinct is a kind of behavioural programming that is passed on genetically from one generation to the next, which means that you can only have an instinctual response to something if one (or many) of your ancestors experienced the same thing before.

Conditioned response is likewise a learned behavioural pattern, except this time based on something you alone have experienced.

The point is that both of these reactions are essentially automatic once established over time, and rest on top of a few even more basic reactions that are hardwired into every organism, which we might call reflexes. And together such patterns of functioning lay the foundations of all animal behaviour - and to which all animals are blindly submitted.

In our own species - on top of all this - we have what we call 'thinking and feeling' etc, but these are no different essentially. For the most part we are just as blindly submitted to our thoughts as most animals are to their feelings and instinctual drives, even if we don't realise it. Just try to stop your mind for a moment, and see how far you get. It is all the same basic task, being done in more or less

sophisticated ways, and the sense of freedom we might perceive about the way we function compared to other animals is largely an illusion.

Brains are basically organic computers, and every organic structure that transacts with its environment has evolved some variation, along with some sort of particular software package to run on it. And yes this might sound rather basic as an explanation, but it is not much more complicated than that, and the analogy fits.

It is also worth noting that we evolved in the middle of the animal tree, not at the top. Not the fastest, not the biggest, not the most poisonous, certainly not the most beautiful - we were always generalists, jack-of-all-trade animals. And our task throughout all of history has been the same as many others: Eat or be eaten. Run after - and run from. Look for - and look out for. Sink or swim.

We also didn't have it easy. For most of our evolution we suffered very significant hardship, which is strangely good for evolutionary pressure. After all, evolution only moves forward by elimination, not by imagination. It is a blind event that only swings an axe, not a hammer - it only cuts down what doesn't work, so it is fortunate that life has so many opportunities to gradually experiment with what does work. Sometimes, and just by chance, it gets lucky - and the serendipitous nature of evolution is that every such lucky break is recorded if it happens to confer any sort of survival benefit to that lucky organism. What we don't see are the billions of bad luck mutations that were immediately washed away into oblivion, so it sometimes looks like evolution is thinking ahead, as if the whole process is being steered somehow, and carefully adjusted. But this is merely an illusion generated by the removal of all the millions of bad adjustments, along with all of the truly catastrophic bad turns that have occurred, as evidenced in the fossil record. More than 99.9% of all species that have ever existed are now extinct.

So why does this matter? Well it helps to set the stage for our own particular unique advantage. In our case this gradual process brought us very close to a sort of tipping point, and eventually something pressed us over that threshold. There was a sudden leap, due to a convergence of various factors all at the same time.

There are many theories about what generated this sudden leap, with some people saying it was a physical change, while others say it was likely more of a cultural or linguistic shift, but it seems likely it was both, all at once. But in the end it doesn't really matter, the only thing that matters was the result.

We could talk about how and when this occurred, and what the consequences were - with all the various factors like brain size increase, how this affected childbirth (we nearly went extinct as a result), the need for fatty acids to support such an expensive bit of hardware (we nearly went extinct as a result), and all the advantages a bigger brain conferred (saved us from going extinct) etc - but that is a job for paleo-anthropologists.

What matters here is that the offspring of some original 'mutant' hominid were very successful, which led to many more offspring. And then all affected individuals in this clan did very well in the race to be the only surviving human species.

From that starting point the human family developed and gradually adapted, branching and unifying, moving and competing, and in many cases eventually dying out. Less than half a million years ago there were still quite a few different types of humans walking the Earth, with the last few of those going extinct only very recently - recent enough that we can still extract intact DNA from their bones. These various types of humans fought, and fucked, and in some cases fled.

One of them (*Homo floresiensis*) ended up on an island that had very few resources, which meant they shrunk down to become only about three foot tall - like little hobbits - only to eventually die out about 50,000 years ago. Consider how recent this is. And we all know these days about our Neanderthal brothers and sisters, and how much of their DNA we acquired along the way to very recently driving them extinct.

Only one branch now remains - *Sapiens*. The name means 'wise man', but it is unclear whether or not that name fits. We might more accurately be called 'lucky man' or even 'most aggressively dominating man'. But in the end, and once again, it doesn't really matter 'how'. Only the 'what' matters. And 'what' happened is that the human brain quite rapidly grew in both size and also apparently in neuronal density. And like having a lot more soil into which both water and seeds might be added, this had a very dramatic and almost immediate effect.

At about the same time, and possibly as a related development, we also mastered fire - thereby providing us warmth and light at night, as well as pre-digesting our food (cooking), thereby widening the range of foods to include grains and other inedible root vegetables, and eliminating parasites. Predators also didn't like fire much. Life suddenly got a lot easier.

The advantages provided by fire were significant in physical terms, but perhaps even more important socially and culturally. Suddenly we had a lot of time to sit around at night and chatter away about all the new and interesting stuff that was floating around in our new and much bigger brains - which were still a lot more conditioned by where we had come from than where we were going. So from fire came language, and from language came stories, and suddenly any good idea that a single individual had could be passed on to many more, and at no cost. The quest for knowledge had begun, and with that, culture was born.

This is all very basic anthropology, and no doubt most will find this meaningless and boring, unnecessary perhaps. But even these days not everyone conceives of their own origins in these terms, so we are just making sure here I suppose.

The key thing to grasp here is that a longstanding historical constraint was broken in this convergence of factors. Basically, a kind of trapped cycle began to open up into a spiralling event, where one opening led to another, which led to another - and fortunately we also now had the brain power to accommodate all of these developments.

One of the advantages we gained from having this 'big calculator' in our heads was the sudden ability to arrange ourselves very differently as a group. First of all we could begin to record and balance social interactions much more powerfully - who owes who what etc - and secondly we could act as a group much more easily due to the ability to internalise collective plans and strategies. Wolves and chimps can act in groups of a dozen or more - but only humans can join together in groups of a hundred, or even a thousand, to act in a truly singular and unified way. And the key to that is common language and a powerful imagination.

Working in a group requires that you understand both the entire group purpose and structure, as well as your one particular part in that overall event. So the other thing that emerged as a result of such large social structures was the need for everyone involved to understand where everyone else fits, and also what each one can do to gain a better position. And animals cannot do this, at least not in the same way we can. It may sometimes appear as if they do, but these patterns are mostly instinctual, rather than culturally learned or shared.

Some deep patterns remain, however, such as the emergence of hierarchies. And sooner or later every individual eventually needs to figure out (and carefully monitor) who is at the top, and how to please them, or at least avoid displeasing the group.

But mostly the function it supported was trade, which for many thousands of years (before money was invented) meant the mutual exchange of favours. This 'currency of favours' was possibly the greatest advantage our species ever attained, and this is why we still sense any degree of perceived unfairness with extreme sensitivity, even today. Judging and accounting for social fairness is what the brain basically evolved to do, and the result was a level of collective unification that no other species can even come close to. This ability allows us to be more than the sum of our parts.

Therefore, all of these abilities resulted from the rather sudden emergence of a larger and more sophisticated brain - a brain that, as I say, also has a far more densely packed neural structure than any closely related animal. But of all the abilities we received as a result of this shift, none even come close to the power and significance of the really big leap we experienced before too long.

Just be aware that as we begin to collect these various key factors here, we will gradually be laying the foundations for understanding the true nature of our situation, and how our core dilemma actually works. So hopefully you will bear with me as we take what might seem like a rather convoluted journey.

Part Two - The Big Leap

What we are going to begin talking about now will perhaps seem a little strange, but only because you completely take it for granted, and don't even know you are doing it.

We experienced many collective advantages as a result of our new bigger brains, but this shift also generated a revolution in the way we personally experience the world (externally), as well as how we experience ourselves (internally).

To cut a long story short, the eventual convergence of functions resulted in an emergent capacity - imagination - and then the explosion of language and culture then immediately began to populate that imagination with all sorts of wonderful and powerful images and ideas.

Imagination did not emerge just for fun, however. It is not a toy, and is far too expensive for that, from an evolutionary perspective. It emerged in the face of a very strong survival imperative: an ongoing and deadly struggle for dominance in a ruthless and harshly unforgiving environment.

I mean, what is the essential game all life is playing? And what do you need to do to win it?

Which is to say - what is the advantage of having a brain in the first place? What is the advantage of having a bigger (or better) one? What does that allow you to do better?

Instinct and conditioned response give us a hint here. It is all about using the past to better understand how different actions in the present might result in different outcomes in the future.

The game (of life) is about the navigation of a complex and shifting environment in a way that confers the greatest benefit for a species as a whole, or for any individual in particular. And what imagination allowed for in this regard was a staggering leap in predictive ability. In particular, imagination (something we now totally take for granted) allowed for the emergence of future projection based merely on probability and experience.

We take the past (memory) and calculate probability (think) and project the various future outcomes associated with actions in the present (imagine).

People often confuse imagination with fantasy, but this is only because they don't recognise the degree to which imagination dominates our conscious lives. Fantasy is just what we fool around with at the end of the day - like scraps left on the floor of a dressmaker's studio. Most of the fabric goes into the dress, which we wear all day long. Well, you might not, but I like to!

It is important to understand this one point, because it is so easily lost when you happen to be speaking to someone who has the ability we are discussing -

The future does not exist.

You have never seen, or touched, or felt, or smelled, or heard, the future. There is no such thing. There is only the ever-changing present moment.

But yes, there are patterns in the way the present changes, and these can be used to determine certain probabilities relating to how certain actions in the present might lead to certain outcomes in the 'future present'.

It is very confusing to think about, I know, but this is where we see the bind that most animals are in - they have no way to know the future, because all they have is perception, and the future is not a real part of the universe. The entire universe, if it exists at all, only ever exists now. There is no past, and there is no future.

I mean, ask yourself this -

When have you ever experienced the past? When have you ever experienced the future? And what exists for you outside of your experience?

No scientific experiment has ever been able to prove the existence of the past, or the future. All they can ever find is an ever-changing present - but that the changes associated appear to follow certain definable patterns or relationships.

Of course, we do not experience life this way at all, and this is the whole trick. This is the point we are getting to here. We, the conscious aspect of mind and experience, were not informed about any of this development. It simply occurred, and was embraced immediately due to its power and advantage.

So what is the simplest way to gain the advantage of a system that essentially simulates and augments our perception of reality by overlaying that narrow perceptual experience with a massive and extended projection that includes both past and future and also a far wider appreciation of the present moment?

The simplest way to gain advantage of such a system was merely to not inform the subject of such an experience that this added part of 'reality' is not actually real.

Basically, the survival advantages associated with fully believing and emotionally responding to this 'massive process of mental simulation' as if it is actual reality significantly outweigh the benefits of any 'doubt based' approach to such.

Therefore, based on memory, cognitive ability, and probability generation - and all supported by an ever evolving culture - our ancestors were suddenly able to supplement their direct perception of local reality in the present moment with a vast and ever-shifting construction of what we might call 'simulated reality'. This added level of 'perceptual experience' included all of what we might call past (something that does not actually exist), a dramatically expanded and supplemented appreciation of the present moment (to include things well beyond direct perceptual boundaries), and most importantly (the point of all of it) a vastly improved ability to calculate and project various different future outcomes.

This was the really big shift, and the origins of all of our successes - but also many of our troubles, as we will see.

Can you see the potential for trouble here already? There is obviously great advantage to be gained if all of this combined functioning really can manage to accurately project the results of various present actions into the 'future' of change in the present. But just as dramatically, what if we get certain aspects wrong? I mean, it is even possible that our entire experience of time itself is a result of this

functioning, no? Which is to say - maybe other animals do not even experience time in the same way we do, and that they merely exist in the ever-present 'now'. But that is another topic.

The point at this stage is merely to set this most basic foundation down, based on the singular leap that allowed it. The vast majority of what we 'experience' as real is not actually coming from reality at all - it is coming from our own simulated projection of reality. And, more importantly, to think about what it might mean if certain important aspects of that simulation are errors. What if we are getting a few very basic things wrong, and don't even know it? And what if we are nevertheless experiencing those deep errors as being fully real, emotionally speaking?

This is a key thing to grasp, so I will repeat it here -

The ability that emerged was an extreme advantage, but only if we embraced it emotionally. To expand our direct perception of reality so as to include some sort of projected 'past-present-future' simulation - at such great cost both structurally and energetically (hardware and software demands) - was of no use whatsoever unless it was able to inform and adjust behaviour, dynamically and in real time.

No emotional investment (doubt) would have resulted in no behavioural response towards the better 'future' outcomes projected, and therefore no value gained from all the cost. So this new system, this 'waking dream', was then fully invested in 'as' felt reality. Nobody 'decided' to do this, it was just embraced naturally, without even any awareness that this supplementary overlay of projected probability wasn't actually real. So what we see is something that is essentially just a 'mental fabrication' being responded to emotionally with all the force of actual reality.

This is how it functions to modify behaviour - this input is plugged into the operating software below the level of conscious awareness, meaning that everything we feel (all emotional response), and everything we subsequently think as a result (shifting attention), is informed in very large part by a 'reality' that is largely constructed purely from our own furtive imagination.

It may not be immediately clear to you, but this simple fact solves a great many very confusing cultural debates about the nature of reality itself, and where it originates.

On the one side we have science, and the idea that reality is a freely self-existing event that does not require any conscious entity in order to bring it into existence. Thank goodness, eh! Lucky for us the entire universe doesn't stop existing every time some Tibetan Lama goes off to sleep.

On the other side there are all those fluffy headed snowflakes who claim that consciousness is itself the very root of all human experience, and that without consciousness nothing would exist - not experientially anyway.

The answer is obvious - there are two human realities, not one. There is actual reality (primary), and there is projected reality (secondary). Emotionally speaking they are both real for the individual, and cannot easily be teased apart experientially. But they are certainly not the same.

Most importantly, only one of them is actually real. Universal reality is a shared and common ground, within which we all exist. Our simulated overlay is merely a personal augmentation, a private experience for the most part. The latter is merely a mental and emotional construct that is being generated so as to better allow us to navigate the former.

Most importantly of all, especially since we experience so much of our emotional reality based on this 'extended simulation', it is important to keep it as accurate and informed as possible. After all, there is no point having a chart of a harbour if you simply begin rubbing out any parts that indicate dangerous rocks just because the idea of them makes you uncomfortable. The rocks will not magically go away if you do that, so not only may you still hit those rocks, but the possibility becomes much more likely in that instance.

So what do you call a mental creation that is responded to as a concrete reality? We call that a belief. And here we also see the very important function of rational thought and science in this situation, especially in a context that needs to be always tuned toward governing how this imaginative structure is generated and maintained so as to be healthy and balanced. The whole idea of this projection is to help us navigate actual reality, to extend awareness as much as possible, but to do so only where we can be pretty sure this is being represented accurately.

And when this simulation is not accurate? After all, this might be very tempting of course. If most of what we experience emotionally is the result of this mental simulation, then why not just imagine paradise? Why not just imagine all sorts of weird and wonderful but very consoling bullshit?

At the extreme end of the scale, we call such dislocated reality 'psychosis'. In the more benign and organised forms, we call that sort of thing 'religion'. But really, that is only one of many culturally embedded forms of fictional storytelling that people find very attractive, there are many more. And this sort of 'fantasy projection' is only quite a small part of the overall damage we will be looking at here as we uncover the full scale of the main event.

The problem with science, however, in relation to correcting 'reality errors', is that its tools are not generally compatible with 'subjective' aspects of human experience, which has left things like religion and spirituality to dominate in such areas. But this is not necessarily true about science, after all we have never actually been to the centre of the sun, but we can still know how hot it is there with some degree of certainty. It is just that special environments require special tools, and hopefully that is what we see emerging here now in relation to certain important aspects of our own subjective experience.

Not only does the anatomy of the event I will be describing fully account for almost all subjective experience in a meaningful way - including all those states and experiences generally covered only by less rigorous explanations - but it also completely conforms to everything we already know for certain about the universe from a purely scientific and rationally evidence based standpoint. It makes practical sense, is comprehensive, and requires no mysticism whatsoever. Sorry about that! But this does also mean that models and language will need to be gradually developed here, even in this simplest possible outline. After all, if we are going to truly capture what is really going on, then we will need to do so in the terms in which those parts of life actually consist. It will not be very romantic, unfortunately. Because reality just isn't. Indeed, romanticism generally results from a flight from reality, which is a shame because there may turn out to be much more to reality than we previously thought. Ugly reality might - once we crack it open to see what's inside - turn out to be the most beautiful thing there is.

It might even be that those people who started many of the great religions discovered something very important about reality, and tried their best to communicate that, but that eventually their message was lost and replaced with the exact opposite. So religion may have gone from being an uncomfortable and very challenging path of individual change - to become a very comfortable way for massive groups of people to basically stay the same. And if so, then the original truth of those paths was clearly lost along the way. I personally doubt very much whether any of the people who originated

such events would recognize their modern day results as having anything whatsoever to do with what they were actually saying.

Reality (actual reality) is complex and difficult and demanding, however. That is why it takes such extreme levels of functioning to grasp it accurately, even slightly. There will always be lots of doubt associated with a rational and scientific view of life, because there is a lot we can never know for sure. So any view that states anything with absolute certainty is almost certainly wrong - that is a primary hallmark of an erroneous view.

For myself, I would far rather have one small bit of hard truth than a mountain of consoling lies. My view of reality is never fixed, it is always changing and evolving and adapting based on new information and insight to be gained. That's why curiosity is the second most important thing in life, after doubt. Nothing is as powerful as cleaning all the fantastically comfortable bullshit out of your mind with the application of rational doubt.

This also solves the whole 'you are creating your own reality' debate. Some people, having noticed the origins of so much of our experience being internal to us, have concluded that that's all there is: that consciousness is the origin of everything! And that we can, therefore, simply change reality just by 'changing what we believe'.

Another similar idea, when people notice this doesn't actually work, is that we are 'collectively' generating reality - so all we need to do is convince everyone around us to change their beliefs also, and whammo! A new reality! Ah, no. But that is very funny!

These two human realities exist within a very bounded and set context - their relationship is fixed and purposeful. The function and purpose of secondary reality is merely and only to assist us in relation to navigating primary reality. That's it. It is not a toy to be freely untethered from that task unless and until that function has been more than adequately achieved.

Which is to say - use your imagination to envisage all sorts of unreal things if you wish, but only after you have used it to pin down actual reality to its fullest and most accurate extent first. To become intentionally lost in fantasy to the detriment of a solid grip on the real world is the very definition of willful psychosis.

Consciousness arises out of reality. And reality is influenced by what you think only to the degree that what you think influences what you do. It is only action that changes things in the real world, and directing action so as to lead to better outcomes is the purpose of all the functions we are discussing here. What we feel or experience inwardly is just a byproduct of all that, it is only action and behaviour that evolution cares about.

To sum up , then -

To experience something as being emotionally real does not make it reality. We (modern humans) actually exist within a continual fusion of two separate but both fully experienced 'realities' -

1. 'actual universal reality' on the one hand (shared and objectively real)
2. and then our own 'subjective augmentation of reality' on the other - an overlay that we project.

This 'secondary reality projection' includes all our past, most of our present, and all of our future. It is unreal essentially and yet paradoxically still about 90% of everything we experience as being emotionally salient to our lives.

Truly - the vast majority of what we experience as reality is actually just a self generated projection - secondary or imaginary reality you might say - a personal creation, experienced only by you, but nevertheless experienced by you as quite real emotionally. And we do this so pervasively that we don't even know we are doing it.

So ask yourself this - how much of what you are experiencing as real in your own life might possibly only be fantasy? Which is to say - how much of what you are projecting might not have any actual reality underlying it, if you picked it up and looked beneath?

Would you know?

Another question is this - if something purely mental in nature is experienced as being emotionally real, does that make it real in some sense? Is that not a way for the unreal to become real - and to cross over that threshold?

Sort of, yes, but not directly. The imagined thing does not become real as such, but the behaviour that belief in it might produce will be real, and so will the emotional states you experience as a result of that thing.

I sometimes think of this like someone fighting off an imaginary swarm of bees - the bees are not real, but the fighting is, and the person might really get hurt as a result of leaping about so wildly. And this metaphor gives a little preview of what we will be looking at next, because this is exactly the situation we are in. This is how things can be both okay and not ok at the same time - it is because of these two human realities and how they interact.

There might (in truth) be no bees - and yet (for us) we might nevertheless be fighting furiously as a result of imagining them to be real. And that violent 'thrashing about' really is happening, and really is causing a great deal of harm. So yes, in this way the unreal can become real, in a sense.

And it can also be very difficult to deal with - after all, how do you remove a swarm of bees that are not actually there? Everything you do to confront an illusion merely strengthens the idea that it is there in the first place, no? And yet, there is hope, as we will see.

The key thing at this stage is just to notice how much of what we experience is being generated from within us, rather than being directly perceived reality, and that some of the most important aspects of what we believe are the least likely to be correct. For instance, almost all of the context (and therefore meaning) of what we experience is provided by our 'cultural worldview', which is generally grounded in a story we heard from others, rather than any direct experience we had.

The point is -

- A. We don't know we are doing it.
- B. That we have the ability to experience very real emotional results - from both accurate as well as wildly inaccurate 'reality projections' (beliefs).

There is a massive potential for error here, especially given that some of the most fantastically unlikely fictions might also be the most emotionally attractive, and also be in areas that might lead to direct experience being interpreted differently.

In particular, if we do manage to make ourselves feel really bad due to some mistake we have made (either individually or as a culture) we can then try to 'fix' that bad feeling by creating even more mistakes - this time ones that make us feel good. But there are not many realities, there is only one - so a mistake is a mistake, and you can't fix one mistake by making another, because that is twice as bad, not twice as good. Even if it makes you feel good to believe it, a lie about reality will always cause harm in the long run, because actual reality will always still exist and need to be related to in an intelligent way.

Can you see this, or not? It is not very controversial, it is just that we don't notice it for the most part. It is easy to observe, and makes total sense, but it is very strange to think about. But this is just a preliminary step here, one small block only, not the main event. As interesting as this may be, it is only a partial foundation for what comes next, where we see a far greater event unfold - one that really does shake the entire ground beneath our feet. So while this whole "two realities" part may not be obvious, and while it may represent a certain potential for trouble - the next part (of which this is just a small aspect) is far more concealed, and totally devastating in its impact on life. So hopefully you will stay with me for a bit longer! Because the next part is what we are really up against in life, and also shows us what we might do about it.

Part Three - The Big Hiccup

This basic foundation sets us up to begin piecing together the really important and much larger event at the core of human life as we know it.

This huge leap in ability enabled us to gain a massive advantage over other animals, and ultimately to dominate the entire planet. But it came with certain unseen costs, and one of those in particular has had a truly devastating effect. It has also remained completely hidden from view, and we will see both how and why in this part.

It is almost as if the 'new computer' of human intelligence came loaded with a software virus, and that the great new software has ended up being an equally big problem, and certainly isn't functioning as it might do naturally. And, as a result, that we have yet to realise many of the natural benefits of our new abilities, because this tangle up continues to cause almost as much trouble as the leap produces gain.

Which is to say - normally a species that has been able to 'win the lotto' in the way we have would be left in a state of constant and blissful serenity, but actually what we see is quite the opposite, with depression and suicide and addiction everywhere in our societies, strangely even more so in more affluent areas, and we will see why shortly.

We are about to explain a great mystery, but in doing so you will also confront a very strange sensation, as yet another part of your everyday 'reality' is brought into question.

Having already addressed the rather uncomfortable and disconcerting fact of just how much of our 'normal' human experience is being generated as a fabricated extension of directly perceived reality, and that we have the very real possibility of creating a great deal of actual suffering as a result of any serious errors, the question then becomes this: What is the worse possible mistake we might make?

What is the one error that might on the one hand produce the worst possible suffering, but on the other hand be the most difficult to undo or even notice we have made?

In order to understand this better, we first need to get at least some foundational idea of where emotional suffering comes from, and why we even have it in the first place.

To begin with, we first need to establish a very basic hierarchy -

Body (physical level).

Feelings (emotional level).

Mind (thinking level).

And here we see Darwin's great contribution to science: In that order!

The body came first, then came the emotional brain, on top of which grew the thinking brain. This was the order in which evolution produced each layer, and can still be seen in the structure of the brain we have today. There is the reptilian brain, on top of which (and including such) rests the mammalian brain, on top of which (and including such) rests the higher thinking brain.

The key thing to understand about this hierarchy is that they all serve the same purpose, although in higher or better ways. But the basic task is the same, and it is also important to understand that all higher functions necessarily include but subsume all previous structures.

The basic pattern here means that the core levels have all the power, while the higher levels are a lot smarter - so the conscious aspect of life can be seen as being a bit like a rider on a big and powerful horse.

For the most part that horse has learned to surrender to the much smarter 'thinking brain' rider, trusting it implicitly, as long as everything is going okay. But occasionally the horse can still get spooked, and even throw the rider off, such as when the conscious will is overthrown by a powerful opposing drive or tendency.

For instance the "obsessive compulsive cycles" many people experience in life are the result of an inexperienced rider being constantly thrown off their untrained and unwieldy horse. People diet (weak willpower), and then the horse (overwhelming compulsion) will binge, etc.

So what makes for harmony in this situation? What would be paradise for the relationship between all these various levels? And is that even possible?

Sure it is. It is possible because the purpose of all these levels is the same, and should therefore be able to perfectly align. The function of all this activity is simply 'change management', and the purpose of that activity is merely the fulfilment of biological needs.

I mean, you might think that needs are pretty basic, and that the fulfilment of higher desires is more of a key to happiness, but we will get to that below in more detail. Actually, in nature, desires (at the emotional level) represent needs (at the biological level), so the fulfilment of such needs should automatically result in a peaceful and blissfully undisturbed state (at the emotional and mental level). All three levels should, in that case, flood the conscious experience of life as a harmony of energised equanimity (happiness-fulfilment-contentment).

Another very brief hierarchy is this one -

Anger
(protecting your connection to a current need fulfilment)

Grief
(releasing your connection to a current need fulfilment, and beginning a process of finding a new one)

Fear
(when both the old one and any new one are not immediately available, thereby threatening a lack of need fulfilment)

The function of the core emotional levels (below the conscious level of life) is the management of strong motive energy, generally in the form of attachment.

The connection between attachment and need is totally obvious, and well established in psychology, but not so widely appreciated by most people. But it is quite simple really - in order to maintain need fulfilment over time, the very powerful but not very smart parts of our core brain emotionally attach to objects (or people or processes) that in some meaningful way represent the fulfilment of various

needs. Thereafter (and the very purpose of attachment being) the emotional system will fight to maintain those attachments, and thereby (by proxy) maintain fulfilment.

This also explains the transition from infancy to adulthood. At the start, a baby simply attaches to the primary caregiver, because the caregiver represents 100% of all need fulfilment. So when they get cold, or hungry, or feel pain - they cry in order to gain the attention of their caregiver, and their needs get met. It is very simple. But notice this fact also - the baby does not experience any understanding of its own needs, or even that they are being fulfilled by the object of their ardour. All they experience is love - they just love the caregiver. That's all they know. And in expressing that love, and making sure this bond is always secure, they somehow 'magically' always end up having their needs met.

Over time, however, as the child grows, this externalised attachment bond begins to be displaced and transferred first to other people, but then ultimately starts to transfer to processes that reside within them - as they gain the ability to directly fulfil their own needs in any regard. At that point, any attachment (and the subsequent drive to protect any connection) will begin to subside, with the associated motive energy then also diverted to drive internal processes instead. They become increasingly independent, both emotionally, as well as functionally, as the energy that would once have gone into protecting an interpersonal bond now begins to power internal processes of self-sufficiency instead.

In the simplest terms possible, all this means is that what other people used to do for us we eventually learn to do for ourselves.

This is the normal transition into adulthood - it is finally marked by the assumption of full responsibility for the fulfilment of your own needs, as well as the necessary and normal emotional independence this state implies. It also implies responsibility for the operation and maintenance of our own emotional systems, so that they can keep our ongoing need fulfilment up to date and well adapted in the face of constant change.

But here we can also see how 'infantile' parents might seek to maintain strong attachment bonds to their children, and thereby prevent them from ever actually becoming adults - meaning that those children will likely adopt the same abusive pattern with their own children, and so on.

The important thing to grasp about the way attachment is managed is the way it can shift and change over time, sort of like emotional architecture. This happens all the time, as the fulfilment of need constantly becomes threatened in the face of perpetual change. Just as any old building might be pulled down and replaced by something newer, healthy emotional maintenance over time will demand a kind of deconstruction and reconstruction process.

So what does that look like?

Think about it this way - an emotional attachment is a kind of short circuit, a sort of 'this-means-that' connection that functions to bypass a whole lot of complexity by simply attaching to an object or process that represents various need fulfilments.

The point is, once the attachment is established, the needs in question are no longer obvious from any conscious perspective - they are subsumed within the surface level attachment. The whole idea of this sort of functioning is to make life automatic in a sense, so that the horse will simply go where it is supposed to, without being told.

The process of moving attachment, then, is also often misunderstood. People often confuse the surface level (object) with the deep level (need). They also often confuse infantile states (emotional dependency and interpersonal attachment) with adult states (personal competency and emotional independence).

Imagine, then, that you have several needs currently being met by something you are attached to. Maybe you have a camper van, let's say, which you are currently living in. You love your camper van, and you might even have given it a name - let's call it Dorris.

What you probably don't really grasp (at least consciously) is that your 'love' for Dorris is actually just a representation of what Dorris offers you in terms of various need fulfilment outcomes. And yes, this seems like a terribly 'unemotional' way to view life, but this is precisely what I am saying here. Emotion is entirely about need, but the conscious self is not generally informed about this directly. It is actually about nothing else. So if you are spending emotional attachment on things that do not represent need then you are, to that very same degree, fucked up.

Imagine, then, that Dorris gets stolen. You run out onto the street to see her speeding around a corner..

What do you do? What are your options?

This resulting choice represents the three most important of all common emotional states.

The most obvious and least disruptive response, and the one that the existing attachment will immediately seek to uphold, is that you will chase after Dorris!

This response is typified in Anger: You seek to protect the current attachment. Dorris is mine!!!

If that is not possible, however, the next level is to accept the loss and move on, and start looking for another camper - or maybe even somewhere else to stay.

This second level response is typified as Grief. You may not realise it as such, but you will begin a process that seeks to undo the current attachment, but also in a way that somehow results in the recovery of the underlying need fulfilment - just not in a way that involves 'Dorris'.

You cannot simply have no response. This is what attachment means. The emotional fusion of need to the object of attachment cannot simply be abandoned, because in that instance need might go unmet and unrecognised, so the recovery of the underlying need from within an embedded attachment always involves the integration of active tension.

Remember that we are taking a bottom up view here, and seeking to establish the most basic understanding of what is really going on beneath what merely appears to be going on. And in reality what is really going on is captured most simply in the horse and rider analogy. The rider may imagine they are in control of the situation, in that this is the role they are being allowed to fulfil, but it is ultimately the horse that confers this ability. Conscious control is an illusion in this sense, which is very easy to demonstrate. Every time you are consciously driven by an overwhelming emotional force, or whenever your conscious will is overcome by a compulsion of any kind, you are being reminded who is really in charge. And in this sense the core systems (the horse in this analogy) have the same relationship to any attachment bond as they do to your own imaginary control - it will only maintain either of these things for as long as they represent an adequate level of gain relative to whatever other options are available.

Hence, when that object or relationship is lost, a process will be immediately initiated in order to extract the 'internal' element from the 'external' connection. This is because the core emotional system (horse) will not allow you to sacrifice a need, so it will only let you release a fulfilment mechanism if the need component is recovered and loaded up like a coiled spring. Which is to say, what was automatic before will become conscious again, as the unconscious extracts the needs in question, and then applies pressure to the conscious mind to restore some kind of fulfilment for that need in due course. It is a bit like the horse hanging the water bucket around the neck of the rider, if the stable boy runs off, just so that the rider won't forget about that need.

This is why grief hurts. It is because we are assuming a weight that was previously being carried by an attachment to someone or something else. So grief is like picking up a heavy bag from a friend's trolley as you say goodbye to them at the airport. The whole idea of assuming this weight is that it will eventually force you (the conscious mind) to find another fulfilment, and in this principle we see the anatomy of the grieving process in its full sense. There is no 'getting over' a loss until you have reestablished fulfilment for the needs in question - that is the full circle of grief in a nutshell. Hence, grief is actually about fulfilment, not loss, and if you have not re-established fulfilment in the wake of a loss then you have not yet fully grieved. Likewise, there is no need to get over any loss if the needs associated can be immediately met elsewhere - in that case a loss will only initiate an immediate emotional transfer (humour).

Both grief and humour (laughing and crying) involve the movement of deep visceral anchors, as one part of their function, which is why they can look and sound almost identical. One has a strong in-breath, the other has a strong out-breath, but apart from that they are very similar in the way they move energy around in the body. But the difference is that the function of grief is to produce a desire if no fulfilment is available, whereas humour will simply bypass that stage and go directly to the new attachment. Laughing is what happens when we find a desire has been released, crying is what happens when a desire has been assumed.

Which is to say - if the person who stole Dorris happened to leave an even better camper behind, with the keys in the ignition, and ownership papers signed, and all your belongings piled up in the back, what would you do?

Laugh, right? Have a party to celebrate the loss of Dorris!

The main confusion most people struggle with is the difference between the surface level attachment and the deep level needs associated. And most especially we struggle as a culture to understand and respect the deep processes that rearrange such shifting attachments so as to be adaptive and relevant in a constantly changing world.

People generally fail to appreciate the transience of surface level fulfilments, or the permanence of the deep level needs. And precisely because we are so inept at supporting - or even understanding - the vital function of these deep processes in each other, it is also common for the attachment to become fixated in an infantile state due to a kind of locked up failure to confidently manage the transitions associated. And the result is people who never quite manage to move early (external) attachment bonds over to adult (internal) processes.

I mean, you can imagine overhearing a conversation in a cafe, where a girl is breaking up with her boyfriend - and he blurts out "but I need you!" Or even worse - "I will never get over it if you leave!"

First of all, good for her! This guy is a baby, after all. No adult ever needs another adult, not unless they are crippled in some fundamental sense.

Assuming the girl is actually an adult, and has at least some degree of self awareness, what she will know is this - her 'love' for this guy is not actually about him, it is about her own needs and desires, and about whether or not this person is taking her toward her own ultimate fulfilment, or away from that. That 'love' is, therefore, not about him at all. It is actually about anyone who might represent the same underlying transaction.

She also knows that - with her own level of personal competency, plus her very practised ability to rapidly and freely transfer such emotional states from one connection to another - her needs will continue to be met no matter what this current guy does.

The point is - she is in control of her own need fulfilment, not him, and this is what makes her an adult. It is within her power to simply replace him, and not only with equal, but with better - and she knows it.

And where does she get such power? It comes from knowing what she in turn has to offer any prospective partner. She gets her needs met by learning to fulfil needs in others, and in doing so thereby becomes 'lovable'. It is all about understanding the deeper level, both in herself and in others, and in translating any surface level transaction into those terms.

He, on the other hand, with his emotionally inept inability to easily transfer such attachment, on top of a complete lack of adult responsibility for his own needs, will find it difficult to let go of the old 'love', as well as very difficult to attract any new one. And this is because he is - for both reasons - essentially 'unlovable'.

So if this girl gets up and, before leaving, says 'you are never going to find another girl like me - because you are weak and selfish' - what will she experience?

Well let's just say that she will probably be smiling as she goes, right?

But what will that infantile guy experience in that situation? Both people just broke up, but only one is smiling about it. So why is that? It is because he was focused on what he could get, rather than what he could give. And what do people who only take (or who never learn to truly give - which is the same thing) experience as their most fundamental emotional state? Let's just say, it will not only be grief he begins to feel as she walks away.

If we go back to our previous story - what if Dorris really was your only option, and that her loss might leave you freezing to death on the streets?

Therefore, the third primary emotional state also relates to need fulfilment in the same way as the other two, except in this case to do with an inability to go down either of the previously indicated paths toward the recovery or reestablishment of fulfilment. In that situation we get: Fear.

But once again the underlying situation is the same - fear will subside immediately upon the restored fulfilment of need, because fear is actually nothing but the frustration of the other two mechanisms at the same time.

So that girl is not afraid, because the fulfilment of her own needs remains entirely within her own power at every point. She might perhaps look back at her first teenage love, and all the wonderful feelings she experienced, but also cringe at all the angst and dread she once experienced along with

all of that blissful levity. And also cringe at the devastation caused by the eventual breakup. And she will do all of this cringing if only because now, as an adult, all of that same bliss is now established as a permanent state - although not now dependent on the maintenance of any particular external relationship, and thereby - like her teenage love - free of fear. All the feelings she once experienced now arrive on the basis of internal processes and capacities that she knows are entirely able to attract and maintain a very good relationship not only with one person, but with any person she chooses. And from this reality comes self-confidence, it is a result of self-competence. She has become the person that the person she is looking for is looking for. And for this reason her relationships will be free of fear and full of joy. If only because, if they're not, she will leave immediately.

So this was a bit of a detour here, but hopefully it helps to illustrate the important difference between any surface level attachment and the underlying needs associated. And also the various layers of emotional tension we might experience, and how they all basically do the same thing.

The point is that each of these responses is more serious, sort of like a ramp. Actually the best way to think about it is like a bowl, with a golf ball rolling around inside. Right in the middle of the bowl is optimum need fulfilment, and the ball is behaviour let's say. As life pushes us off kilter occasionally, need fulfilment suffers, and as a result the ball experiences pressure as it is pushed up the slope in some direction. The link in this metaphor is between horizontal movement around some ideal point (optimum need fulfilment) and vertical movements as that process strays too far (emotional drive). The elevated pressure caused by the steep sides of this 'bowl' is emotional tension, and its entire purpose is to move the ball back toward optimum need fulfilment in the middle. It makes sense, right?

The principle is called homeostasis. And in our case, all the various emotional processes we experience are just different ways of achieving the same thing, depending on how serious the threat is.

What does it all mean, then? And why do we need to know this?

The main thing, I suppose, is that needs are stable and reliable aspects of life - as defined by our physiology and our psychological expectations. We can't just make them up, or change them at will. But it is also true that we (the conscious rider of the horse) will only have an easy time of things if the needs (of the horse itself) remain securely met. If not, then life can be very difficult to control or enjoy, because the conscious level is not actually in charge. As we outlined above, and contrary to the way most people conceive of their own situation, the conscious self is actually a servant, not a master.

Anyway, the point here is that emotional states are generated based on attachment, which is itself all about the fulfilment of needs. And also that the powerful horse upon which we are riding will only be calm and submissive as long as those needs are being securely met. If that does not happen, then the 'conscious self' might easily find itself in a situation that is completely out of control.

This elementary connection between need and desire - between what tastes good and what is actually good for us - is so incredibly basic, but somehow also completely overlooked by most people, and for reasons we will come to see below. The implied alignment between these two systems has been so corrupted that people no longer recognise that it even exists, let alone use such awareness in any meaningful way.

Fortunately evolution has ensured that we are entirely capable of meeting all of our actual (natural) needs on a realistic and sustainable basis, even within the very harsh environments in which we evolved, which means that doing so in our modern context should be easy.

Hopefully that part makes sense, even just in outline. Sorry we didn't spend much time here, there is a lot more to all of this. But we need to move on to the main issue we are setting up.

What matters in this context is that the way we now perceive life (two realities etc) has very dramatically impacted this basic relationship.

It is not that complicated really. Over time the very stupid horse learns that if the future projection associated with any action in the present involves suffering of some kind, then it will indeed suffer as a result - and so it learns to avoid such actions where possible.

So in order to get that horse to do what it wants, the conscious mind is essentially telling it a story - continuously. That story is the projection of 'secondary reality' simulation, as mentioned above, and in particular it is about the projection of various future outcomes associated with various current actions.

This is how that reality prediction works. This is the entire point of it. Which is to say - there would be no point in projecting various future outcomes if the horse (the emotional level of life) did not respond to such warnings or promises and redirect energy accordingly.

The problem with this, however, is that the only way to meaningfully project future outcomes that make sense to the stupid horse, in any truly salient way, is to populate that 'future life' with some sort of 'future self'. And, also, to generate that 'future self' in any meaningful way requires the similarly meaningful and emotionally invested construction of a 'past self'. Which, together, have the very strong effect of manufacturing a very tacit and emotionally real sense of 'present self'.

What does that mean?

It means that 'Self' is an illusion. The whole idea of 'self' is a fabrication of the mind. It is part of secondary reality, not primary reality. The idea of self is just that - just an idea. It is merely a functional illusion, a necessary part of a motivational and navigational program we are running, and is never actually real.

Does this seem outrageous? This is not even controversial. In all the thousands of studies that have ever been made, none have ever isolated or located any 'self' within the body, or even associated with it. It is not in the hardware, but is merely a program we are running as part of the software.

I mean, think about it - if there is a bounding line between 'self' and 'other' then where is that line located? Do things ever pass across that line? Do they become 'you' if they do?

It is very strange to contemplate, in just the same way as the whole 'two realities' thing is, if only because the 'self' is (emotionally speaking) just a very heavily invested part of secondary reality. The functional combination of events that produces this strong subjective sense of self may also produce consciousness as we know it, but that is another subject.

The important thing in this conversation is that we live our lives as if we 'are' a self, as if we 'have' a self - in just the same way as we are very sure we had a past, and will have a future. And yet, there is no past, there is no future, and there is no self. There is actually only one thing happening, in the present, and we (whatever we are) are a natural and intrinsic part of whatever that is.

It all sounds very cosmic and profound, but the point here is not to say what IS going on, or even why. The point is merely to say what is NOT going on, which is much easier. And what is not going on here is a fight for the ultimate destiny of your 'self'.

Can you begin to see some potential for trouble here? I mean, how much of your life is completely dominated by the past, by the future, and by yourself? Almost all of it, right? So you can maybe begin to see the reasons why so many of the wisdom traditions have always told us to "live in the present moment" and to "be selfless".

Obviously, the advantages of projecting this emotionally invested sense of self into the future are massive, and this is why evolution supported its development. It is a great trick. But it is still just a trick, and one that is also extremely costly in another sense entirely, as we will see. In particular, this trick is costly if only because we are not even aware we are doing it.

What is the main cost, then?

Without even realising it, evolution has stumbled upon a solution to a problem, but in the same moment created another even greater problem - and one that it does not immediately know how to fix, or even realise it has created. This is one of the challenges that any process as blind and rudimentary as evolution will always come up against - sometimes it will develop the ability to cause a problem before it reaches the ability to solve that problem. Fire came along a long time before fire engines, etc. And that is the same here - we are only now reaching the stage as a culture where we might finally understand and release an issue that we began to generate a few thousand years ago, and that has caused all manner of very seriously negative outcomes for all that time.

What was the damage this 'sense of self' caused, then?

The essential issue is that we developed the ability to project this sense of self some time before we developed the ability to fully understand its illusory and purely symbolic nature, and the result of this is that the combination of 'future projection of reality' and 'future projection of self' confronted us with an existential dilemma.

Basically, we are not what we think we are. But if we really were what we think we are, then death would be a very big problem for us. In particular, it freaks the horse out, and we become unable to control it or to get it to move forward. It really just stops cooperating if any of the paths you are seeking to lead it down will eventually lead to death - which they all do eventually.

The detailed anatomy of all of this, when fully expanded, offers a rather interesting study in dynamic systems - but for this very brief explanation the best we can do is simply say that the result is bad. It is very bad actually, in that the effect is to introduce a need that this system does not actually have, and that it therefore never evolved to fulfil. And this is why we took the time to examine the relationship between attachment, need, and emotional states.

Surviving death is simply not something that organisms do, or need to do. And yet, suddenly, this need is felt with very great salience and in the highest resolution. We - our 'self' - simply must survive. By any means. Because to not do so would be just inconceivable. Our entire existence, as far as we know it, has always been defined by finding emotional satisfaction via navigating life toward positive outcomes, and all of that is, of course, for 'us'. So at the future point where no positive outcomes remain, a great deal of attention begins to accumulate.

So this is the issue - we have one falsehood resting right at the core of this storm: the self. The one thing we never question about life is actually the greatest mistake we could ever have made, so everything else becomes a bewildering mess as a result.

It should also be noted that the functioning that draws attention toward the imminent and inevitable reality of death is all entirely healthy and balanced in this context. There is no error. We will die. No matter what we do. And we (what we believe ourselves to be) will certainly not survive that event.

So what happens when an ultimate need confronts an ultimate thwart? The highest level of emotional tension available is what happens: Existential Fear.

It is not like we can simply ignore existential fear, nor continue on down the path of life in some hope that things will get better. Existential fear is an emotionally eclipsing event. Everything stops. The great and powerful horse of the unconscious simply won't move until some path that does not involve death is presented to it. And so it is that we become stuck, deadlocked, crippled. It is a noise so loud that we can no longer hear anything else, a light so bright that it blinds us, and so the only available option is to shut the entire thing down somehow.

Part Four - Two Things - Not One

In order to fully appreciate the implications of this event, and what happened next, we would need the full anatomy of this very complex system. But that is not the purpose of this brief outline, so all we can do for now is take a very rough snapshot. And yet, if self-understanding is something you seek in life, then even the most basic grasp of what we are pointing to here will take you further than years in any university philosophy department, or sacred Tibetan monastery. Because the relatively simple mechanics we are discussing here go a very long way toward solving every major riddle there is, at almost every level, which matters most especially because this simple insight is currently entirely absent. As we will see, it is the particular nature and location of the tangle up that allows it to cause so much damage, and also to remain so profoundly concealed in how it does this.

Of course, if the symbolic 'self' could be identified as the cause of all this, and 'removed' in some meaningful way, then the entire issue would be resolved immediately - but this is the one aspect of life we never even question. We instead keep the self, enthroning it at the very centre of our lives, and then do everything we can to negate or avoid the brutal and impending reality of death. We dampen and smother the emotionally explosive potential associated with allowing attention to focus on death fully, because - if ever that happens - it can so very quickly get out of control.

In essence, the only option remaining is for the core systems (unconscious level) to somehow subvert many levels of healthy functioning in order to restore some degree of normal equilibrium, and then to maintain that subversion for... well... forever, basically.

There is clearly a lot more to explore here, but in a nutshell what we see is that the healthy operations of our internal systems are being distorted in a very particular way, and for a very particular reason.

If you imagine for a moment that the ideal and most open human experience spans the boundary between inner and outer, and also extends as deeply as possible in both directions - like a single 'zone of awareness' that extends from deep in the inner realm, out through the expressive boundary between self and world, and then extending as deeply as possible into that field of reality. At the inner end that connection represents what you want - your deepest emotional drives and desires at their ultimate root, with their concomitant aversions. And at the outer end we see direct and penetrating understanding of the world as it is, and what makes it work the way it does.

All of which represents a certain dynamic polarity, like the positive and negative ends of an electrical battery, thereby producing the resulting power that drives the animated self in between. It is the difference between 'the way things are' now and 'the way you would like them to be' that drives emotional production - and thereby action and change. But in this case it is as if we find 'incompatible' realities at the far ends of this full and natural span of awareness, meaning that it is fine for this bubble of awareness to touch either of these things, but that if ever it does both at the same time then the self in the middle immediately begins to fry - like someone sitting on an electric chair. So all that can be done in order to manage this situation is to keep this from happening - hence we see this bubble shrinking and being diminished so that it can't reach both at the same time.

We basically dumb ourselves down to stop ourselves from totally freaking out. We then do that to other people also, and do whatever we can to prevent anyone from talking about the fact that this has occurred. And we call that great effort 'culture'. Which is a great solution, very ingenious, and also entirely within the power of this system to achieve. But it does have one lasting effect: the limitation in this instance is essentially related to how much you 'feel'.

What you 'feel' is what you call the subjective experience of activity that is actually just managing how primary functional integrity is maintained over time in a system that is intrinsically free. Wow, what does that even mean! It means that 'feelings' have a job to do, just like everything else in this beautiful and complex system. And I realise that you might naturally think that your feelings are very deep aspects of your life, but actually they are just the surface level when viewed from the perspective of the vast unconscious. This is one problem we will continue to struggle against here as we continue discussing systems and functions that normal waking awareness does not normally have access to - what we think of as being deep is actually quite shallow, but you only notice this as you dive in and begin to descend. So it can be a little disorienting at first.

The point is that what we experience consciously as 'feelings' is just the tip of a far deeper iceberg of very dynamic functioning that has an important role to play. It all makes sure we will always return over time to a state that both feels a lot, and that also feels good, which is why the particular topography of our emotional landscapes need to be trustworthy.

Essentially, the 'river of behavioural tendency' will always tend to follow the contours presented to it by our own deeper systems, which themselves have the task of modulating the production of emotional states so as to define which actions we will take over time. Does this make sense?

But in this case the system is forced into a situation where - in order to survive - it must paradoxically sacrifice a degree of happiness. It must violate its own prime directives. The water somehow needs to be prevented from flowing where it naturally wants to - or somehow forced to flow in directions it does not naturally tend toward - both of which are possible, but also costly and very unnatural.

Put most simply: in managing to avoid a really bad feeling, feeling itself becomes limited, which in turn also limits our ability to feel openly happy.

It is obviously a lot more complicated than this, it might even be the most complex single process ever discovered, but in essence it is pretty much this simple. And this is why we often see people who are very deeply connected inwardly, and who are awash with what they feel, but who are often also enamoured with all the fantastic yet fictional artefacts of subjective reality as we defined it above. 'Away with the fairies', we often say. And then we see others who are just as deeply focused on hard and objective reality, deeply penetrating the complex and shifting external realm of the world, but who very often appear dead and hollow inwardly. 'Hard headed pragmatists', etc.

The point is that we so very rarely see anyone who does both at the same time, and this is because the inner realm ultimately holds the roots of self - while the outer realm ultimately discloses the imminent reality of personal death.

Another confounding factor is how incredibly dynamic the various expressions of this struggle can be. There are lots of ways to do it. Once again, it is difficult to discuss this aspect without explaining the full anatomy associated, but what this means is that there are many possible methods by which this underlying subversive event can achieve its primary aim of avoidance and concealment, and that all of them might work to some degree. It can also employ a combination of several, or many.

Think of it this way - the conscious level of life is predisposed to seek out and dig up threats, after all this is the primary method by which it is tasked with avoiding such events in life. And what greater threat than imminent destruction? So the 'dogs of attention' immediately latch onto death as if it was a massive and juicy bone - so massive and so juicy, and so very tasty, that they soon begin to choke

and suffocate. So the dogs are put to sleep, and that big bone buried out in the garden somewhere, as deeply as possible.

And when they wake up? Well, there is something missing, right? Something nobody is talking about..

But what is it? The dogs no longer remember..

The only thing that can then be done is to then keep these dogs of attention forever distracted, just so that they never again catch a whiff of that buried bone - because if they do, and if they start digging, the result can be functionally catastrophic. It is all very difficult to stop if ever it begins again.

I'm not sure if this helps you to visualise the strange situation that results. It is quite simple in essence, once you see the deeper event, but the ways it might be expressed in any particular instance can be extremely varied and dynamic. They are also (all of them) always necessarily dysfunctional in nature, to at least some degree.

The functions that need to be unconsciously subverted in this instance are not pathologies - they are healthy and natural and correct responses to a situation that is simply being misunderstood. I mean, the dogs should be running free, and also be allowed to rest occasionally, and there should not be stinky stuff messing up the garden. And yet, provided things can be arranged in any of the patterns that remain workable, this situation can appear rather stable and even quite normal. And common culture also offers us many tried and tested ways to manage this strange situation, including the ultimate injunction, posed as the ultimate is social wisdom - "never talk about this stuff!".

But it is not normal, and not talking about it turns out to be the ultimate mistake. Beneath the surface of it all there is a sleeping potential for very big trouble, and so a kind of vigilance and rigidity pervades life from that time forward. And sorry about the metaphors, but they help to impart a sense of the dynamics involved, without needing to go into explicit anatomy at this early stage.

The key thing is to understand exactly what all of this means in real terms, as well as to begin to fully grasp just how dramatically concealed and concealing this activity really is.

So maybe consider this silly 'dysfunctional family' metaphor: The kids are all getting hungry, but mum got totally drunk, and getting to the store means going for a drive around the clifftop road. So while mum is piling the kids into the car, they conspire to thwart her plans. They are not stupid, after all. They have to, even though they are hungry, because taking that drive with mum in this state would be even worse, right? So what do they do? What can they do? All manner of things, right? They can hide the keys. They can lock the doors. They can stick a banana up the tailpipe. They can throw her shoes over the fence. While one kid is being put in one side of the car, another one can be getting out the other side. Etc. You name it, right? The options are endless really, but the basic game is always the same.

In this instance, unfortunately, the mother is the conscious experience of life - and the kids are the seething unconscious. The kids complaining about being hungry is general unhappiness. So for the mother this situation is completely bewildering and confusing, on top of a situation that was already very confusing. She just can't win - the kids are hungry, but no matter what she does she can't manage to get to the store. They just won't shut up about being hungry - but they also won't let her solve the situation - although she doesn't actually know this, obviously. And the unconscious is not happy either, but it will always choose the lesser of two evils. The kids will always choose survival over happiness. But ultimately neither can win, not while the mother remains drunk.

All the various options this system can employ in order to subvert and distort natural functioning are what make this situation so interesting and also so bewildering. One minute we will see someone who was a rampant alcoholic suddenly transform into being a screaming born again Christian - apparently without batting an eyelid. And we may even think that things have changed. But this could merely be to exchange an active interruption of our connection to our internal reality for an even worse interruption of our connection to external reality, etc. I mean which is better - mild anaesthetic or deep self-delusion?

It also strikes me that you may not really grasp the reality of the forms of 'repression' we are referring to, or understand that such possibilities even exist. But this is a fundamental principle of modern psychology, and the foundation of almost all of the major insights associated.

There are lots of potentials for this sort of activity, and almost all of them are healthy in origin. First of all there are many internal functions that do not need to be consciously accessed by waking awareness, such as how fast your heart beats, or the digestion of food. Then there are functions that might start off conscious and then gradually become unconscious over time - like looking in your rear vision mirror occasionally whilst driving. And then there is the ability to delay need fulfilment, which in certain contexts can itself be just about as important as the basic ability to fulfil need in the first place.

Consider the ability to hold your breath as you swim under a log, or to not piss yourself on the train. The ability to delay certain functions can represent a distinct survival advantage in certain situations. And this level might be called 'suppression'.

At a far deeper level, however, it is also possible for the same processes to occur in a way that does not involve any residual conscious awareness at all - which is where we see 'repression'. In this instance the vast unconscious is actively withholding awareness of certain realities, and thereby keeping the 'conscious self' in the dark.

Does that sound ominous? Sure, it really might be. But just as often it can be helpful, or even vital. It is also very costly, however, if only because it runs directly against the natural flow of a conscious system, which is intrinsically open and aware. In a perfect world, we would obviously not be keeping secrets from ourselves.

So anyway, we might step back from it all now that we have the basic outlines sketched out, to view it all from various different vantage points.

One other thing worth grasping about this situation is that the needs in question (the ones causing all the emotional storm) do not actually exist. Therefore, if we suspend all the functioning that is seeking to fulfil those needs, we do not actually suffer as a result. At least, we do not suffer from a lack of need fulfilment. But we do suffer from having a great deal of our normal and healthy internal functioning distorted and suspended and subverted etc. So it is very strange.

I mean, if we repressed our very real 'need for water' in the same way, we might suffer some interesting subjective tensions associated. And this repression would be possible, merely by hypnotising someone, etc. They might then set about living as if they don't need water, in just the same way as we live as if we are not going to die. But in this instance - even if we experienced no thirst consciously - we would eventually get very sick indeed as we began to suffer from dehydration. And before too long, we would die. But in this instance, when we banish the reality of death, as well as our need to survive it, we experience no biological consequences whatsoever, if only because surviving death is not something we ever evolved to do.

Remember what we addressed above regarding the connection between the higher aspects of this beautiful system (conscious subjective experience) and the deeper level transactions they represent - it is all about the underlying realities of life at the end of the day. So if a great deal of activity is occurring at a surface level (emotional and mental turmoil) but if none of that relates to anything real at a deeper level of the system, then there is definitely something very wrong.

Several other things also become clear once you begin to see this underlying pattern more fully. First of all, that it is structurally defined in terms of how seriously damaging it is. You only need to understand that the functions that generate the 'explosive crisis' produced whenever you bring the 'deeply felt reality of personal self' together with the 'imminent reality of personal death' are all normal and healthy in nature. The context of this crisis may contain certain fundamental errors or delusional fabrications - but the conscious level of experience does not know this. And so the entire situation can only be taken at face value, with the result being a kind of spiralling dilemma (conscious), which then collapses into a deadlocked impasse (unconscious). And what this means is simply that it always weighs a certain amount, so to speak, as defined by the mere nature of the systems associated. It is, essentially, equally serious in all cases, as well as universally present in all people.

This is another factor that has allowed it to remain so obscured - we do not (often) see examples of people free of this hidden burden. Which is to say - you might naturally claim that something this significant couldn't possibly have remained concealed, not if it was everywhere, and in everyone. But actually quite the opposite is the case. It has remained concealed precisely 'because' it is everywhere, and in everyone. And these aspects are important, if only because this event is absolutely huge, and absolutely everywhere, which certainly places some onus on us here to explain how it could possibly have been so profoundly overlooked. It is an issue that we will come back to later on, but for now we can at least touch on a few lesser points as they pop up along the way.

It must be quite mild, then? If everyone has it? But once again this belies the truth of the situation, which is that it is an absolutely devastating event that runs the entire gamut from the deepest internal experience to the broadest external reality. It is a very powerful emotional and psychological force - so powerful that most people live their entire lives well within the unspoken boundaries it defines for them, which is why they seldom experience its full force.

But by far the single most important factor to grasp about this situation is that the entire struggle associated - along with all the various machinations and manipulations involved - is entirely unconscious in nature. It all occurs far upstream in a functional sense, far above the conscious experience of life, like pollution pouring into a river deep in the jungle - making it impossible to separate or remove once it reaches the ocean of common waking experience.

What we are explaining here has absolutely staggering implications if it is true, and it also completely explains all the great mysteries of human life - both individually and collectively - which would normally result in at least some degree of natural interest. But what's the bet you have found yourself shaking your head, and pulling away. It's even possible that this impulse is quite strong. And in light of that 'general feeling' about it you might be tempted to conclude that it's all just a big load of horse shit. "Bullshit!" I hear you roar... And yet, if it was indeed true - and if there really was a very profound process of active denial that was animating a huge amount of our own actions and feelings - then what response would you expect, in that case?

So - it must be false because we haven't seen it before? Where could it possibly have been hiding? The simple answer to that question is obvious: It is false. But the simple answer to that question may be just as obvious in the opposite direction: It is true.

Anyway, are you telling me that you can't remember all of this happening? That's right. And why is that? I mean, this is by far the most dramatic event you ever experienced, and you can't even remember it?

And there we have it. This is the big secret. The greatest secret of all time is that you are currently keeping this great secret from yourself. And this is why you will already be squirming a little as you read this - it is not because all of this is bullshit. It is because it is all true.

So - "No, no, no! This can't be right!" I hear you saying... but if so, then that's only the very thing we are talking about here. You will, of course, deny all of this immediately. Or simply ignore it and walk away. But we will get to all of that stuff later also.

Essentially, the event we are discussing does not like to be poked, and in particular it is allergic to conscious awareness. So for now, if you are having some kind of 'reaction' to any of this, please feel free to simply shelve that toxic reaction for the moment, perhaps filing it under the heading of: "direct proof for the existence of a heavily loaded process of active denial and avoidance in myself".

Anyway, we need to get back to the event itself. Where this leaves us is with two opposing emotional agendas - our natural and normal and healthy process, and then another entirely hidden but very powerful army of unconscious drives that have a very different purpose again.

In particular, one agenda is based in biology and history, the other based in the subversion of the first - with a very specific objective associated with it. The two events then exist in dynamic balance - one trying to break free of the slippery grip, with the other moving rapidly to counter any attempt, and in the process forever remaining unseen. That is its very purpose, so it cannot ever be seen to be hiding something, for that would blow the whole game. So the result, from a conscious perspective, is a constant stream of mysterious impulses and tendencies, which - if challenged - will transform into some other equally mysterious drive, and eventually the path of least resistance will win out. Sooner or later the conscious self just gives up in utter exhaustion, and accepts one or other of the various bad options available to it. The semi-collapsed, emotionally frustrated, and utterly confused state that results from this is what we call the 'typical human life'.

From our analogy above, this means we have one part of ourselves that is forever trying to recover and fully extend our natural zone of awareness and feeling at both ends - inwardly and outwardly - whilst at the same time we confront some strange and slippery process that is forever trying to shrink or limit that bubble, or otherwise frustrate its natural reach. And because that process is intrinsically unconscious in nature, the waking self can never be made aware of any of this. It is very frustrating, and incredibly perplexing, but once you see the particular dynamics associated with all of this, suddenly the enigmatic human psyche begins to make a lot more sense.

The foundation here is not that complicated, but it does take a while to get your head around it, especially once the implications start to creep into your mind. So let's see if we can capture this part here once again, just to recap and consolidate everything we have collected.

You might consider this: What causes unhappiness?

Of course we could talk for hours here about the nature or even the purpose of happiness, and all the things that can disturb or disrupt or limit it, but for the purposes of this discussion we are speaking very very generally and simplistically, so we will zoom right out.

Hopefully you will agree that both happiness and unhappiness are generated by your basic emotional response to your situation - which is to say: between what you desire, and what you receive.

This is pretty simple, right? But here's the thing - in almost all instances what you desire is considered sacrosanct and immutable. By and large we only have the option of following or resisting what we desire - not the option to significantly alter (or even understand) what we desire. Indeed, for most people the nature and origin of what they desire remains somewhat mysterious and enigmatic, but now we are beginning to see why.

What would happen, then, if you somehow got hold of a remote control for a typical person - in particular, one that had the ability to generate very powerful 'extra desires'? What power would this give you over that person? Well, to begin with it would obviously give you the ability to steer their actions to some degree, as they began to navigate life differently based on these altered emotional realities - in just the same way as a river will change course based on the shifting shape of a landscape over which it is flowing, as we outlined above. But that would only go so far, right? I mean what if you decided to generate a strong desire to run off the edge of a cliff? Or give all their money away? Or to invade Ukraine?

In almost all cases good judgement would prevail. But what would this 'refusal to follow desire' mean emotionally? What would happen once the person stopped simply submitting to your crazy and arbitrary desires? What if you simply turned the dial to maximum and tried to make the person fly?

In that case the outcome is quite simple. Unfulfilled desire is effectively identical to unhappiness. They are not only related in some way - they are the same thing. That's what unhappiness actually is.

I also need to be clear - we are talking about legitimate desire here. After all, how could you tell the difference? You think you could? No. This is the entire point of what we are talking about here. From the perspective of normal waking consciousness, a desire is a desire is a desire. No differentiation is possible at that level. All you can do is connect with that desire, and follow it - or refuse to do one of those things, or both.

Which means this: the ability to generate desire is 'effectively identical' to the ability to generate unhappiness, to at least whatever degree the desires in question cannot be completely fulfilled. And even if any such 'surplus' desires could be fulfilled, doing so would involve actions that would otherwise be both unnecessary and costly, which would itself diminish happiness to some degree.

The question now becomes - What generates your desires normally? And can that process actually be trusted? How would you know if something had hold of your remote control in this regard? And I mean, if something like that was happening, wouldn't that make a certain amount of sense in relation to what you experience in life, generally? Wouldn't that make sense of the world we see around us?

This is why the typical person has remained something of an enigma. It is not only because of the great leap in imagination that set us apart from all other animals so suddenly - but because the result of this big shift was the almost complete obliteration of the integrity of our primary emotional landscape. It has all been so messed up by the addition of this secondary activity, which results in so much mysterious confusion that the relatively simple nature of the underlying natural functioning has been very difficult to discern amongst all the other noise.

This is what the emerging models here bring to light so fully - all of a sudden there is a dynamic anatomy to explain the typical person and what is really going on. Once you realise there are actually two things occurring, and how each of them is working, as well as what the associated goals of each

are, suddenly the entire mess resolves back from total and messy confusion into a kind of clockwork clarity.

For the individual, then, we see a terrible bind. They are born into a situation in which they are suffering from a kind of existential death grip, almost as if they are being wrestled by a giant squid - except in this instance they cannot see the monster, and neither can the culture they are immersed in. I mean - What squid? This is all they hear as they struggle and strain against its mighty embrace. And the very nature of its dynamic anatomy means that even when they manage to peel one limb off, another one will simply squirm in to immediately replace it. And this is the true origin of the cyclic and damaging patterns of negative behaviour that people find themselves subject to, and why one pathology will so often be replaced by something else equally bad.

Everyone is looking in the wrong direction, and focusing on the wrong things - downstream things, when the true problem is well upstream from all of that. Which is the final crux of the issue here I suppose, and the whole point of making all of this plain: If the problem arises upstream, then the solution can only be found upstream. And if all our major issues are actually rooted in this singular overarching cause, then nothing you ever do downstream from that will ultimately have any impact on them. For the most part you will be forever looking from the problem, rather than at it, as the very motivations that are moving you are themselves expressions of the problem itself. So it's like when the mafia own the police - who can you call? Which means that even if you do manage to have any significant effect on the giant squid that has hold of you, all this will do is displace the distortion into some other area of life that is just as bad, or worse. And the very fact that you are taking such a narrow view will often mean that you never even notice this effect.

And remember, it is not as if some people know this, and others do not. Nobody knows this. And they don't know it not because anyone is hiding it from them - but because they are actually hiding it from themselves. The blind leading the blind, etc.

This might even be worth clarifying here once again, just so that you don't miss the point of it: This even controls your actions to a large degree, and its purpose in doing so is to achieve something you can never become conscious of, and otherwise to itself remain totally concealed. So this squid is not only invisible, but it controls your eyes. It directs when to look, and when to look away. And for as long as you simply submit to those impulses - it remains fully in charge of you. For as long as we refuse to look, it wins.

We are then all left spinning in space, not knowing which way is up, or even what is real, and can only grope our way toward happiness based solely on what we feel - feelings that are themselves totally fucked up in a really dynamic and slippery way. It is a total mess, both individually, and collectively. And the result is that we accumulate mountains of external resources, in our never ending hunger to solve this inner crisis, but that we nevertheless remain well short of the happiness we somehow know we should be enjoying. We lose ourselves in experiences, leaping from one distraction to the next, and in the process become human doings, rather than human beings.

Welcome to life on Earth.

We have come to live in a world where self is the ultimate reality, death is the ultimate fiction, and where confusion and struggle abounds. It is a puzzle that has no obvious answer, if only because nobody is even looking at the problem. This 'not looking' is actually the very nature of the resulting state, and for as long as that remains the dominant existential stance people assume, this confusion and conflict will never be resolved.

Part Five - The Common State

At the macro level we see this micro situation expressed and amplified almost exactly, with a similarly bewildering and conflicted human civilisation. The tyrannical and deluded 'self' is running amok in the human individual, and in just the same way the tyrannical and deluded human mass is running amok all over the planet. And just as different aspects of ourselves are in constant tension and conflict, just so the many different elements of the human collective are doing the same. The entire thing is forever restless, all of it merely reflecting the restlessness in the common human individual.

The entire world is confused and conflicted, it has no idea where it is going, or how to get there - just like the typical individual. And all of this is because the true problem exists - and can therefore only be resolved - at a level above where people are working to address their assumed issues.

The foundations of this insight rest in grasping the detailed functional anatomy associated with there being two things going on, rather than just one, and that it is all occurring at a strictly unconscious level. And what you see, once you truly grasp this event, is a kind of impossible knot, a puzzle that can never be solved - not in external transactional terms, and neither by any obvious internal manipulation. It means that there is literally no way for the 'conscious self' to win this game, if only because there is a certain intrinsic and irresolvable tension built into the resulting functional struggle.

I mean, put it this way -

If something happened to seriously adjust the foundations of a person's behaviour, and if the resulting alteration was then fused completely with the underlying original pattern, and if all of that was done in a way that made sure the entire event was kept strictly away from conscious awareness - what would the result be?

The result, in that case, would be a new (altered) emotional foundation. And would the conscious 'self' know about this, if it had occurred? No, of course not. That would be the entire point.

This is the bedrock here. The average person we see around us, as well as the one we see in the mirror, is not a natural human being. That is the subverted version - the one that has been taken over by a kind of psychological parasite. Well, that might be somewhat harsh language I suppose, but it basically fits the picture.

More importantly, how would you know? It is implied that this underlying event is being maintained permanently by an extremely active and pervasive process of personal avoidance, and also that this emotionally loaded aversion is going to be naturally expressed in the way we arrange things socially. So if you were forever looking away from this particular thing personally, and likewise if nothing whatsoever in culture ever pointed to it, or even had a name for it, and if you had no recollection of the events in question ever happening - apart from some vague yearning for something more - then how would you know?

This is a key element of what we are explaining here. This intrinsically concealed nature, along with the perplexing functional conflict it generates, is also expressed at a collective level as a profoundly pervasive and very active 'cultural blind spot'. No roads lead to this particular Rome, or you might put that the other way around I suppose - all roads lead only and forever away from it. And this aversion is far more active than you might ever suspect, which becomes quite obvious if ever you make the mistake of pointing to it in any public way.

This pattern explains the common person, and it also explains the world as a whole, in particular it explains why nothing ever seems to make much of a difference in relation to the very deepest problems we face, at both levels. It explains the true origins of those problems on the one hand, whilst also explaining why those issues remain so profoundly intransigent. Which is staggering when you think about it, because what it means is that the very deepest and most penetratingly internal of issues every person is dealing with in life also happens to be the exact same problem we are all confronting at the broadest and most collective external level.

The problem is in here, with the human heart, not out there with the planet as a whole. We rarely assume that the two issues might be originating from the same root issue. People will blame all sorts of things for their general sense of malaise, but they will never actually point their finger in the right direction, if only because the true culprit is not even visible. It does not even have a name in culture by which you might refer to it. I mean, for the last few pages I have been calling it a 'squid'. What does that tell you? It is ridiculous. And groups of people with one surface level form of this 'disease' (one possible limb of this polymorphous octopus) will look at other people with a different form and imagine that they are some sort of alien species, when actually they are all suffering from the exact same thing. Everyone is so sure that their way is the right way, their creed is the right creed, that they totally fail to see that it's all basically the same shit, just in different packaging.

So we have not only failed to even identify the true issue we are facing, but we also very often end up with completely different methods of managing this screwed up situation. We even have wars between groups of people who have two different methods of 'coping' - each side absolutely convinced that the other side are heretics, when actually they are both equally right (or equally wrong) depending on your viewpoint.

It is all downstream remedies, not upstream cures. It is all shallow, myopic, and circular - and because of this, it is ultimately ineffective. The entire world remains impotent, blind, and crippled. And if you don't think so then that is only because you are so immersed in that bullshit that you can no longer smell it. In that case you have completely lost sight of how things could be, how things were meant to be, before the fall. In that case you've been drinking the kool aid, as they say. And good luck with that. It is possible, after all. It is an available path, but at what cost? How high do you need to fly to rise above those clouds? And when will you ever land? But for anyone who can see through that thin veneer to appreciate the actual human reality beneath all of that puff and bluster, a sobering and very bitter reality is all too clear. People are suffering to a far greater degree than they like to let on. They are all struggling, one way or another, and this is the point here - a very large amount of that suffering is entirely artificial and unnecessary.

So just like the individual will spend a great deal of time and energy chasing their tail in a completely futile manner, the way we tend to approach our collective issues can tend to make the same basic mistake: It is all targeting surface level manifestations of a far deeper problem, and thereby perpetually missing the mark. As indicated above - you cannot take the pollution out of a river as it flows into the sea. You need to get your boots on and go upstream if you really want to address such issues. And hopefully you can see where this is going.

The simple failure to collectively travel upstream in this one particular sense is why the world remains in a circular loop of conflict and confusion - and why the individual is not much better off. It is because - from the point of view of both culture and conscious awareness - the actual problem we are suffering from is both completely invisible and yet still extremely powerful and dynamic. Indeed, it remains invisible precisely because of how incredibly powerful and pervasive it is, which is even more weird once you see it, and then suddenly realise that it was standing right in front of us all along, resting in

plain sight. The entire loop of suffering only persists because nobody ever gets their boots on to head upstream into the jungle of the unconscious, to take a closer look at what's really going on. Because if you do that, and if you do get to see the true nature of the situation, you also get to see that it really wouldn't take more than a few people to poke even a tiny hole in that great dam and thereby begin an epic process of change that would soon be completely unstoppable. But for as long as people are fat and lazy (intellectually, emotionally, philosophically speaking..) and only want to lay about on the comfortable beach of life - watching that river pollute the ocean of our collective destiny - it is basically the perfect trap.

Even what we are doing here will confront it, sometimes far more powerfully than you imagine. And this is why I offered a warning at the beginning. I am basically seeking to make you aware of a process that is presently operating within your own seething unconscious, right now, and that has the sole task of keeping this very fact away from conscious awareness. So if you are already wondering how something this dramatic could ever have remained so profoundly hidden, then there is your main answer. How are you feeling as you listen to all this?

We have to assume here that you will already be suffering from quite a strong desire to return to this 'not looking' state as soon as possible. Is that right? If so then that's totally normal. I mean, if that wasn't true then what we are saying here either isn't true, or I am really bad at explaining it. Just be aware that this riptide of aversion will blow over in time, as you get to see it all in more clarity and detail. It won't always be like this. That's just what the water feels like when you first jump in. You only need to persist for a while and you will discover something completely different again - like pushing through some spiky brambles only to eventually emerge into a secret garden you didn't even know existed.

Here we see the question again, one that always comes up in relation to something so incredibly grand in scope and depth - surely we would have noticed this? But no, that is the whole point. The very nature of the event implies that we were picked up and then put down again exactly where we were - or so we imagine. And that we didn't really notice much difference. But since then nothing has ever been the same. We just can't see it, that's what it means for a process to be geared away from conscious awareness - it means that the entire event gets placed upstream as a cause rather than downstream as an effect.

We are completely blind to it, then, even though it is standing right in front of us, and also accounts for most of what we feel, not to mention most of what we do. So every picture that has ever been painted of the typical human state has included this added event.

Partly this conflation is also because of all the resulting mess. The unconscious struggle that ensues is so incredibly complex and dynamic that being able to separate the natural from the added has become impossible - to the point where the natural is not even generally recognised or isolated at all. There is just this big jumbled mess of sensitivities and motivations, and we call that humanity. It is as if the waters have become so muddy with all this unconscious wrestling that we can no longer see our true nature - not least because we don't even know we have lost it! By and large it is only because we have so comprehensively forgotten how things were meant to be that we can manage to bear the way things have ended up.

I mean, the resulting situation is actually far worse than most people realise, or will ever admit. And to achieve any kind of stable happiness in the grip of that event is an amazing feat. Self esteem is generally based on your own ability to meet your own emotional needs, which in this instance becomes virtually impossible, so to achieve that in any sense is often the result of a lifetime of desperate effort, and just as often remains tenuous even then. And this is why we cluster together in

mutually reinforcing chants: "I am awesome! We are awesome! It's all awesome!" And within that myopic bubble of collective self delusion, people actually manage to live their lives, apparently oblivious to the fact that the world is burning, or even what is actually going on within them. And when you do finally see what people are actually up against, the achievement of any sort of stable self esteem really is an amazing feat. People are frankly incredible. It's just that they don't have all the relevant information, that's all.

Do you remember those early video game systems that had a cartridge or cassette that was plugged into the top of the console, and which contained the entire game architecture? All of the programmed features and limitations were contained within this 'upstream' unit, and nothing you ever did within the game itself could ever fundamentally alter or affect anything at that level. So if the software was corrupted, or if your character could never win based on the way the game had been scripted, then you were totally screwed.

The question in our case is - What is our natural emotional landscape? What is the program we are supposed to be running? What was the original 'cassette' like, before this 'altered cassette' was plugged in upstream from conscious experience?

It is all coming from this same originating source, and it all remains so mysterious and intractable because nothing you ever do downstream will affect this upstream cause. Indeed, nothing you ever do will even make you aware of this event. After all, how would you possibly become aware of it if you never see any examples of people who do not have this secondary activity running riot within them? How would you ever gain incremental insight in a situation where every thread of your living psyche is steering you away from such awareness at every turn, and where the culture you are immersed in does not even have any language with which to articulate such concepts?

Separating these two events requires a certain anatomical complexity. But that anatomy can itself only ever be divined in the wake of separating the two events somehow. So it is a chicken and the egg situation, where the essential information is completely missing. Which makes the emergence of such insight a little like looking for a flame in the middle of a monsoon. It just isn't going to happen, not naturally anyway. And this is where we have been stuck.

The problem of 'collective blindness' occurs due to the ubiquity of the issue, and how this has remained so concealed. So it is a real mind bender. This added activity within us causes so much confusion and mess that the original healthy and normal functioning is not even obvious anymore. I mean, did you ever see a video of an octopus swimming along and then cling onto a rock - and immediately change colour to become effectively invisible? It's like that in a sense, the affliction we are suffering from has a very firm grip on the way we function internally, but we can't see it. In some ways that is the whole point of it.

As indicated, the missing piece in this instance was not the answer, it was the question. We have consistently failed to penetrate our deepest problems to their final roots, and to thereby gain true power over them. And the result of this failure is everything we see. It's not good.

The true nature and depth and anatomy of the real problem was the big secret, and it turns out that it was not missing by accident - as you will see soon enough as we begin to drag it out of the shadows and into the light of collective awareness. I mean, you could write a Pulitzer prize winning book on this very subject, explaining in great detail - and with great authority - the foundational role that 'existential dread' plays in the formation of the average person's psychological reality, and you will still be completely ignored. Even 50 years later it will still be completely unknown in common culture (See - Ernest Becker: The Denial of Death). Or you could make a documentary film about that author, and

that book, arguably one of the best documentaries ever produced, and nobody will even have heard of it (See - Patrick Shen: Flight From Death).

What we are referring to here is the way we have constructed 'culture' as a means of recording and implementing a great many customs and conventions that actually have their roots in the shallow and circular management of a fundamentally screwed up situation, rather than gearing such collective action toward deep awareness or any kind of fundamental solutions. All the things we see now are merely remedies, not cures, and therefore never actually get to the true source of our problems.

We don't know this, however, so all of those 'life hacks' can become institutionalised and very strongly upheld as 'unassailable virtues'. People's entire lives are devoted to navigating the resulting complex dynamics, and all of common culture is dedicated to institutionalising the best of all resulting methods.

All of which are completely worthless if what I am proposing here is basically true. The whole lot, all of it. It's all junk, most especially because all of those shallow remedies actively prevent the emergence of the deeper level cure. It all overlooks the only thing that really matters, without which nothing else can ever possibly work.

The point is - the last thing anyone in that situation wants to hear is that all of that effort and history might have been for nothing, and that they may have just spent their entire lives walking down what is actually a dead end street. The whole idea is simply too dramatic for people to contemplate. It is just too deep of a shock, and too much of an adjustment, to consider that the entire foundation of their lives might somehow be critically flawed or lacking in one essential regard. They would literally need to start the whole process again - with an entirely new destination in a sense, using entirely new skills, and travelling through entirely new territory along the way.

But consider this also - what if everything we are discussing here turns out to be the single most important thing there is to know about being human, and being happy, and if we currently don't know it? Wouldn't that make some kind of sense out of the world we see around us, as well as what we see when we look in the mirror? And doesn't such a dark and pervasive possibility - if you can accept it - also immediately lay the groundwork for equally profound hope?

All of which returns us to the good news here, which is this: the bad news.

We didn't know. But now we do. So - what difference does this make?

First of all there is everything we have explained about the dynamic nature of this hidden event - all the various forms of it - as well as its basic purpose: concealment. And this immediately implies a degree of empowerment associated with nothing more than becoming more aware of it. The 'emotional landscape' of the average person does not currently match the pattern evolution provided us with. This is what we are saying. In its present state it represents two events, rather than one. And the resulting dynamic fusion of these two events - based on the outcomes each is seeking to maintain - defines the complex and enigmatic picture of human behaviour exactly. It also explains common human subjective experience. Basically, it explains the way we 'feel', and in particular how 'bad' a lot of people basically feel, so much of the time. And just knowing this is a big deal.

It all looks like a single seething mess only if you don't know what's actually going on. But once you do see it - that there are two distinct things going on, and especially how each of them works - suddenly the anatomy of each becomes quite plain. I mean, seeing all of this does not undo the struggle associated, but just seeing it does make a very big difference nevertheless.

Remember, these are the foundations of our own psyche we are talking about, so this sort of penetrating awareness can often provide direct and immediate transcendence over the events associated. It's like when the 'ugly duckling' finally understands she is a swan - nothing has changed, but suddenly everything is still very different nevertheless. Basically, if keeping important things away from conscious awareness is the reality you are discussing, then just knowing can be a golden ticket to freedom. And of all the things that might be known in that context, this is the mother load, the kingpin, the Holy Grail of all meaningful insights into the human situation. This is the big one, and it is also the one giant fish that - miraculously - nobody has managed to catch yet. What you are reading here is, to the best of my knowledge, the first time this has ever been captured in this way.

Think about it this way - if concealment is its only power over you, then if you become aware of it, to any degree whatsoever, you gain power. But beyond mere awareness as a whole, the true power comes with detailed awareness in particular. Because with that sort of anatomical detail comes direct transcendence and personal empowerment. Suddenly you have Kung Fu. This does not eliminate the issue, but if unawareness is the game, then gaining awareness at least means you are at least holding the ball suddenly, and that you also know which direction to run with it.

The other thing about this sort of awareness is that once you can see it in yourself, you immediately gain the ability to see it just as clearly in others also. And once again this can be both scary as well as interesting. You could certainly do a great deal of harm with this degree of insight, if you were, say, a con-man, for instance. But you can also do a great deal of good, which I suppose is the whole point of what we are doing here.

The point is, if the purpose of the entire event is to prevent us from knowing something, then just knowing changes everything. The underlying anatomy, once fully explored and elucidated, completely reframes the typical life, and the global situation, in a single stroke. It explains the futility and circular nature of typical change, at both levels. It explains the dynamic equilibriums we encounter as we seek to push things in a positive direction, as they mysteriously seek to push us back again. It explains how the individual problems and the collective problems are all paradoxically the very same thing. It provides the foundations for a million conundrums to not only be understood but also resolved.

Ultimately, the framework we see emerging here allows us to gradually deconstruct the typical experience of human life in a way that explains some of its most mysterious and problematic features. It gives us a pathway back out of the labyrinth, and a method by which we might once again begin to figure out which way is up, as we try to navigate our way toward some sort of balance between personal happiness and collective survival.

First of all it explains the shallow nature of common experience, by which I mean how little the average person manages to penetrate beneath the obvious surface of things in order to get at what is really going on, rather than what merely appears to be going on. In relation to any 'external' experience, the ability to look beyond the apparently simple surface structures and begin to grasp the far more complex underlying processes is perhaps the most fundamental leap in development anyone can make. And yet this capacity remains exceedingly rare.

Likewise, in relation to 'internal' realities we see an almost identical pattern - the willingness to delve deeper into the underlying complexities of your own apparent motives and conclusions is the very essence of self-awareness, and a very great step toward fundamental self empowerment. First, free your mind, etc.

Without this depth, in both directions, a person risks being completely lost and bewildered, like a cork on a stormy sea. In the deep, however, it is always calm. But yes, the deep is demanding. The cork

does not like the deep. So if it is going to go there, and stay there very long, then you will need to consciously push it under. Rational penetration of things is like a muscle that needs to become stronger based on effort, and practice.

We do of course see a certain amount of cultural support for this sort of depth, in both directions, but overall the climate is set strongly against it. Dumb and docile is a lot easier to manage and manipulate than smart and savvy. And as a result most kids will hit their teenage years with about the same amount of deeply penetrating understanding as a typical rock.

This teenager will then set about taking the helm of their life, with very little idea about what's even going on, apart from what everyone around them tells them is going on, or what they can glean from pop music or TikTok influencers. Of course they might get some insight from their parents, if only their parents weren't just the relics of a previous generation of the same sorry confusion.

So what remains? I will go where the wind blows me..

Which means what? "I will follow what I feel. I will do what my heart tells me. And it will take me home."

But will it? This is precisely what we have been explaining. It will not. I mean, it should, but in this instance that wind cannot be trusted. That's precisely what we are saying. And that's how sad this really is. In this situation it is not actually possible to feel your way to happiness. That compass has been set spinning, in a very particular way. Which does not mean that it is completely useless now, but it does mean that, if all you ever do is blindly follow it, then you will spend your entire life circling a very dark magnetic rock. The compass will keep telling you to go toward the rock, but the big waves and high cliffs will threaten to smash your little boat whenever you get too close. So in this situation if all you ever do is 'follow what you feel' then you will be forever stuck.

Like any good sailor, what you actually need to do is sail across the wind, and even sometimes directly into the wind, in order to get to somewhere more deliberately chosen as a desirable destination. This is what becoming an adult means. But what destination? And I mean, if I am going to override or at least delay what I feel like doing, then how can I then use my feelings to select something better? And if I don't have any deeper appreciation of what's really going on beneath the surface of life (or myself) then once again: how can I navigate? Which way is up?

If you now place all of this within a context where we have, as a species, removed ourselves almost completely from the 'natural and normal' human environment, we really begin to see how fully disoriented the typical young adult might be. For the most part any animal might always fall back on its basic instinctual drives and primal responses in order to steer it through a storm, but in our case almost all natural stimulus has been removed, along with all the social frameworks within which all those patterns evolved.

I mean, a child knows instinctively not to get too close to a river, or a snake. But what instinct does a child have regarding a road, or an electrical fitting? What instincts do we have for concrete, glass, or Twitter? What instincts do we even have for the typical nuclear family? None. That's the reason people cheat. Why? Because the nuclear family is a very recent cultural invention. We are forcing ourselves to conform to patterns of behaviour that actually have very little to do with those we biologically expect, based on millions of years of historical programming, patterns that worked just fine in order to get us here. But those have now been abandoned in favour of completely inhuman standards and norms, many of which were probably just the result of agriculture and industrialisation, if not invented by various power hungry Emperors and Popes. Either way, stripping people of their

natural instinctive birthrights is part of a pattern of dominance and control, and what deeper birthright could there possibly be than your own inbuilt tendencies and drives? What deeper power is there than the music that is built into your very bones?

This is a side issue in relation to the subject at hand, but in relation to all the possible causes of unhappiness we might see in modern life this remains a big one to acknowledge and get out of the way first. The world we have come to inhabit is not even remotely aligned with the deep tendencies we find emerging naturally within us.

We have been completely dislocated from our natural context by the formation of so called 'civilised' culture, and as a result severed our final link to primary reality. And in the wake of this tethering at some many levels we then spin freely, completely out of control, and suddenly life becomes almost entirely abstract and relativistic. Which is to say, you can then believe whatever you like, and do whatever you like, and want whatever you like - and it all means nothing except what you say it means. A fully post-truth existence. And in that state subjectively created reality can reign free. Indeed, for the most part you will struggle to tell the difference between actual reality and the vast majority of what you experience, which is actually just delusional fiction.

This radical dislocation at so many levels of reality at once is what has allowed us to fabricate a totally abstract sense of existence, with no grounding in anything natural or innate. And with this we see the final untethering of any connection to reality for most people as they grow up and seek to get their bearings in a world that now has no discernable connection to anything deeper, and this leaves them spinning in space, with only their feelings to guide them - but if only they hadn't been corrupted also.

And so it is that the vast majority of people fail to penetrate either their internal reality, or their external reality, in any kind of robust way - which leaves them completely vulnerable to the influence and manipulation of anyone with enough nous to tell a good story. There are then no rules except those defined by the arbitrary limits of interpersonal power dynamics, and the gutter politics of big business.

This is the world where entire generations of people can be led around by anyone with the right haircut. We no longer even know which way is up anymore, and that makes us weak, and docile. And it is within this tumbling gyroscope of an existence that people try to be happy.

After all, this is not to say that happiness becomes impossible in this situation. It is a lot more complicated and subtle than that. Happiness is not actually the target of this secondary subversive event, in many ways it is merely an innocent bystander. Indeed, if the unconscious could manage this subversive gymnastics without any impact on happiness it surely would, if only because impacting happiness is a totally obvious and noisy outcome, which sort of makes that byproduct one of the worst of all - sort of like a burglar banging loudly on garbage bins as they sneak about in the dark. It's not the best approach. And so it is with the way this activity goes about its business - the least impact on general well being is always the ideal being sought. It is just that this is rarely possible, not unless the person in question has very low personal integrity. Ignorance really is bliss in this sense, which also accounts for the whole 'genius borders on madness' hypothesis.

It is basically the higher levels of integrity that represent the most threat to this subversive concealment, and so to whatever degree someone was put together only very roughly, or poorly, then the easier it will find this concealment to be.

There are actually lots of ways to achieve some stable degree of happiness in this situation. Because it is not that happiness has been banished. It is just a far more complex and sophisticated event than we were ever born to biologically expect. So complicated, in fact, that a great many people will fail to

ever achieve it. And why is this? Because they are weak or stupid? Quite the contrary, it is because their integrity is so powerful that it remains pretty much impossible to suppress or subvert - or perhaps because they simply refuse to compromise themselves to the degree required to achieve any kind of stable equanimity.

As I say, there is not just one way - there are many. In some sense it is a situation that shuffles the human deck so as to place a very particular type of person at the top of the pile - a very different person to the one evolution would naturally have defined.

And very often these different groups of 'winners' will end up competing with each other as they set out to espouse their 'winning formula', or their own special framework of understanding. Lots of people think they have it all sussed, and even more so as they surround themselves with others who are equally convinced of their own righteousness. The abject conceited smugness that results is often so repugnant and pernicious that entire gated compounds need to be constructed just to contain it.

Needless to say, such people don't actually have it nearly as sorted out as they might like to think. What they call happiness is not actually the real deal, and generally costs an enormous amount in terms of external resources compared to the real thing. It is an artificial form, an inflated form, a completely unnatural and unsustainable form of myopic personal self gratification. And at the top of that septic heap all you find an entire gaggle of cultural icebreakers for a tide of moral bankruptcy. And all of that might even make sense if all you ever saw was the narrow and shallow view of life, where there is no ultimate direction that is up, and where values are completely arbitrary. Which is to say - a world where a leopard skin bag is a lot more valuable than an actual leopard.

The massive excesses of these 'cultural icons' allow us to feel less bad about our own milder excesses, and so we blow hot air up their assed like a balloon that in turn gives us lift. But in the real world, if everyone actually achieved that sort of 'ideal' lifestyle the entire planet would probably collapse in under a week. But once again, and precisely because so many of our cultural ideals are so persistently unattainable, we don't realise just how false and misleading they really are. It is sort of like a manipulated collective trance that can only be maintained by endless stimulated consumption and personal excess.

There is basically a cap on happiness. I mean, this is not just a vacuous statement, I'm sure you've seen the data. The fact that material success and happiness do not correlate beyond a certain point has several spurious explanations, but this paradigm offers a far more fundamental link. But it also points to the possibility of a great deal of potential happiness that has no connection to material success whatsoever, and we will get to that shortly. It turns out that all of the artificially stimulated excess we might engage in based on a high personal income will never even come close to producing the sort of naturally happy state we were born to biologically expect, and that we can all have that for free, without destroying the planet in our mad rush to avoid some creeping sense of personal despair.

As a result, what we see now is a completely surreal existence, made all the more kaleidoscopic by us not even understanding that so much of what we experience is not actually real at all, but purely the result of freewheeling thought processes that have been dislocated entirely from primary reality in many instances, and fed by perpetual cultural fantasies. We are living in the kind of artificially generated nightmare of our own brilliant construction.

It is all an impossible, invisible, dilemma. Nothing works. That is the final summary here. Nothing you do downstream can affect something that is originating upstream.

In the end it is like having a wild tiger in your house. You can work out all sorts of strategies to prevent yourself from being chewed up, or you can live your entire life hiding under the sofa, but in the end it's never going to be the same as essentially not having a tiger in your house.

Basically, common happiness is only for those who can stomach the compromises associated. But when you see what is really going on, and especially what is presently holding back a tsunami of authentic happiness, that sort of self congratulatory backslapping seems only bizarre and outrageous. The whole thing represents a sort of humanity test in this sense, assuming that it is all basically accurate. There are those who are totally convinced that 'this is it - this is all we get - so we may as well just make the best of it'. And then there are others who remember, and who know just as surely that 'there is something wrong here - this is not it - there is definitely something else'. But to be well adapted to the sick and sickening world we see now is basically identical to being just as powerfully misaligned with the healthy world to come.

Anyway, if we look at the resulting state, what we see is a situation that is artificial in many ways. Not artificial in any sort of unnatural sense, but still aberrant or strangely distorted in a completely unnecessary way. And the results of this distortion, first of all being very powerful, and secondly being universally present - on top of its general invisibility - is a personal experience that is almost completely disconnected from any sense of biological expectation.

Of course, a great many will see this basic view as being so fundamentally pessimistic that it couldn't possibly be reconciled with their own basic experience of life - which is pretty good. But actually the main problem with this entire view turns out to be quite the opposite, as we will see in the next section. It is so fundamentally hopeful that it can really only be assumed to be completely deluded, in that everything we are examining - if it can be faced - can also be removed.

Anyway, that is the world we see. And nobody even knows. This is the life we live. Our kids are lost, the planet is dying, and the very best we can do is throw antidepressants down our throats and have another stiff drink. Or pray to some non-existent God. It is hard to say which one is more bleak. And then we ask our children to adapt to this artificially constructed world as if it was totally normal and desirable, as well as to adopt all the various patterns of behaviour and virtue we prescribe. We ask them to compromise as we ourselves were compromised. We ask them to swallow the bullshit we ourselves swallow on a daily basis, and wonder why they can't. We ask them to lie to themselves in the same ways we do, and to value the crap we value, and all the while they are drowning right before our eyes.

So who is right? The kids are always right. We are totally fucked up in ways we don't even recognise let alone do anything about. It all returns us to the question we started with at the top. Is there a problem? Is this what we were born to expect? Or is there something else? Is everything basically okay, or not? Can we just relax? Or is there something we desperately need to change first?

Yes. It's all true. Every one of these questions can be answered both ways, depending on where you are standing. It is true that fundamentally everything is okay. And always will be. But it is equally true that there is a very big problem, and that if you do not solve that problem at its primary origin then you will never be truly happy. Not to mention that if you keep throwing all of your very expensive 'remedies' at this aching existential pain then the planet will only last another couple of decades before the result is some sort of cascading ecological collapse.

We come back to our earlier metaphor again here when we consider whether there really is a problem: the mad person fighting off a swarm of imaginary bees. The entire world is like this. And so if you are asking if the bees are real, then no. But if you are asking if there is a problem, then yes. A big

one. Because all that thrashing and bashing really is causing a huge amount of damage, not to mention all the very real stress associated with imagining you are in an existential fight for your life.

All of that can be ended. It is true that the bees cannot be removed, because the bees were never there in the first place. But the idea of the bees, that is a real thing, and that really can be removed entirely, permanently, and with very dramatic consequences.

Part Six - Something Else

So what are we talking about? What is the elephant we are gradually creeping up on?

It's really not that complicated in essence, but the implications overall turn out to be just so epic that it is not easy to capture what is being proposed at first, if only because it suggests a possibility that is completely unprecedented in all of recorded human history. It literally suggests a possibility for very dramatic personal change that will inevitably become available to all people, everywhere, all at once. And this is the thing - if people can't really grasp the nature (or even the existence) of the problem, then the scale and depth of the solution will always remain beyond their grasp. And that is only individually, so when you add the whole collective aspect - with how the entire prospect might very rapidly roll forward - it all starts to just look like a blur.

The point, I suppose, is that people won't need to understand it. That won't matter at all in any downstream sense, which is sort of the power of what is being proposed. It will only be a courageous and dedicated few who will need to venture forth and explore all the deeper anatomy of the underlying events, and thereby extract from all that various insights that will then be implemented in the form of practical applications. But we will try to sketch an outline here regardless, just to give you some idea of the overall possibility being discussed.

As we indicated earlier, perhaps think about it this way: Your computer gets a software virus. This is not that unusual, right? And what do you do next?

You employ an antivirus software package, and then reboot your computer. Simple.

Once again, I will try not to labour this metaphor too much here, but it is remarkably apt in certain regards. After all, the brain is what? It is a computer. We covered this earlier. And instincts and emotions are what? They are organic algorithms.

This is not a metaphor, this is what the brain actually is. Except in our case we have the added factor of subjective consciousness.

So think about that scenario, except this time imagine that a computer was conscious. What might a 'self aware' desktop computer experience regarding such a transition, from one state to another? What would it 'feel like' to be all conflicted and screwed up by some malicious virus, and then to be 'miraculously' restored back to its normal state? After all, the computer would have no way to control or even become aware of the virus, right? That's what makes it a virus - it cannot, from the inside, do anything about it - or even see it. So from the point of view of any subjective self observation, the afflicted computer would simply experience such a virus as a confusing and bewildering series of bizarre and absurd conflicts and tendencies, a sort of uncontrollable and invisible subversion. Some of the time things would work perfectly well, but at other times things would happen for no reason, or wouldn't work at all.

What would it 'feel like', then, for such a computer to have that complicated affliction removed based on some kind of external intervention, such as the deployment of an antivirus package?

It would be a sudden and completely unexpected revolution, right? Especially if the virus had always been there, right from the start, for as long as the computer could 'remember'.

This metaphor expresses three very important elements of what is being proposed here.

- Firstly, a complex and yet completely invisible problem exists.
- Secondly, that this concealed activity can be entirely removed - thereby producing a dramatic and unexpected shift in the way everything works.
- And thirdly, that this great potential does not represent any kind of upward development.

The second and third points here maybe need a little more explaining, because they are very important. Consider the computer metaphor - it is obviously implied merely by the term 'software virus' that a computer that happens to be suffering from such would not be functioning 'normally'. And even if every single one of a certain model of computer came with such a bug, the same would still be true. The very nature of the situation defines this.

The same is true of the context we have defined. Because the 'added' event is not intrinsic or necessary, it is implied that it is separate and distinct, which in turn implies that it might be functionally removed. And not only does it imply that doing so would not cause any harm, it hints at the possibility of very great good that might result.

Anyway, we will obviously address this 'removal' aspect going forward here, alongside what that is going to demand from us in the first instance. But for now we can quickly address that third point above, and what I said about this shift not being developmental in nature.

What does this even mean? For the most part advancements in human wellbeing are assumed to be 'developmental' - which is to say they involve upward complexity and skill etc, higher achievement of some kind.

This is how we have come to view almost all significant positive shifts in human growth or potential - they are all in the direction of 'becoming more' somehow. This is how we conceive all of the so-called 'highest' human 'achievements'.

If basic human development was the equivalent of ABC etc, and then the next level up was words, and above that sentences, then we naturally assume that the greatest of all possible shifts must be some kind of ecstatic poetry or prose. We always think in terms of caterpillars to butterflies, buds to flowers, eggs to chickens, etc. The emergence of higher order complexity out of lower order complexity is always our default understanding of significant positive change, perhaps if only because that's what life itself actually is. But what if this is not the case at all in this particular instance, and what if knowing this changes everything?

In this case all of that is turned on its head due to something very important having been overlooked about the situation we are already in. And this is what makes this a paradigm shift: we are not in the situation we thought we were in, and our options are - therefore - not actually what we thought they were. The caterpillar is actually infected with a huge parasite, and whilst becoming a butterfly might be amazing, that is not the greatest single change it might experience based on what its current circumstance actually is, if only because that parasite will afflict the butterfly version even more dramatically.

The result of all this is quite simple: there is only one final and secure solution to our true and most essential problems, and no other so-called 'solutions' will ever make any lasting difference until that one core problem is addressed and undone. And this is what we mean by the claim that it - 'changes everything'. This alone gets right to the very root of our issues, and also does this in a way that offers

very real leverage. All other approaches fail on at least one of these two counts, and thereby leave us forever trapped in struggles we can neither fully comprehend nor fully overcome.

I realise that you will have no way to really appreciate what this means, but if you were made aware of all the detailed anatomy we are discussing you would now be starting to hyper-ventilate.

What it means is that the very anatomy of our situation contains a potential so incredibly dramatic that it is difficult to easily convey. It means that we didn't know there was a cure for our situation, because we didn't even know what our true situation was. It is the ultimate trap, and a terrible hole to be in - both individually and collectively - but it also means that our sorry situation has the ultimate surprise waiting for us. It is really only a bad situation if we don't know about it. And that has really been the only power of this 'virus', it is all about concealing itself, so now that we are beginning to drag it out into the light here the situation transforms entirely.

It is a lot to unpack. We are not where we think we are. Things are not as we imagine them to be. And where we might go from here is not something we can currently even comprehend. Happiness is not where we thought it was, and the territory we need to travel to get there is not anything we have prepared ourselves for. And all of this is both incredibly hopeful as well as devastatingly challenging at the same time.

It is a very strange situation. But this also explains the basic thrust of what is being proposed here. I am not offering you the solution to the greatest problem in human life. I am explaining that you do not even know what the greatest problem in human life actually is. Indeed, not only do you not know the details, but you have never even heard of it. It is completely outside your awareness, even though it is standing right in front of you, even now.

This brings us back to the computer metaphor, and the purpose of what follows, plus who all of this is for, and just how difficult this sort of thing can be for many people to even talk about.

It is a very simple but also very dramatic proposition, it completely reframes the typical human life by splitting what was assumed to be a single thing into two separate things. That's all. And in doing so, it is the only perspective that makes sense of the enigmas of both the common person and the world we see today - and also provides the basis for a staggeringly epic process of individual and collective change.

Importantly, that process of change has certain characteristics that set it apart from what we have generally come to assume possible: it can be initiated by just a few dedicated people, it will be completely unstoppable once it begins, and it will result in change that is permanent in nature. It will also singularly address both the deepest individual human struggle on the one hand, as well as our most tragic and resistant collective problems on the other. And it will do all of this, because the second thing it identifies and separates from all the rest that is happening within us is the source of both of those things.

It's not that complicated. Well, it's very complicated of course, but not in essence. But it is very hard to talk about, precisely because it is true.

All at once this explains who it is that we are ultimately aiming this at, and it explains the nature of what is being delivered. In the end it is the true nature and anatomy of the problem that has been overlooked, and not only slightly. The entire thing has remained entirely beyond our view, both personally as well as culturally. We don't even have a name for it. But once you see that, and I mean truly see it, the solution becomes completely obvious.

We also see in this computer metaphor who we are necessarily speaking to in the first instance here, and how this entire restaurant is only for chefs at this stage, not customers. This raw and unfiltered awareness is simply not for everyone - not yet.

If we go back to our analogy - There is a very big gap between the level of insight required to 'use' an antivirus package, and the level of understanding required to 'develop' one, right? I trust you agree. These two levels are completely different. And the same is true here.

So what do you need in order to develop an antivirus package? The demands are always the same in this regard: You need a few very smart people, you then need to isolate them away from all the really dumb people (so that they can collaborate constructively and in peace), and they need to be afforded whatever resources the task will demand. And, of course, you need to provide the complete anatomy of the virus, in some kind of essential form.

With this we begin to see the trajectory emerging here, and what this is all about. We see an epic event at one end, and the few who will ignite that event, at the other. And with that we begin to see just how ludicrous it all is in its basic outlines.

Part Seven - Zooming In

If this entire discussion hasn't started to move sideways for you at this point, at least a little, then you are probably a bit mentally unbalanced. Either that or you have not yet been able to fully compute the implications of what we have been suggesting above. Which would be unfortunate because we are about to more than double down on all the weirdness as we now gently lead this elephant up to the scales to weigh it. Honestly, if you think we have a mess to clean up now, wait until the end of this section.

So how would we weigh all of this up? By what measure? How do you even begin to scale the relative significance of things in general?

The only way to do this would probably be to examine what it all means for the typical individual, most especially in relation to what matters to them most. Which is to say - if something does not affect the typical individual in any meaningful way, in terms of its impact on either happiness or suffering, then it is probably not significant at all.

Consider the average person, then, especially in light of all that we have outlined above. What does all of this mean for them?

First of all it means that the situation they are actually in is not what they imagine they are in. And secondly it means that pretty much everything they are doing in order to find some degree of happiness is largely futile, or at least somewhat misdirected. They are standing there looking outward at life, and managing external events as best they can in order to produce the maximum degree of personal meaning or fulfilment, and doing everything they can to enjoy a situation, but all of that nevertheless remains mysteriously lacking in some deep but indefinable way.

They are simply misguided - like an orchestra that has been handed the wrong music. So it doesn't matter how well they play, because the issue is upstream from that, and fixing it requires a totally different sort of approach.

So what does the emergence of this insight do to shift all of this? How does it change things?

Well, first of all it explains the abject futility of the typical approach, and how simply 'becoming a better musician' means almost nothing, not if the issue lies with the music itself. And this explanation can itself provide immediate and quite profound relief.

"Oh, thank god, it's not me!" etc.

But what practical difference does this make, and where do we go from here?

The important thing about what this insight points to is where it is located, and that it is (generally speaking) completely hidden from view. It can also be viewed from several different angles - you can examine the problem, or you can focus on the solution; and you can see the whole thing in terms of the individual, or take a more collective vantage point. It is as if we have four quadrants to explore.

We can start with the problem, at the individual level -

Consider the average person's life in light of this basic insight, assuming for a moment that this is what's really going on beneath the surface of things everywhere. Think of any person, on any escalator, in any mall, anywhere in the world: what is the essential game they are playing? More importantly, look at their face - do you really think they are winning that game?

Or perhaps think of any person you see walking alone down a long and windswept beach: what do you imagine they are thinking about? What great puzzle are people trying to solve? And can it even be solved?

In this regard the basic map we have now established explains some very important things. Most centrally it explains that there is actually no solution to this core problem, not at any transactional level. The demands are simply grotesque, and cannot actually be fulfilled. The situation is fundamentally corrupt, like a customer at a restaurant asking for soup that is both hot and cold, but definitely not warm. And in this metaphor the waiter is the 'conscious self' - the one who acts to fulfil such distorted demands, but the one who is also punished as a result of failing in any regard.

The daily emotional agenda of the average person, that being all the things they need to do or acquire in order to maintain a degree of emotional equilibrium, is not actually natural or normal. And the fact that common culture so fully supports and validates this distorted pattern in countless convoluted ways does not make that any better - that's even worse.

Perhaps the easiest way to express it all is simply to examine what happens if you try to escape this bind. Look at the average person as they seek to either move forward toward some kind of summary happiness, or away from any particularly stubborn or resistantly negative situation. In an overwhelming percentage of cases we will see this process frustrated at both ends, often at the same time. A general failure to clarify and define what it is that we ultimately desire in any sort of summary sense very often leaves us languishing in a state that is just as generally afflicted with any number of mysteriously cyclic and invisible afflictions.

These recurring states can often be seen as self imposed somehow, although we will rarely figure out how or why, or be able to prevent ourselves from so persistently generating them. And the temptation is to imagine that we are simply not trying hard enough. But if we do try harder, what is the result? Just a more amplified version of the same dynamic, usually. So the whole thing is like running into a concrete wall - you can do it slowly, or you can do it fast, but fast isn't necessarily better, and this is why we become more timid over time. We call that accumulating caution 'wisdom', but it might more accurately be called 'defeat'.

It is only when you get to see the underlying dynamics in question that you begin to appreciate just how slippery and dynamic this all is, and just how many forms of subversion it all implicates as being part of this same event. We don't generally realise how vast it is, or just how fully we are submitted to its dictates - not until we threaten it in some way. Which is to say, it remains largely hidden not because of how small it is, but because of how vast and powerful it is, and because of just how fully we tend to unconsciously avoid waking this great sleeping beast.

The primary thing is that it defines an unwinnable game at the normal level of life, like an endless game of existential whack-a-mole, a sort of 'choose your poison' no-win scenario that allows for lots of options, but none of them very good ones. It is as if the natural pyramid of human happiness has had the entire top half removed.

This is what you see once you have the detailed anatomy required to make such connections in any meaningful way - the ability to trace the true origins of all the various emotional ailments and puzzles people struggle with, and to see that they all ultimately lead back to this singular originating nexus.

The common state is an invisible trap. Which is not to say that all is lost in that situation, far from it, but it does define a situation that is far from natural, and where the achievement of simple and profound happiness - our biological birthright - becomes a dramatically more complicated and sophisticated event. Like trying to hold a beach ball underwater, it is not impossible, but life does become hugely more complicated and costly.

Truly, it's not you. That's what it means. You remain trapped in a psychological bind that makes awareness of this particular issue almost impossible, as well as a surrounding culture that banishes such awareness even more strongly. So in many ways you remain innocent, but that is little consolation when you remain stuck inside that bind regardless.

So what about the solution at the individual level? -

Contrasting all of that, then, we see another entire path emerging here. Instead of forever searching downstream for a solution to an upstream problem, we see the possibility of addressing that issue at its true and final origin, and thereby eliminating the entire cluster in a single sweeping stroke. It is another whole option, defined in completely different terms, and requiring completely different skills. More importantly it requires cultural support, which at this point in history it does not have.

For millennia we have been refining and evolving our collective ability to reliably maintain our avoidance of the issue at hand, but we are only now just beginning any sort of collective willingness to confront and overcome it instead.

What matters are the options that this emerging insight provides for. What matters is the empowerment associated, as well as the way all of this remaps the entire territory of potential human experience so as to suddenly include an epic landscape we didn't even know existed.

All of which leads us to consider where this particular insight might fit amongst all the other various possibilities we might face in life. Think for a moment of all the so-called answers people are pushing at every turn, and just how many different basic life paths you might take. There is a huge diversity, right? But then consider this - how many of those possible styles of life even contain knowledge of this issue, let alone aim to functionally remove it in some realistic way? None. Then consider that it defines a situation that will forever remain completely intractable if not addressed at its only and actual root cause.

And what this means is that everything we see is - from this perspective - just one thing. Everything you know. The entire world. All of it. It is all one thing, the same thing: in particular it is all the avoidance of this singular other path.

This takes a bit to get your head around. What it means is that the obvious path indicated in the wake of what we have addressed above does not rest amongst all the other possibilities we already know. It does not relate to any, or compete with any, or basically fit alongside any.

If you put that the other way around, what it means is that the emergence of this particular path as a realistic option essentially eclipses all other options in a single sweeping stroke - like a kind of immediate checkmate move. Because on the one hand if what we have outlined above is basically

true, then nothing you ever do will ever significantly affect your most basic level of subjective wellbeing. It will forever remain fixed and suppressed and stifled at the level you presently find it.

Looking back the other way, what it also says is that if ever you did manage to both become aware of - as well as somehow address - this causal event in some kind of meaningful way, then all of a sudden your complete experience of life would suddenly be transformed, and you wouldn't even need to change a single thing for this to occur. Not externally.

The resolution of that causal root issue is basically a kind of panacea, the singular answer to a million age old questions.

More importantly, if what we outlined above is broadly correct then the happiness you presently experience is not the natural level you were born to biologically expect. It is a pale and dim and shallow forgery, at best. And the reason your situation will in this sense remain so forever stuck is because you are failing to address, or even become aware of, the one thing that holds the true balance of power in this context. You have completely overlooked the single most important defining factor in your entire existence, and nothing you ever do externally will ever touch that - not whilst it is holding the emotional steering wheel.

In the end it all represents a kind of existential puzzle that only has one true solution - an option that has thus far remained beyond our individual or collective reach. Even worse, the resulting state - along with all of its very expensive maintenance - has been completely normalised by our surrounding cultural expression. And the result of this is not just that we see very few people attaining this singular escape, but that nobody even knows it exists. The whole thing remains completely obscured and hidden from view.

And when I say this I do not mean that some trivial aspect of life is being a bit twisted up or disturbed. What I mean is that of all the things we are attracted to, the single most desirable and rightfully coveted human potential is standing directly behind, and is entirely eclipsed by, the greatest single dread we all flee from the most. It is as if the emotional north pole and south pole have become locked together in a kind of eternal embrace, thereby creating an impossible emotional conundrum as a result.

The ultimate summary of the individual state is actually so depressing that it even feels sad to write it down: it is not just that people do not achieve the sort of happiness they naturally deserve, it is that they no longer even know such levels of happiness even exist. Which in turn means that the only true and final solution in that regard simply makes no sense to them - they can't even conceive of something that might cost nothing at the end of the day, and yet deliver ten times the general sense of fulfilment than even the highest level of worldly success might result in.

This is the one thing we are incapable of seeing, even when it is resting right in front of us. It is also the one thing that common culture will never capture, precisely because of how fully it reflects the individual aversion of all those who participate in its formation.

Clearly, however, the issue in this regard is this implied lack of cultural support. After all, is this new path even open to the average person at this stage? No. Not really. Not easily, or securely. The process we are discussing might eventually be so well understood that the whole thing will become rather mundane in a sense, but it is always going to be a very profound transition, and very threatening subjectively. And yet, for the individual person, this is the only final answer to the only final question. As stated earlier, this concealed and concealing event is by far the most important thing to know about being human, and being happy, and we don't currently know it.

It means that there is good news, and bad news. The good news is that there really is a fundamental solution to the core dilemma the average person is dealing with at the deepest level of life. But the bad news is that this potential is currently out of individual reach, precisely because there is such a dearth of substantial collective development in that regard. Or, more precisely, that there is presently none at all - assuming you discount all the woolly headed spiritual approaches to such, which would probably be a wise first step.

The main import of everything we have laid out above is what it says about the human state in general, as opposed to what we naturally assume about such. Instead of there just being one human state - the one we know and love so much - the implication here is that there are actually two. And also that the 'other' one is very significantly better than the typical twisted and distorted one we know.

The central defining feature of this insight relates to how stable each of these two states is. If you happen to be in one, then the chances of you waking up in the other are very slim indeed. This doesn't just happen. I mean, even if you deliberately wish to transition from one to the other it still won't happen, not for most people, and we are also starting to see why in our outline here. The very nature of the situation defines this stability.

Culturally speaking, this stability is also reflected in the fact that any incremental development in this direction will be immediately swept away again. Even quite a bright light shone on it will be immediately smothered in darkness, and common culture throws wet and heavy blankets over any such insight with the same sort of vigilance it might have to putting a fire out. And what this means is that there are not even any maps for this journey, let alone any significant support for such.

The result of this universal riptide of avoidance and denial is that very few people ever 'discover' this other state. I mean, it does happen, but they really would need to be a total freak - so much so that for the most part they will probably just be considered insane or deluded in the wake of such a shift. Not to mention that they will generally have no idea at all about what they have found, or how it occurred.

This other state, then? What makes that so stable? How can that be so permanent once 'achieved'? That is quite simple. The previous state is defined by the dynamic stability associated with a living organism. It basically responds and adjusts just like any living thing does, and in doing so perpetuates its own survival. The harder you push it, the harder it will push back, etc. But what happens if you push that thing so hard that it dies? What then? That would result in another kind of stability, right? It would then be consistently, and permanently, absent. Very simple really.

So can you go back to the diseased state once you blow the bottom out of this bucket of suffering? No. It's a one way street. That never happens, any more than you can ever put the snow back up on the mountain after an avalanche. It only ever occurs in one direction, and this is what we meant above when we discussed such an event being downward in nature, rather than upward. It is a strategic collapse, a deconstruction, not a development. A letting go, not a building up.

Clearly, however, there is a sort of critical threshold associated here. And this is true. The central events all of this relates to do indeed need to occur in a particular sort of sequence, and for that to happen the entire thing also needs to be structured in a way that makes the process emotionally sustainable and realistic for the person associated. It is incredibly demanding, even when you know which direction to move, and what is happening. I mean, objectively speaking - in terms of the structures and functions involved - it is not difficult to understand what needs to happen during this transition process. But from a subjective vantage point - in terms of how all of that might feel for the person in the hot seat - it is another thing entirely. If you think you are afraid of heights, then you ain't

seen nothing yet. This is the sum of everything you ever feared in life, and for this to work you have got to walk straight toward it.

At this point in history such a transition remains securely beyond the realistic reach of the average person. It just isn't going to happen, not if all they have to go on is their own personal insight and nous. It is just not realistic. But that fact does not in any way change the reality that this other state exists, and that it can - in the right circumstances - be 'accessibly attained'. It is just that (without collective assistance of some kind) that threshold is currently too high for most people to realistically assail. On your own, and even with a map, it is still too hard. But still, consider the implications of making it more readily achievable.

The scale of the insight, then, is broadly equivalent to realising that you are in The Matrix. Everything you know is challenged, all of it becomes implicated in contrast to this singular alternative option. The result is two separate paths, and two separate destinations.

Importantly, for the typical person, this dramatic and singular alternative to all common paths and views represents the foundations of a very profound shift in values. Suddenly the map is twice the size, and the only destination worth visiting is not even within the boundaries of the old map. It basically means that everything you have ever been told was wrong. But it doesn't do this merely by negating all of that, it does this by providing something even better, and thereby outshining all of that. It is an option so bright that most people simply can't see it at first, no matter how hard they look. But what it means is that you already have all the ingredients for profound and permanent bliss, that boundless happiness is already in your very bones, and that all you need is to be provided with a way to permanently release it.

Part Eight - Zooming Out

What's the point, then? Who cares if there is another whole state if we can never personally reach for such? How does that even matter in that case? Well, it matters because even though the personal threshold cannot be significantly lowered based on individual effort or intention, collective intention and effort is another thing altogether in this context.

So the question now is this: what might knowing all this change?

This brings us to the collective aspect, and how cultural development might tip this balance so dramatically, and so rapidly. I mean think about that individual, the dilemma they face in relation to this primary shift and how to reliably achieve it - or even knowing that it exists. What might make that possible, and accessible, and what would the inevitable results of that be? Can collective action make the transition from one state to the other state more effective and realistically attainable for the individual? And if so, then what might that take in order to initiate such collective efforts? How many people might it take, and what might that demand of those few?

With this we come to the collective solution, but before we define that we really need to take a closer look at the collective problem.

If we now snap our view back out from the individual to take a look at things at a more global level, the exact same patterns can be seen, if only because the human collective is actually nothing but a whole bunch of individuals. So if the individual is conflicted, then the collective is conflicted. Which is, of course, what we see - the same cyclic and intractable conflict we see in the individual is expressed in the collective.

In this regard we also see the very same patterns of futility and impotence being expressed at a more collective level, with all of the same excesses being reflected at a global scale, and all the circular patterns of frustration and inertia. We see a million great ideas, and endless screaming hype about what we could do if only we did this thing, or vote for that person, but in the end the trajectory we are on as a whole just shrugs all of that off like a juggernaut being occasionally pecked by chickens as it mows them down by the millions. I mean politics. I mean, if everything we said above is basically correct, then failure is locked-in right at the start. This is why politics is totally futile. Really, mention politics to me and it will be the last conversation we ever have. That is just so dumb that it defies all decent onus to even respond. Do you really think politicians control anything? And even the small part they do control, what does that mean when they are themselves being controlled? Money controls the world, including politics. And if you don't see that, then you are simply an idiot. Sorry if that seems a bit harsh, but when you don't believe in politics, then being 'politically correct' suddenly carries no weight, so why would you bother?

Politics is, at its root, merely a failure to look hard in the mirror. It is a search for an answer where none will ever exist, when the only true solution would make no political solution even necessary. Basically, for as long as we are arguing about what needs to happen next, then we are still totally fucked, and we therefore need to travel even further upstream to find and address the source of the conflict, rather than forever dramatise it in a perpetually embarrassing and impotent Punch and Judy show.

Needless to say, and in case it is not obvious, what we are discussing here has no political dimension whatsoever. People often confuse this, if only because they spend so much time thinking along those

lines, but we are talking about real change here - not anything so base as to require, or even desire, popularity.

So at a global level we see exactly the same dynamics in play. With everything to gain from unity, and nothing to gain from conflict, we nevertheless see an endless failure to align on even the most basic and obvious global issues. And all the while we continue to be completely powerless in the face of continual threats to collective harmony and security. Institutions such as the UN are so fundamentally impotent that they may as well not even exist, with a single multinational corporation often wielding significantly more real power in the world, and all at the behest of just a couple of old, white, fat, cigar smoking, men.

Less than 5% of all development globally occurs on the basis of government initiatives, with all the rest being completely unfettered and morally unbridled free enterprise for personal profit. And let's just say that the system is not exactly structured to ensure that only the best of us will rise to the top in that arena, any more than that is true of politics. Quite the opposite is very often the case.

But it is all just feeding demand, you might say. And how can the individual be wrong? But as we have seen, that grass roots demand - in the form of individual desire and aversion - is itself the subject of considerable suspicion here, and nobody at any boardroom level is going to bother questioning such things. The personal characteristics that might give you access to such an arena are not exactly conducive to a high degree of insight or compassion. And as far as they know a person is a person, and cannot be fundamentally altered in any significant way. At that level a Lego block is a Lego block, and nobody looks any closer at them. Which once again means that the individual base unit is blindly defining the scope and nature of collective development in ways that have nothing necessarily to do with natural or healthy human concerns, let alone what's best for the planet. The entire system is completely out of control.

Which is merely to state the obvious I suppose - the collective dilemmas reflect the individual struggle, like a river reflecting all the kinds of pollution in the tributaries that combine to make it up. And as we said above, you cannot remove all of that in any downstream way.

The way culture is generally structured at present means that the necessary types of support this much deeper solution would require are actively undermined and eroded away, in just the same way as individual awareness tends to be mysteriously diverted from the central issues associated.

Once again, this is how people can remain completely unaware of the single greatest potential they face in life. Human beings have an absolutely incredible propensity for self-delusion. And you might imagine that culture would tend to balance and correct such distortions, but you would be suffering from a fit of optimism if you did. Quite the opposite tends to be the case, and what this means is that sometimes the gap between the way things really are, and the way people think they are, is absolutely massive.

That is the problem as it is reflected at the collective level. So what about the solution at that level?

The central crux here is that whilst the transition we indicated above remains impossible at an individual level, for the collective to make that available to the individual would be relatively easy. And with that having been said, the equally unavoidable implication has to be that everything we see now - with the world the sway it is, and people as they are - can only be defined as fundamentally unacceptable.

This obviously flies in the face of one of the primary functions of culture as we currently see it today - which is to reassure everyone that they are on the right team, and doing the right thing. But the whole idea that we are already there somehow, or that this is all we get, or that we are free to simply enjoy what we have now, is completely undermined.

I mean, great effort everyone! But all of that is nothing beside what we are now discussing as a potential within easy collective reach. We are not actually free to simply take what we see now and make the best of it - that entire approach becomes completely moronic the moment this other potential comes into view. All of that might be fine if you had not been informed, but now you have. Sorry about that.

We find an important tenet here, relating to what any kind of final solution might look like. The question is whether the issue ultimately rests with the individual, or with the collective. But the real situation is that the individual and the collective exist in a kind of ouroboric fusion - an endless looping spiral, like a snake eating its own tail. In just the same way as a river will always flow based on the shape of a landscape, but will also reshape that landscape as it flows, the individual and the collective are always defining each other and reflecting each other in the form of their dominant 'culture'.

It is, in the end, culture that is the problem here. And it is also the solution. It is culture that is keeping this door closed. And it is a culture that will open it at last, blowing it clean off its hinges, once and for all. After all, the resulting state we are discussing will be both effortless, and permanent.

We can discuss the important difference between these two cultural events, and we will do that below in some detail, but first of all we need to complete our circle here in order to establish the basic path here, and to finally sketch the scale of the event implied.

Consider where we now stand. The only missing piece was the information associated - the elusive and hidden anatomy of what's going on inside the mysterious 'black box' of the human unconscious - in just the right level of detail, and in just the right terms. These are not the terms you see above by the way, where we have deliberately avoided such resolution in order to avoid morally capturing anyone. That sort of detail will be reserved for the next level up, in The Hard Book.

What does the missing information explain? Just as with the individual, it explains on the one hand how completely futile and meaningless most of the things we do collectively actually are in the face of a formidable and largely elusive momentum - a body of force that is ultimately emanating from nobody but ourselves. We are all essentially like people who are running around trying to put a fire out, whilst at the same time failing to notice we are actually on fire, and - like king midas - only spreading the problem everywhere we go.

But once again it also indicates a solution that is so dramatic that it defies all reasonable belief or comprehension. It means that if the entire collective can get together to produce or enable this transition in a single individual, and then in another, then a third, that the entire ball of string will begin to unravel in a completely unstoppable wave of transformation. And also that such an event will be driven by the exact same forces that currently drive the downward spiral - myopic greed and personal self-gratification. No understanding will be required, because the resulting cultural level - whatever that happens to end up being - will essentially be a form of applied technology, not any kind of belief system.

The point is that the whole situation is very powerfully loaded in a way that nobody has noticed, and that only quite a small triggering event could set in motion an entire chain of events that would, once initiated, be unstoppable - like poking a single small hole in a clay dyke. There is an enormous amount

of pressure built up, and - once it all begins - it will very rapidly unfold in ways nobody ever even knew was possible.

This is the real subject of this entire work, and it also defines who we are actually speaking to here. It is indeed possible to make a very big difference in this regard, and almost all of that empowerment will arise out of direct and penetrating personal understanding of the systems associated, and how they all dynamically relate. As outlined above, only a few of these very specialised and highly informed 'hackers' might ever be required in order to provide this accessible option for everyone else.

In a sense we see a sort of pending cascade being set up here, as we follow these stacked dominos back up the chain to see if we can find the first domino, and what pushing that one over will require.

So what will those few 'hackers' require in order to do whatever they need to do, and as a result unleash this epic wave of change? They just need information. That's all. Because that's all that was missing. And we can see why now, right? It is because everyone is simply getting washed away down this river of emotional aversion, or at best merely clinging to their own little rock and trying to keep their heads above the water. Apparently nobody ever bothered to do whatever it took to make their way upstream to see what's actually going on up there. But in this situation that's maybe all it was ever going to take.

We have always been coming at the entire problem from the wrong end, and in entirely the wrong terms. In particular we have been focusing on the supposed solution whilst at the same time completely abandoning any seriously rigorous penetration of the problem. As outlined earlier, this is simply not how we have been imagining the nature of our situation.

After all, to think about things in this way requires the existence of an event that is both vast as well as extremely stable, with many possible permutations, and yet for all of that staggering scale and impact to somehow remain completely concealed in plain sight. But now we see - this is exactly what's going on. And once you know where to dig, and what you are looking for, all of a sudden the entire thing simply reveals itself right before your very eyes, and you then come to wonder how you could ever have possibly missed something so obvious. But all of this does still imply the need to capture the whole issue in the right terms, and to communicate about it using the right language, to the right people.

So what we see here is that the individual solution shows up in the collective in just the same way as the individual problem does. The pattern is essentially identical, except in this case it will require the removal of that conflict in all the individual elements that make up the collective event.

Which is to say - world peace and universal prosperity will never occur until you are happy. But it is also to say that world conflict and spiralling ecological crisis is not something that is either beyond your personal control, nor happening 'out there somewhere'. It is all coming directly from you. And I mean, who else would it be coming from? Think about it.

So, how to get 7b people from where they are now to another state entirely, one they have never even heard of, and which they are in no way prepared to even look at, let alone move toward? Easy. You only need to break it down to the base unit to see how this works. And that shouldn't be too hard, given that the base unit is you. But it will be a bit of a shift in perspective I suppose, in that you have probably spent your entire life considering how the individual can possibly affect the collective, and that the main thrust here will be the other way around - how the collective can affect the individual.

The situation is this: This shift is possible, and it is very dramatic, but it is presently completely concealed. In particular the solution is hidden beneath the problem, and the problem is something people are desperately not looking at. And this is where the solution has been languishing - beneath ignorance, and fear, and weakness. So what is the answer? Well, it is obviously the opposite of all these. But does this mean that you personally are going to have to become fearless and strong and brimming with perspicacious self-understanding? No. This is the whole point. For most people even just looking at the map would be more than they could manage, let alone making the journey. It is all far beyond their abilities to even understand, let alone navigate with any degree of stable confidence. But they won't need to, not if all of that insight is embodied for them in the form of some kind of cultural institution.

At present even just becoming fully aware of the true nature of the common situation is exceedingly difficult, and exiting that trap is all high impossible. There is just no way you are ever going to do that on your own, and even if you did there is even less chance that anyone will ever be able to repeat that feat. So individual effort is worthless. Even the Buddha could attest to that. Personal realisation is not the key, even when it provides direct evidence that there is indeed 'something' there. Not actually knowing what that 'something' is makes all of that stuff pretty much worthless. I mean for thousands of years we have had entire cultures ostensibly dedicated to reaching this singular goal, and how many times has all of that actually delivered on such a promise? I suppose it is hard to say for certain. But we can say how many times any such culture has achieved stable mastery over such a process: never. Not even once has this ever occurred.

What it means is that it now rests in the hands of a very few people to initiate a process of collective change on a scale and depth the world has never seen before, and of a type the world has no way to even broadly comprehend. It will, therefore not only be the task of these few to provide this practical application, but also to provide the necessary sociological frameworks required to explain and unpack the resulting state in a way that makes sense to the average person.

This is the function of the paradigm that is emerging, in whatever form it ultimately takes. On the one hand it will enable directly applicable modalities of change, and on the other hand it will function to explain the results of those processes. It will make change possible, and then explain it for people, and all in a great cascading wave of transformation - thereby establishing a completely different world in the wake of that epic event.

It is total lunacy. I get it. But let's be clear, even that claim won't stop it. If you don't agree, and if that drives you to ignore it, then it will still happen quite fast. And if you don't agree, and decide to attack it, then it will happen even faster. And the only thing all this requires in order to be true are those rare few. Those people will know this is true immediately, and won't be bothered in the slightest by all the noise (or complete silence) from the ignorant masses.

It doesn't matter. This is the power of a technology, rather than a belief system. It will all be done in private, and there is nothing you can do to stop it.

On the positive side, the very nature of the event in question is that it will only be driven by raw social demand - so if you are not interested in exploring the resulting potential in your own life, then you will be welcome to simply ignore it. All I'm saying here is that this will be far more difficult than you realise, once you are surrounded by it on all sides. It is a very compelling prospect, like a doctor walking into a leper colony with an instant cure.

Therefore, the entire power of this emerging field of potential is that it is a brute force approach in one sense - in that it harnesses the same forces that currently drive people. They will not need to be better

people than they are now in order to avail themselves of this potential, that's the whole point of it. But in another sense there is no force involved at all. The whole thing is, and will always be, completely voluntary. So you will be free to choose. It's just that certain decisions are effectively mandatory, and this will certainly be one of those.

To be clear, then, we are discussing an event that - once initiated by just a few - will come towards you like a tsunami of profound personal healing and release, and you will get to choose for yourself what to do about that possibility. And in the meantime there is nothing you need to do except wait for it - assuming you are a typical person.

If you are not a typical person then the story for you is completely different, however. And this is where we need to part ways with the masses. Like a train that is carrying all of humanity, it is as if we now need to decouple the engine and a single carriage as we embark on a brief but far more demanding journey. The whole point is that we are entirely free to leave all the rest behind us as we do this. They will be the beneficiaries of this process, but will be almost completely worthless to it, for reasons we will see below.

Before we even begin to focus on that 'how' part, however, we need to make certain that the 'what' part has been adequately captured here.

We are currently spending the entire resources of the planet chasing what? What are the outcomes we are seeking to achieve? Where is it all heading? What are the problems we are seeking to solve?

All of that is merely what we addressed above when we looked at the futility of the typical approach to change, both individually and collectively. All those mighty horses are pulling the wrong carts. People are absolutely incredible, but also totally misguided. They develop tremendous levels of skill in areas of potential that are almost completely inane and vacuous. They mean nothing. They are all barking up the wrong trees, or going down dead-end streets. And this what this paradigm defines - not only that there is another potential that changes everything, but also that all existing approaches (basically anything that does not implicitly include this potential as a defining aspect of its function) are completely worthless at the end of the day. They are all just meaningless and ultimately futile distractions from the only potential that really matters - one that nobody is even looking at.

This 'not looking' part is only natural in this situation - but also, 'looking very hard' will also become very natural the moment that first proof of concept is provided in any reliable way, in light of a sufficiently developed and refined body of theory.

After all, consider the magnitude of this potential in the life of a typical individual. Well, I suppose you can't really do this yet, given that you don't have all the anatomical details of the event in question. But just imagine for a moment that this is an internal awakening that represents the single highest potential for natural freedom and effortless bliss available to the average person - a possibility far beyond anything they can even remember or imagine. And then consider that this first proof of concept, within a robust framework of broadly scientific understanding, will make that potential available to everyone on the planet in a very brief period of time.

That will essentially be the single greatest scientific advancement in all of human history, and the whole thing currently rests within easy collective reach. Honestly, you have no way to realistically comprehend what I am saying here. I do realise this, but what else can I do but say it?

That is the 'what' of all this. What it amounts to is the power to change the entire world being delivered into the hands of a very select few.

So the only questions now are: who are they? And what is this alternative form of culture?

What else do you need to know? And what part do you play in all of this?

Part Nine - The Right Stuff

This entire event asks so many important questions that it really is difficult to know where to begin when discussing what comes next, or where to even start in terms of any sort of meaningful discussion. There are actually so many issues raised by all of this that if I stopped to address each one as we encountered it then this book would already be ten inches thick.

With this in mind, we had better limit our discussions at this stage to only those that really pertain to the main issues at hand. We need to take some time here to pull forward only the most critical issues, and to push everything else back into the background for the moment.

This small work is only a brief introductory outline, the purpose of which being to make way for a far deeper exploration of all this subject matter in the much larger and more detailed work to follow. And with this in mind it falls to us here to do whatever we can to prepare those who decide to take that journey, and in particular to provide both the tools they will require, as well as a few warnings about the various pitfalls they would best avoid if possible.

In particular, we need to address the other elephant in the room, so to speak. And what is that? Well, consider the broad strokes of what has just been proposed - that something of this scale even exists in the first place is beyond all reasonable probability. But for all of that to fall within the reach of just a dedicated few, that is simply laughable. It just doesn't make sense.

I mean, the claim is that it has been sitting right in front of us this whole time. But how could this be? How could something that holds the singular key to the entire human puzzle just be sitting there right under our noses, and yet not ever have been noticed?

Which is to say - what is the catch? Something just doesn't stack up.

There is a huge amount of noise here, like a massive cloud of philosophical dust that this great possibility suddenly stirs up. And that can be very confusing, and distracting. After all, all of those questions do need to be answered in due course also. But if we now strip away all the noise here and focus only on what needs to happen next here, we suddenly get a much clearer picture, and we also begin to see the real situation much more clearly - including the challenges associated.

Our purpose here will be simple, then, based on the singular outcome it all defines. We need only define 'what' now needs to happen, 'how' that will occur, and 'who' will be associated. In particular, the 'how' aspect will need to account for exactly what stands in the way of such a process currently, and what overcoming such forces will inevitably demand.

In this sense the particular brief process we see mapped out between the emergence of the necessary theory and the first secure body of proof is required to run a gauntlet in a sense, and thereby overcome a series of challenges along the way. And it turns out that many of those challenges really aren't that difficult, not once you see what is really going on. Indeed, the emergence of a clear enough map here should make reaching that first destination relatively easy. But it is also a high stakes game, and if you screw it up, or fail to appreciate the true magnitude of the various potholes you need to avoid along the way, then the results would be complete failure. And in this regard it is all about understanding the context.

Perhaps you can see what we are doing here now, as we chase this series of events back up the causal chain toward that initiating spark. The question now becomes one of exactly what needs to

happen, and who will be involved in that. And we will get to that below in more detail, but for now the only thing we are seeking to somehow illustrate is the magnitude of such an event, especially in relation to the tiny scale of that initiating spark, and most especially in light of the fact that nobody knows this entire potential even exists.

The whole thing embodies a series of very rare characteristics - most especially in the way that it bypasses the need for any kind of broad social or political support. Popularity will mean nothing in this instance, not essentially. And in this way it completely inverts a whole raft of typical expectations relating to how change can occur, and where it must come from.

I mean, how much of your life is dominated by a smartphone, or by facebook, instagram, and twitter? But did you ever vote for all that? No. Why? Because none of the decisions that led to such developments were political in nature - they were merely technological advancements, and as such made freely by individuals who never consulted you in any way whatsoever. Those advancements were all made behind closed doors, by very rare few. And the same will be true here.

You are not being consulted here - only informed. You are not even being invited to participate in such development, most likely, not unless you happen to embody the very rare characteristics associated. You probably don't qualify. But some people will, and what we are seeking to do here is explain what that means, in light of the missing information now emerging for the first time.

This is the top domino, then. And this is where we stand right now. Who are those few? And exactly how much information or resources do they require in order to begin this next vital stage? Who will provide first proof of principle in this particular context, and thereby ignite an entire storm of development and upward investigation? And what will they require in order to achieve this quite modest but very significant feat?

Understanding is the key, because only shared understanding allows for collective action. Beyond that, not only is reaching that 'Wright Brothers' ignition threshold possible, it would be easy. Well, when I say easy, I mean a hell of a lot easier than building an oil tanker or putting a telescope into space, or any other such event we see occurring on a regular basis due to collective human will and ingenuity. Except that in this case we will actually achieve something significant as a result - something that profoundly impacts individual human lives. We don't even need to develop anything special, we already have what this would take, in spades.

What we do need, however, is the right information, in the right terms. And this is what has been missing in all the 'spiritual' traditions that purport to represent this transformational event.

These 'terms', then, what are they exactly? You might suppose that we have been gradually developing this special language here, but actually we have not. Not much anyway. As I indicated above, we are intentionally avoiding too much detail at this point, if only so as to prevent you from being captured in any ethical sense by what you read here. We are just very roughly sketching here, as if with a blunt pencil or crayon, when what you would really need is the equivalent of a high resolution photograph.

The actual anatomy of the events in question is vast and dynamic and complicated, making fields such as dynamic complexity and systems theory the most likely to capture it best. Which is obviously beyond the grasp of most people in terms of being able to articulate such models in their head directly, but not beyond all, and probably not even close to the level of number crunching ability required to develop the average video game. And just as with that example, what might be deemed virtually

impossible for any individual is actually pretty easy for the collective - once the group mind is able to conceive of the destination in question, and what makes it worthwhile. I mean, if we put up a \$10m prize for a computer model that captured this entire thing, it would probably emerge in about a week. Our ability has not been lacking - only our awareness of the true nature of the problem, and what that immediately says about the possible solutions we might actually have available.

What you see here in this introductory work (The Easy Book) is the result of conversation at Stage One. At Stage Two we will see the emergence of a far more detailed and comprehensive description of the anatomy associated (The Hard Book). And Stage Three, where we actually get to begin tinkering as a group endeavour, will literally be the beginnings of a global revolution the likes of which the world has never seen. So it should be Google. Or NASA, or some specially convened think tank funded by the Gates Foundation, but like Amazon or Apple it will probably start off as just a couple of people playing around in someone's suburban garage. Boeing didn't come first etc - they came later, and only once the basic foundations had already been established by a few more adventurous and daring types.

The essential function of the paradigm is to provide anatomical details that make it possible to meaningfully separate the natural function of the human organism from all the added and unnecessary subversion that is afflicting it. It is all about the ability to tease these two things apart. And what you see, when you do this, is that the added event has essentially eroded large sections of the healthy functioning away.

This is obviously a hard pill to swallow, but it also explains a great deal about the average person, and about the world at large. I mean, if you consider individual human development - in the sense that most people might understand such - you would probably see some basic recipe defined by how well a person is adapted to the demands of life, etc. But in this instance what we see is that the 'life' to which they are being asked to adapt is not actually a singular event - but two events in twisted dynamic union. It is a diseased event, basically. And this is what we mean here when we say that separating these two events can have a profound impact on the way that you see things.

If you isolate natural human functioning from all the added noise and distortion, what you see is that it reaches upwards toward a sort of defining apex, like a pyramid of sorts I suppose. That apex is what we might call peak adulthood - a grand synthesis of ability and responsibility that involves a great many various levels of competence and relationship.

Conversely, and here we come to the point, any degree of erosion in this regard can only be defined in the opposite terms. And what are those terms? Well, think about it for a moment. People do not develop in a vacuum, they are not grown in a tank, and so a half finished human is not half an adult. A half finished human is actually called a child. And what this means is that the damage we see in people, and in ourselves, is not only movement away from true adulthood - but that it is movement toward regressive and infantile states of development.

As I say, what we basically confront here is the issue we raised above in relation to who is - and who is not - qualified for such a path. And once again we confront the basic atrophy of modern popular culture, and the dumbing down of the masses. In particular, what we see - when we say that common culture has grown to support this subversive agenda in the individual - is that what it is actually doing is supporting transactional behaviour that is essentially childish in nature.

The important thing is that there is a social divide that emerges here, a kind of unavoidable gap between the actively blind and those who choose to deliberately see - and especially between those

who will step forward, and those who would rather sit through a fight. It can be a very frustrating situation for both sides. In particular, mutual respect can tend to be profoundly eroded over time.

The issue here is not that mysterious, but it does require at least some grasp of the basic scale and nature of the events in question. There are essentially two paths here, literally based on two different personal states being available to every person, not only the conflicted and confused state we know now. Which in turn defines another entire world based on a different individual. And the more you penetrate the core anatomy that makes this fact clear the more you become attuned to the new world, and the less aligned you become with the one we see now.

You basically become a fish out of water. Increasingly, and over time, it becomes unavoidable that your entire focus of awareness will begin to saturate you with further knowledge of the anatomy of the trap you are caught in, which happens to be the very thing most people are so frantically avoiding awareness of in this instance - avoidance upon which their fragile emotional equilibrium entirely depends.

So there are only a few options in this situation once it begins to develop, and I am telling you this because anyone who finds themselves faced with the same potential (and the same increasing body of awareness) will be in the same quandary. There really are two possible worlds here - there is the one that stays the way it is, and then there is the one that changes into something else entirely - and you can't have both outcomes because each one is exactly defined by the absence of the other.

I'm not sure if this makes sense to you yet, but consider the great deadlock this situation represents in purely personal terms -

What people truly desire is being confused. In particular, in this instance it is hidden behind what they are avoiding above all else. This is the state of the world, and the situation every individual also finds themselves in. This is how something so big can be resting so close, but still somehow remain completely unnoticed. What we are all looking for is sitting directly behind or beneath something that we are all terribly afraid of. And this also describes the conundrum we face at a social level, when it comes to making such awareness openly available to anyone. Any such attempt is often devastating in its emotional impact, but generally achieves nothing at all except conflict and bewildered confusion.

This divergence, both psychologically and culturally, will therefore need to be addressed at some length once the basic paradigm has been laid out at the next stage. It will be necessary for anyone who intends to go any further down that path to fully understand the social implications of doing so.

There is a deep culture clash emerging here essentially. Two different tribes. And whilst this is not necessarily true or even important at the very start (stage one), or at the very end where practical applications have already emerged to confirm all of this conjecture (stage three having reached its own Write Brothers moment etc). In the middle stages we find a rather difficult period.

The middle stage (where we are now) will always be somewhat turbulent and tense.

- In the beginning there is no responsibility being assumed, and everything is also somewhat vague and generalised.
- And then, at the end, where all of this has been broadly confirmed in theory, as well as widely applied in practice, there will also be no tension - if only because the origins of such tension will by then have been largely removed, having been replaced by a tsunami of gratitude and emotional relief. By then all people will be able to swim confidently, and the entire swimming pool will be open to everyone.

- But in the middle stage we strike this terrible dilemma, where awareness will inevitably be spilling over onto people who are in no way prepared for such.

Which is to say, awareness of this issue is the one thing that most people can't bring themselves to face up to. After all, their entire lives are built around avoiding exactly that. And while we will not experience that damage here to any significant degree now, as we adopt this relaxed approach to exploration within carefully controlled boundaries, it still remains a very real and serious consideration for when you need to examine the boundary between these two emerging cultures, out in the wild so to speak.

Once you see this new world, therefore, you are faced with an interesting choice. What to do about the old world. How to relate to that old one, and all the psychologically blinkered people who populate it. Suddenly you will see the disease everywhere, and that people are slaves to a barrage of powerful impulses and tendencies and destructive behaviours that are actually not only able to be better managed, but also entirely removed, assuming they can first be examined. But if only this particularly cogent form of self-examination wasn't so fully and powerfully banned in general cultural dialogue.

This is one thing in particular that needs to be explained in more detail, because at this stage you will not fully appreciate the extreme nature of what is being proposed, or just how deeply ensconced the average person is in this emotionally loaded avoidance. The cascading nature of awareness (the way awareness leads to more awareness etc - and the way the emotional aversion tends to suddenly and dramatically invert) means that a sort of invisible rift tends to emerge between these two different cultural forms. The difference really isn't obvious on the surface of things, but at a deep level it is as if the entire definition of what - (love is) becomes inverted in a sense, and in particular in a way that people just don't understand.

Like lancing a boil, long term gain requires short term pain in certain situations, and people can generally grasp this idea in some contexts - but they don't really tend to do so when the pain you are talking about is this deep or personal. And this is why we are ultimately speaking to only a very select few here at the end of the day. Not many people will be able to withstand a shift in values that is this deep - not prior to the emergence of the practical aspect. There will inevitably be a stage where culture in general will be confronting something that completely mystifies it, and not in a good way. People are very very afraid. So we need to try to avoid this potential if we can, especially given how completely unnecessary that sort of thing might be here. The whole point is that we only need just a few, just the right few, and that everyone else can be left completely in the dark. And it is not only that this might be possible, it is that it would be entirely preferable.

Anyway, in this case it is as if there are suddenly two boats now, not just one, each heading to what seems like a different destination, using a totally different map - and you will find yourself with one foot in each as you begin to explore the new one a little. But eventually you will need to choose, because they are not just ideas, and are both moving in different directions, in the short term at least, so that is simply not a sustainable situation to be in. Do that for too long and you are likely to end up falling out of both, and thereby upsetting people on both sides, not to mention freezing your arse off.

You should expect no appreciation on this path, that's all I am saying. Nothing you do here will ever be recognised for what it is, indeed quite the opposite is most likely. The whole thing puts the social 'balance of payments' out of whack, because suddenly it is as if you are paying with currency that is not recognised by anyone. And you might be a billionaire in that context, morally speaking, and yet still not be able to buy a bubblegum, socially speaking. This is how it can easily damage connections beyond repair. It is because so much of what people embrace in life is implicated in this event, and

because the entire impetus of releasing that event (or even looking at it) is not yet recognised for what it is - a supreme value.

Which will in turn lead us to one of the most important keys here, in relation to how to establish and maintain this particular form of dialogue in any kind of sustainable way. It would basically be completely pointless to attempt such a conversation in any typical cultural context, which in turn means that some kind of threshold or boundary will always need to be established and maintained. And a large part of what follows will be devoted to explaining exactly what this means, why it is so important, and what happens if you don't do this.

Imagine you created a boundary, then. You put up this separating threshold, and thereby isolate what you are doing from the surrounding context. What then? How does this help if what you do inside that boundary is no different to what happens beyond? I mean think of a garden swimming pool - what would be the point of filling it with dirt and planting grass? What would be the point if what happened inside that threshold was exactly the same as what happened outside it?

What, then, needs to be inside that threshold? And how do you maintain this increasingly rigorous exclusion as the water gets deeper?

I can only speak from experience here, from years of direct and open exchange across this boundary between cultures, and offer a single piece of advice. Whether or not you choose to ignore this advice in the way you engage with others will obviously be entirely up to you. But I will certainly be applying this principle myself in the way I relate with anyone, so knowing this might at least be valuable in that initial context. It is all about separating healthy rational doubt from loaded emotional denial, and in the end any failure to achieve that very simple outcome boils down to a single elementary rule.

What does it mean? And what did my own path teach me, that would not be even slightly obvious unless you actually jumped in and tried it?

It is this: you can have everything in place, you can have the right language, you can fully overcome all unconscious aversion, you can have access to all the details you wish, you can even have people who are extremely enthusiastic and who 'believe' in it with all their heart, and still it will go nowhere at all.

Why? Why isn't that enough?

It is because all you will do in that case is generate a 'following'. And what does a following do for you, except boil your eggs in the morning, metaphorically speaking? What is the point of having a bunch of ducklings that follow you around everywhere and get under your feet?

Part Ten- A Fork in the Road

What is the ultimate key then? Where has it all been stuck? And how might we unstick it now, in some sort of very secure manner? What does that take? And what will it look like?

It is all defined by a singular very simple function, in particular as it relates to culture and the way it either moves toward or away from this central defining insight.

- Option A (what we already see): The current situation is held in place by this simmering unconscious event itself, as it manipulates the flow of attention away from itself, and likewise as culture is established so as to reflect this same basic drive. It is both stable and dynamic, as well as very powerful, and the result is the maintenance of a very pervasive process of avoidance.
- Option B (the new path): Opposing that, there is a type of cultural event that has the exact opposite function in relation to this one defining event at the core of life. And we already see several characteristics of that in what we have examined above: the right language, the right degree of capture. And yes, all of these things matter. But in the end the only thing that truly defines any emerging cultural event as having crossed the essential threshold is that it first of all grasps the full trajectory of the entire unfolding process, and secondly that it presses forward relentlessly in that direction at every successive stage in a way that produces more meaningful gains than it suffers in terms of backsliding losses.

What does that even mean? It all boils down to the cascading nature of this pending event, and understanding how quickly it will evolve and develop as it rolls forward. People just don't get this at first; just how rapidly the entire ball of string will begin to unravel. What this means is that the demands at every stage will immediately begin to unfurl and transform, as one event rolls out into the next, which then blossoms out into yet another, as it all begins to unpack itself.

The question is - which side are you on? There is no middle ground here, if only because the incumbent state is not at all passive as people may imagine. So to do nothing is not actually a passive option, not if your present state is actively engaged in the avoidance of this other potential. Which it is. After all, you are not being presumed to be innocent here, as I say - you are being completely implicated in the current backward moving event, both individually as well as collectively. This is exactly what the paradigm defines.

So what is the opposing proposition? What is the alternative culture? What essentially defines it?

It is simply anything that - by whatever means necessary - manages to achieve this one summary outcome at the end of the day. That outcome being this other world, along with everything associated, which in the first instance only means the establishment of any small cultural event that manages to reach that critical initial tipping point threshold associated - that Wright Brothers moment. Once that point has been crossed, all the rest will simply occur by itself. So we are really only talking about the brief period between the emergence of the basic theory and that first small proof of concept, that's all.

It could be anything, therefore. There are no rules. There is simply a goalpost, and billions of mindless zombies slowly nudging the cultural ball away from it. So even a small group of well organised individuals could probably grab hold of their own brand new cultural ball and begin a process that

eventually results in that simple goal being reached. And the rest will flow unavoidably from there. The deadlock would have been broken, and a new gold rush would have begun.

The dividing line between these two cultures is very simple therefore:

- One culture tends to diminish and sweep away all awareness of the issue being alluded to above, or fails to then act on what is discovered in a way that is both natural and effective, and in this way it acts to placate and console the average person's unconscious fears and aversions.
- The other culture naturally increases awareness of that aspect of life over time, and then acts in an intelligent and responsible manner at every cascading stage, and in this way it directly and intentionally confronts and transcends all of the related unconscious aversions in all those who decide to participate in such a process of exploration.
- And there is no third type of culture in this particular sense. All forms of social engagement fall into one or other of these two modes, as defined by the polarised outcome states each one leads toward.

They do not play well together, and you cannot truly join one without truly leaving the other. They are mutually exclusive by definition. Which means that if you are not for it, then you are against it by default. And this cannot be avoided. The two different events might look almost identical, but as we say - they are defined by completely different outcome states.

So what might seem like only a tiny change is actually a critical spark in an absolutely enormous haystack of human suffering. In one culture you are allowed to talk about this stuff, whereas in the other culture you aren't. That is really all it is, that is the simple dividing line. But as you may soon see, like a spark in a haystack, that small difference can have a very dramatic effect in quite a short period of time.

Therefore, what does it take to reach the essential dividing line? I suppose this is what we are getting down to here. What exactly sets this critical cultural threshold, and how do you step across it in a way that is both secure and effective? In particular, how do you generate a sustainable social event in that regard, and prevent it from immediately resolving back into a typical backsliding mess. What structures need to be in place to maintain that forward motion as well as avoid backward pressure.

By far the simplest way to establish and maintain such forward momentum is to enter any context that is being managed by someone who is already adept in this regard, because they will very easily be able to both start this fire, as well as contain it in a responsible manner. But for all those who may be seeking to initiate such a bounded social event on their own initiative, we will need to define these essential elements here, and to spell it all out very clearly.

The key to all of it is the cascading nature of this pending collapse, which means that this is also the key to who those people will be, because only this defines what the whole thing will demand. This is what needs to be pulled forward here, because only this defines the true weight of the whole thing. This is what produces the eclipsing moral imperatives, as well as the polarising nature of the social values associated.

So what defines these two cultural events, then? What essentially makes them different? It all boils down to the cascading nature of this pending event, and understanding how quickly it will evolve and develop as it rolls forward.

People just don't get this at first - just how rapidly the entire ball of string will begin to unravel.

What this means is that the demands at every stage will immediately begin to unfurl and transform, as one event rolls out into the next, which then blossoms out into yet another, as it all begins to unpack itself.

So people will sometimes think they are already doing this just because they are talking about it, or hanging out with others who also 'believe' in it in some static or inert sense. They imagine that they can simply 'belong' to it, like being in some kind of club. But could you ever imagine an 'astronaut club' that was populated by people who have never actually been in space, and who have absolutely no realistic chance of ever doing so? How dumb would that actually be?

This is what I meant above when I said that this is not a joke. People always tend to misunderstand, if only because they have become totally accustomed to ideas that make a huge noise at the beginning, but that ultimately go nowhere beyond pointing to some sort of unrealistic or futile political possibility for change. But there is no political aspect to any of this. It will make no difference whatsoever if you 'follow' it.

Who cares? How would that help? What might that give it? Nothing.

Likewise when people sit around and talk about it - it means nothing, not when that does not achieve the critical threshold required, and therefore has no connection whatsoever to the far deeper events implied. At the end of the day - in most cases - that sort of thing will only tend to stall and ultimately resolve back into the far more dominant cultural flow, like a little whirlpool that for a moment happens to move upstream in a river, before ultimately being swept away again downstream. There is no lasting effect. And so that is also worthless.

That is not what we are talking about here. Actually that's probably worse than nothing at all - like spending days trying to create a fire, but ultimately failing to do so. You are probably better to just sit there and enjoy yourself in that case, or do something else constructive.

The very simple answer is indeed just to talk about this stuff. That is actually the crucial missing piece, and the aspect that common culture has eliminated so effectively. But that conversation must itself also be prepared to move through all of the natural and inevitable layers and stages implied in the event associated. As indicated above.

Therefore, the question now becomes - how to achieve this important function? How to open the whole thing up completely to all those who qualify for such, whilst at the same time isolating the entire thing from all those who don't?

Perhaps think of firemen running into a burning building, while everyone else is running out - it is important to understand what you are doing, why you are doing it, and also to do that in a safe and secure manner. The fleeing people are not the enemy of the firemen. The whole point of their brave actions is to address a very dramatic problem in a way those people cannot themselves manage in their current panicked state. And yet, all those people are indeed running in the opposite direction, which means that the firemen could easily be trampled to death by that stampeding horde. And this is why we are doing a bit of 'fireman training' right here at the start, in this sense. It is because, if you do not know how to erect this very strong barrier on the stairs - between all those running out and those brave few running in - then you might easily do more harm than good, in which case all your efforts will be for nothing.

Anyway, the important implication is this: What the typical person calls 'sanity' is essentially predicated upon the stable and perpetual unconscious avoidance of the very thing we will be digging up here and examining. An entire army of unconscious processes is walking out ahead of your conscious experience of life, even now, subtly navigating a path for you that will steer you well clear of this particular body of awareness so as to perpetually avoid any possibility of such ever reaching conscious attention. Which can be a little awkward in this situation, because here we have someone directly steering you toward such in the most unequivocal terms, in person, and asking you to take a closer look.

But what if it's not actually dangerous at all? Wouldn't that be rather embarrassing!

How will you know, until you look?

Therefore, the question now becomes - how best to prepare people for such?

This is why you need to very clearly grasp the context of such an arrangement, where it all leads, and the part you might play. Which is why it is probably worth delivering several more of the big blocks we need in that regard, before this philosophical lego can really begin in earnest.

In this sense there is a lot more to say here about that wider context, and about the much larger process, including the big mistakes that are now being corrected. There is more to say about the purpose of such dialogue, which is apparently not what people imagine at first.

In particular, there are three things we need to have in our backpack here, before we can even begin this adventure together in any safe or reliable way. And the first two are directly related, like the two sides of the same coin. The third is a little less obvious, but in many ways far more important.

1.

Keep it to Yourself

Perhaps the most difficult thing to grasp here is that you are being completely implicated. You are certainly not being presumed innocent in any sense. Both your own present psychological state, as well as the current state of the cultural norms you uphold as being 'civilised', are completely immersed in this roaring process of avoidance.

It is very hard to accept at first, but once you begin to peel away even just a few layers of that process, only then will you really begin to see what I am saying here.

This is simply how it works when what you are discussing is a deeply unconscious process of avoidance - you always start off looking 'from it', rather than 'at it'. And also that there is a very challenging process of increasing personal awareness and responsibility associated with such a path, like the peeling of an onion, layer by layer. So the ability to make this transition at each progressive stage is the primary demand in this context.

This is simply how this particular level of self awareness develops over time, in anyone who pursues such. It is like the intentional lowering of a tide that reveals all manner of previously hidden territory - a shipwreck here, a tunnel over there, some great sea monster right in the middle!

Beyond all else, a capacity for profound self awareness is the key qualification on this particular journey. People can be incredibly smart in almost every possible sense, and yet still somehow remain profoundly unaware of their own internal workings. And what this also means is that as you progress into it , layer by layer, you might easily come to see certain things about yourself and others as being as obvious and objective as objects in the living room, no different to tables and chairs in this sense, and certainly be able to chat about those without any trouble at all - whereas others might see the same subject matter as being profoundly threatening, very personal, or even deeply offensive.

So there is a process of direct personal transcendence associated with gaining such awareness over time, which can itself be very demanding. But you should also be aware that this deepening conscious appreciation of your own core subjective anatomy will stand you in increasingly stark contrast with those around you. Which means that in many ways any social space dedicated to exploring such stuff is a bit like a nudist colony in some sense, except that you are exposing your insides in this case, rather than your backsides. It can become totally normal very quickly once you get used to it, but anyone who is suddenly thrust into such a context without warning might be totally freaked out at first.

Anyway, beyond this deepening process of awareness within any individual, there is the nature of the overall event itself, and how the entire process will evolve in a sense, or unfold is perhaps a better term. This is the other thing to see - the immediate rolling forward of the event itself.

There are stages and waves in how it will all proceed from this initial point, that is a key thing to see. And every one of those stages comes with very particular demands, once again belonging only to a very particular type of person at each level.

Overall I suppose I am seeking to explain the need for at least a bit of care, and that like so many things that are quite safe in life, they only end up like that because sufficient preparation has occurred, and the right context has been established first. Like skydiving - it is statistically safer than riding your bicycle down the road to the local store, but only if it is done correctly. And, more importantly, only ever if it is done with prior and informed consent!

So as I say - the simple act of talking about this subject matter is not the trivial event it might at first seem. There will always be an immediate and quite strong tendency for the surrounding culture to attack any such event, or otherwise seek to aggressively infiltrate it in a way that gradually undermines its basic potency, and thereby revert it back to just one more version of the same old thing.

Precisely because we are talking about a very active process of concealment in the individual, and because we finally have that thing fully captured here at its essential root, it means that any sort of collective exploration of that issue will basically be perceived as a kind of tumour by the loaded cultural immune system, which is one reason it must always be kept within very clear boundaries. It is because any event that was carrying this particular body of awareness in any sort of proselytising way would immediately be seen as a very threatening metastatic cancer and invoke the highest level of collective response possible.

It can never be seen to move towards people. And can, therefore, never be represented by anyone in the world at large. Which is to say, anyone who promotes it openly is immediately defining themselves as not even knowing the very first thing about it. We may end up flying a few very carefully structured flags over time, just so that people might know where to find it, but in general all of the actual dialogue and development associated will occur in a strictly isolated social space.

This cultural boundary is vital, and it serves a very important purpose in this context. It is very important that this particular form of communal exploration does not ever 'spill over' into the surrounding cultural event, and also that only those who are truly ready for such step across this very clear dividing line.

I mean think about it - the primary hidden event we are proposing here, if it is true, is basically the root of every person's deepest fears. And in this case we finally have that thing cornered. So the exploration we are discussing is dangerous in a sense, or will seem dangerous at least, the first time you do it. Like taming a tiger.

The key thing in that context is to first of all have a very secure cage, and then to progressively allow you in there with it, in a very controlled way.

What you do not do, if the thing you have captured is essentially the root of all human dread, is allow it to run around freely in the crowd. That would be the equivalent of 'philosophical terrorism'. And that's what the first person to make a YouTube video about this subject will be engaged in.

And here we see the first of our main cultural precepts coming into view: **The information associated cannot ever be allowed to freely cross the necessary boundary that defines this shared space, or spill into common culture in any way. Clear separation must be upheld at all times, and the rules associated with entering such a space must always be made very plain.**

So I have to ask you this -

Would you want to know the ultimate truth, the final secret to human life, the one thing that makes all the difference - but only on the condition that you could never tell anyone else?

What would knowing that do to you?

To be clear, however, we are not discussing secrecy. It can all be made quite openly available to anyone with an interest to pursue such knowledge and whatever insight such might deliver, but it must never be actively or indiscriminately broadcast in any sense that does not first allow for informed consent.

It is like Neo in the Matrix, and his choice between the Red pill and the Blue pill - the choice was Neo's alone to make.

It is a very strange situation in this sense. You can't ever talk about it with anyone who has not already been initiated into it via some kind of intentionally structured primer - one that first takes the time to provide all the relevant warnings and preparation required - such as the document you are currently reading.

This part totally confuses people. We have become so tuned these days to perceive every new idea or advancement to be based on broad popular appeal, and the widest possible public spread, that it is now very difficult to conceive of anything that does not require this, and that might actually suffer dramatically from any such popular attention. It is all very strange, especially in light of the scale and magnitude of what is being discussed.

In the end the particular process of avoidance is very sophisticated and delicately balanced, but it is also remarkably fragile once you have the combination to the lock, and the result of such insight can produce a kind of indelible stain on your mind.

This is why we are taking so much time and effort here. It is because it will significantly shift your values, and the consequences of that in the first instance - in the stage between when this information first emerges and applications are deployed - will generate massive social stress in your life. Basically, if you are married, and if you take this initial path, but if your partner does not - then you are definitely getting divorced. Be warned.

Once you see this new world, therefore, you are faced with an interesting choice. What to do about the old world? How to relate to that old one, and all the psychologically blinkered people who populate it? Suddenly you will see the disease everywhere, and that people are slaves to an entire barrage of powerful impulses and destructive behaviours that are actually not only able to be better managed, but also entirely removed, assuming they can first be seen. But if only this particular level of self-examination wasn't so fully and powerfully banned in general cultural dialogue.

2.

Know Your Own Limits

The event being indicated is an absolute fortress of concealment - both individually and collectively. I suppose this is the main thing to see here. And this is only one of the many very unusual aspects that need to be clarified right here at the beginning, in order to make all of this dialogue safe and effective.

It is just too big. It is a completely hidden problem, one of absolutely massive scale, and in particular one that is hidden because mere awareness of it is so psychologically toxic to anyone who has not been gradually inoculated by careful exposure over time. So it is a very big opportunity, but it is not one that is open to the typical person. You really do need to be extremely robust psychologically and emotionally, as well as capable of grappling with this level of complexity and a very confident manner without struggling. And for most people developing these particular muscles will take both time, and effort.

As I indicated above - but it bears repeating - the collective event being proposed is not even what most people imagine at first, having been so completely attuned to all such events being only some inane possibility for tribal membership. As if deep level change was some kind of club that they can simply belong to, rather than the single most dangerous and demanding game there is.

It requires a very particular type of person to venture into the deeper parts of this territory without any kind of significant negative response. By which I do not mean smart. In fact this affliction hits intelligent people even harder than most - "the bigger they are, the harder they fall.." etc.

It is, most fundamentally, about primal honesty, and a preparedness to get your philosophical feet in the mud, so to speak. It is also an extremely profound insight, with very penetrating and far ranging implications, so a degree of humility is also a basic requirement.

Really, people will generally think they know lots of stuff, and build an entire identity upon that foundation - only to then quite suddenly come to realise that this is literally the single most important thing to know, that it is vast, and sweeping, but that they also know nothing whatsoever about it. It is a complete shock, especially for those who have become very comfortable in their own particular philosophical armchair. It pretty much changes everything, so if you have a massive investment in the status quo, then this will be like a very powerful and very disturbing boot up the arse - and the likelihood that you will be capable of even examining it closely is probably somewhere close to nil.

This is why the whole thing must always be passive in any social sense, it is because we need to let all those who do not have what it takes flee from it in peace. People should never need to hide away from such insight, or go out of their way to avoid it. And to achieve this we need only ensure - at every point - that such information will only be made available if you go out of your way to demonstrate interest in such, in particular by crossing a very clearly marked threshold.

The whole concept of there being various depths here is itself defined by the final threshold that needs to be surpassed, and all the other thresholds required along the way. So whilst in some sense we see a breaking down of the entire thing into a series of progressively easier steps as we approach the initial entry point, we do also see that every one of these stages represents its own unavoidable demands, and its own particular version of this minimum threshold.

Like any stairway, the whole point is to make the overall climb accessible in a sense, but each step does still represent a certain height that needs to be achieved if you are not going to trip and fall flat on your face halfway up. So whilst we can break the whole thing down in this way, that does not in any way diminish the final height this stairway will need to climb, and nor does it imply that each particular step won't have its own critical level, including certain unavoidable demands.

There is no room for a 'nice try' or a 'good effort' as we reach the top level here, and at every lower level the same is also true, albeit at a lower height. In this emerging arena, as with any event that relates to actual reality, actual performance matters. There are very real and definitive ladders at every stage - ladders that actually need to be climbed, and thresholds associated that cannot ever be lowered just in order to accommodate anyone's particular weakness or conditioned sensitivities.

I suppose this 'critical threshold at each level' is what I have been preparing you to more fully grasp here, in order to make that emerging context both safer and more effective. After all there is no point in doing something new here that merely ends up being just one more example of what we already see, right? As some hairy old guy once said - "insanity is doing the same thing over and over again, but expecting different results". So there is no point in allowing the same old thing to dominate it, or even to gradually creep in. That would be totally pointless.

This will be the point of each deeper level of this journey: The same thing in higher resolution; to scope out the same anatomy in ever higher detail, as well as to much more clearly define the essential conditions associated with rolling the entire event forward.

So you may not be one of these few who will go all the way here, and you don't need to be. But you do, nevertheless, still need to know the sort of game you are playing, and what your own small part in that game is.

The whole point now is that the entire event has been broken down into tiny pieces, small enough for anyone to bite off and chew, but that breaking down process does not diminish the power and significance of such casual engagement - it actually amplifies such. If the event was dynamite, then this new 'shallow end' approach would make this easy end the fuse. It is inconsequential in itself, but where it ultimately leads is another thing entirely.

Therefore, as we see these various steps and stages emerging here, we also see various levels of demand. This issue of 'who' is actually one of the primary foundational pillars of what we are seeking to establish here, and reflects a singular deeper principle that is of critical importance.

The key thing is to understand the essential difference between this emerging culture and all the rest we see at the moment, and then to see what it means to cross that threshold. And here we see our

second important cultural precept coming into view: **If you are not going to actually play, at whatever level you have chosen to engage with it, then stay off the field!**

Never crossing that threshold unless you are going to do so in a way that meets the minimum criteria associated - i.e. engagement that is compatible with meaningful movement and progress toward the alternative end state implied - that is the second pillar here. That's what playing this game means. And so, if you are not going to swim in that regard - or even try - then you should definitely stay out of the pool.

So our first cultural precept was formulated around stopping the new stuff from going out from this new context, so as to never impose such information on anyone who has not first consented to such in a very informed manner. And the second pillar here - the second leg for our stool - basically means preventing the old stuff from coming in. Common culture cannot be allowed inside that threshold, for the same reasons, except in reverse - because the two cultural events basically cancel each other out.

Together these two pillars keep it all isolated from the surrounding event. Essentially, the two precepts just outlined are just the two sides of a wall here, and maintaining the functional separation implied is absolutely vital for people on both sides to exist in harmony with each other, whilst still both fulfilling their own important functions.

In practice, however, we also see that this second pillar becomes a kind of spectrum now, rather than a fixed threshold. And what this means is that many levels of engagement become possible as we break it all down so as to generate this shallow end, which in turn means that you can decide for yourself what level you are comfortable with.

This option to 'turn the volume down' so to speak, means that the injunction to '**stay out of the pool if you can't swim**' now becomes '**never go out of your comfortable depth**'. You can decide for yourself what level you feel comfortable with, so that you never end up inadvertently blowing your eardrums out.

But the main thing is to see that all these antics in the shallows only exist in order to serve the deep, and also that they are not the same thing. The cultural divergence (along with the demands associated) gets more significant the deeper you go, which is why we will need to repeat all of this at every new and deeper level. We always need to explain the various demands associated, at each stage, so as to first of all filter out all those who aren't ready, but most importantly to progressively prepare those who are.

Levels, Stages, Waves.

Even the various stages need to be separated in this sense - both externally in terms of the way we structure the event in the world, as well as internally in relation to how we engage with it at every stage. Which is why the forum itself will inevitably be broken up into various layers or levels.

So we not only need to keep all of that separate from the world at large, but also keep each of these different stages isolated from each other. And it will be up to you to navigate all of that as you see fit, based solely on how well you manage at each deeper level, and what particular stages you are working at.

On the personal journey of exploration implied here there are a few quite different stages, I suppose this is what I am pointing out. And the important thing to see is that for every outward stage the event begins to move through, there is an accompanying deeper level of personal demand associated. It is inevitable. And they should also never be confused -

- First there is the stage where you are just examining the entire thing, and trying to capture the full anatomy of the claim, in order to check it against reality, and against what you know of yourself directly. As indicated above - there is a certain minimum capture associated with merely seeing the whole thing, a sort of critical mass wherein the essential blindness implied is very suddenly dispelled, and the whole thing comes into view. And we might call this - **'capture'**.

The thing to know about 'capture' is that until this point is reached you won't see some of it - you will essentially see none of it. It is like a bubble of self-enclosing delusion in this sense - it has either popped, or it hasn't. So reaching this point will always be the first order of business for anyone in the beginning.

- Then there is the very important stage of rigorously challenging every aspect of the essential claim, and most importantly the overall singular integrity of the paradigm itself, which defines it as being basically 'true or not', and with very little possibility in between. We might call this stage - **'doubt'**.

The entire weight of human progress rests upon the rigours of shared rational dialogue and scientific methodology etc, which can itself seem rather hostile to those not accustomed to such, but intellectual combat is the very engine of positive change and development.

For the uninitiated, an 'argument' generally refers to some kind of conflict, but in rational dialogue to provide a solid 'argument' is the very breath of life, and the essence of intellectual discourse. And healthy and open intellectual discourse is the bedrock of positive change over time.

The whole game is that only the strongest of ideas get to survive into the next round in such an arena, with all others being vanquished into oblivion, to join the likes of - "the world is flat", and "best president ever". There are rules, however, and principles that are especially formulated to transcend personal vested interests. And these rules are intended to make that arena a fair one, a flat playing field, without bias or prejudice. Logic and evidence should always win out at the end of the day, regardless of how many apple carts get tipped over by any particular new insight or paradigm shift.

- And then, assuming all of that works out okay, there must be a stage where you have essentially exhausted all personal doubt, and are thus no longer actively challenging it - not short of new information or explanation becoming available. Which, given its ethical and practical implications, can only mean the beginnings of a stage where you are now openly exploring it, and - more importantly - beginning to travel down the path it indicates. We might call this stage **'conversion'**.

I use this term very intentionally here, and not only so as to be provocative, but because it is exactly appropriate in this context. There is a very deep shift in both perspective and values implied by the time you have reached this particular stage of such exploration, and we really shouldn't beat around the bush in this regard.

It cannot be partly true, not in essence. It is logically, practically, and empirically integrated - and if it is true, then almost all current approaches to human wellbeing are necessarily false. This is logically and

practically unavoidable. So eventually a choice will be confronted, and a decision will need to be taken.

It is basically either true or not, and in each case we see a completely different map, and completely different compass. You therefore cannot accept it as being true, and yet still live as if it is not. Cognitive dissonance aside - that simply wouldn't make any sense.

So in this case believing it and living it cannot be separated in any meaningful sense. It is basically a totally different view of what happiness is, and where it is to be found.

So at first we **(a)** take the time to bite off more than the bare minimum required, and this can most effectively be done together. Then we **(b)** chew it in a process of rational deconstruction and rigorous logical and empirical challenge - which can once again best be done together, once you grasp how that sort of rational dialogue works. And finally we **(c)** begin to actually do something about it all. We either swallow it, or spit it out. All of it. And yet again we see that this final stage is almost completely worthless if it does not result in some kind of collective force. Birds of a feather might easily get all the worms in this instance, etc.

The key thing is that the willingness to delve into it is just the first small domino in an increasingly massive cascade that is then set in motion. But it is also more heavily protected than you might at first imagine, for this very reason.

You might think of these waves or stages in the same way we view any kind of relationship, such as with how we form our primary connections etc. We go from courtship, to cohabitation, to marriage. From merely looking, to trying it out, to full co-creation, etc.

Likewise at a far more trivial level of life - We see the car, then we test-drive the car, then we buy the car. And in some sense each of these stages needs to be clearly separated in order to prevent them from cancelling each other out, in that their functions are quite different. But each of these stages is also vital to the overall game.

Like building a house - there are the foundations, then the floor and walls, then the roof. And if you get the foundations wrong, then the walls will falter, which will in turn make trying to add the roof sort of pointless.

More importantly, each of these represents what might be considered a deeper level of penetration into a very profound insight, so they should each be very clearly signposted at every point. Both internally, as well as externally, we always need to know which stage we are working at.

Basically, you cannot even begin to challenge the whole thing until you have at least captured the basic claim in essence, and doing that requires a certain critical mass in terms of information.

Likewise with reaching any sort of summary decision regarding the veracity or efficacy of the entire thing relative to all the alternative views - that cannot be achieved without first of all very deeply challenging every significant aspect of the central claims being made.

Every stage requires a certain level of commitment, and implies a particular threshold that needs to be achieved before you can move on to the next level. And if you are not going to commit to reaching that level at any particular stage then you are simply not qualified to be a builder in this context.

Therefore, in terms of how we structure any kind of communal space, these various stages and layers will somehow need to be reflected. You might even choose to be engaged with several levels at the same time, but they should never be confused or conflated. And it should always be very clearly understood that all of this only relates to the way anyone might progressively penetrate the body of understanding that is emerging here, and the demands associated at every level. The actual event itself, as it emerges in practical terms in the world at large, will in many ways be entirely backwards in relation to who will be able to access it.

Upward vs Downward

What do I mean here? The current process we are discussing, where the whole paradigm will be examined and explored, within a framework of seeking to extract various directly practical applications, will start off open to anyone, but then progressively make its way into deeper and deeper territory, ultimately leaving most people behind along the way.

But then, once that depth has been reached by these few, assuming we have all supported and informed them sufficiently, we will see the first fledgeling applications emerging, and the whole 'who qualifies' part will begin to open up again. At first those processes will only be available to a rare few - the proverbial 'crash-test-not-so-dummies' so to speak - but over time eventually become more and more accessible, until eventually they become completely commonplace.

It is as if we see a kind of hill here, a relatively small upward climb, and that on the other side of that little crest we see an absolutely massive downhill slope. That initial climb is what has prevented anyone from discovering this downhill part, or even seeing that it is there in the first place. We didn't even know which direction to climb, which is sort of the point of having this new paradigm as a compass.

Upwards, as we are defining such here, is explicitly referring to personal development and individual capacity at very many levels at once - a combined symphony of cognitive development, emotional development, moral development, social development, practical development, etc - and in this case a very particular combination of such characteristics. And so the transition into the deep we have been referring to above, and also warning you about, is basically the same thing as making this brief climb up to the top of this hill. That will require only a few, which is what makes the entire prospect powerful. If it demanded that everyone climb that bit then we really would be fucked, because most people would have no chance at all.

For those who qualify for such it will be easy, like a sunday stroll in the park, but apparently for most people that same process of examination would scare the living bejeezus out of them, as well as pretty much being well beyond their cognitive abilities.

Give vs Receive

At a moral level these two stages are also quite different, in that the entire journey up until the emergence of the first practical application is essentially an opportunity to 'assist' only. It is not a retail event, where you might line up to 'get' something. It is a wholesale event, where you might only line up to 'give' something. So if what you want here is to 'receive' something from all of this, then that defines you as being a sheep, not a sheepdog. In that case this first uphill section will be very confusing to you.

All the possible levels of engagement you see being discussed here, including the entire website etc, are all related only to this brief initial climb, and none of that will be public. None of that is an event in the world. That climb will be made by just a few, and almost entirely in private. That is an elite sport so to speak, where there will likely not even be spectators present, not at the end stages, as things become more and more refined and developed. And so the unfolding of that event will be a kind of progressive narrowing in a sense, as indicated repeatedly above. A filtering down is implied, a process of refinement of both the message and the listening over time, that's what we are talking about - until we are ultimately left with just the most detailed and concise capture of the entire structure being delivered to the most highly capable and adept audience possible.

And then what? The end?

No. That is the beginning. Beyond that point, in the world, we will see the beginnings of the great downhill event. At that point the whole thing will invert in relation to who might be able to realistically access it. So that instead of beginning with pretty much anyone and ending up with some highly tuned elite, the whole thing will then begin in a form that is at first available to only a few very capable individuals, but will very rapidly begin to break down to a level where pretty much anyone will be able to accessibly and reliably access what it offers. And not in theoretical terms mind you - this time in direct practical terms.

By the time we are talking about the resulting event itself, we are looking at something entirely different. At that point we are talking about an external process in the real world at large, where the entire thing begins to roll forward in purely practical terms down a path that nobody even knew was there, through territory nobody even knew existed. That part will be openly public by definition, and effortlessly viral in nature, like a sort of 'existential Macarena'. Before too long everyone will be doing it.

At that stage we see a far wider process, and one that will increasingly require very little in the way of prior knowledge or ability. That event will start off like the internet in 1993, where only the best coders had access to such - but eventually end up like the internet in 2023, where we now struggle to keep 2 year olds off it.

That downhill part is the real deal. That is the big news. That is the entire point of all the rest. The brief climb up to that threshold is only worth the trouble because of where it all leads in this sense. That small and increasingly narrow event at the beginning is simply the price we need to pay in order to reach the much larger and increasingly open event that follows.

So once again, it is like aeroplanes - there are those who build and fly them, and then there are those who travel on them. These two groups should never be confused. You should never take that fat drunk guy who is making a ruckus back in economy and put him in the pilot's seat!

For now we are only building, and passengers will come later. So it is all about very clearly understanding what it is, and what it is definitely not. Which in turn tells us who it is for, and who it is definitely not for in the first instance. And all of that together begins to tell us how we might move forward here, and what comes next.

It is all about the anatomy - the hidden and previously absent combination to the lock. And it is also about how, where, and why that has been so concealed. It is immediately like stepping on an escalator - the ground starts to move under your feet right from the first moment, and in ways you never expect. You soon get used to it, but in the beginning it can be extremely disconcerting.

So we see two very disturbing realities here at the same time -

- Firstly we see an internal process of deepening awareness that - at your end - will immediately begin to make people seem shallow and inane, and that - at their end - will make you seem offensive and very threatening.
- And we also see various levels and layers of dialogue that reflect each one of these different stages or waves in your own unfolding penetration of the whole thing.

This initial process of deepening exploration is, therefore, something that many will find rather challenging. It will be disturbing for most people if only because it requires skills and knowledge nobody has ever prepared themselves for. So a process of gradual self-elimination is implied along the way.

So you need to ask yourself - are you actually ready for that? Really? Have you had enough of the world we see today, and are you prepared to put your money where your mouth is? Or is all of that still acceptable to you in some sense?

If it is, then you are definitely holding the wrong book here, and you should probably put it down immediately. Because in that case you are going to absolutely hate this, and also have very little to offer it.

In the end this is an entirely different culture pursuing an entirely different body of awareness in order to travel an entirely different path toward an entirely different destination. And every one of those things stands in direct and ever increasing opposition to what we see now.

Well, the destination is ostensibly the same as what typical culture aspires to - peace and happiness etc - except that this emerging path will actually take you there. So that is completely different to what we currently see. Typical culture only aspires to those things, and very rarely takes anyone there, and the very few who come close do so only at enormous cost to all the rest, and to the planet as a whole.

All of which can, once again, be seen as extremely threatening to anyone who has spent an entire lifetime developing and acquiring all the assets and abilities they thought they needed - only to find out that most of that is completely worthless in light of this massive shift in approach.

For most people this first 'very divergent' stage here won't really matter much, in that for most people there is really no need to be involved in such, or even be aware that it is occurring. Most people should simply stay away from it, as they will always be free to do.

But the far larger downstream event beyond that initial climb is another matter entirely, if only due to what it means in relation to the foundations of modern civilization, and how deeply invested people tend to be in the status quo. That part will not be avoided by anyone, if only because of how forcefully their own hidden pain will drive them toward such. It will not be others who push it on them - it will be their own internal wounds that press them whole bodily in the direction of the single most profoundly healing possibility the world has ever known.

Safe in Isolation

A developing theme here is the profound and ever increasing divergence between the sort of cultural event we are proposing and the world we see today. And this might lead you to imagine that they are

in some sense conflicting events, but this is not true at all. The only important thing is to provide a crucial missing piece here, and also to do that in a way that causes the least disruption possible, whilst still attaining the minimum capture necessary. In the end there would be no point being so polite that you end up achieving nothing. This is not politics after all.

The essential thing to understand is the relationship between these two cultural events, and that they are not in any way antagonistic toward each other, as it might seem. But also that this is only true if they can be kept strictly separate. This critical dividing line is what I have been seeking to clarify.

Out in my shed I have a small bottle of nitric acid. I also have a big plastic bottle of propylene glycol. And they are each totally fine, perfectly safe, and both extremely useful if used in the appropriate manner. But mix them together and all of that changes very quickly. Nitroglycerin... BOOM!

This emerging context has no issue whatsoever with the incumbent cultural form. Really, for all of that to be disturbed in any way prior to the stable release of the first practical application indicated is the very last thing we want to see here.

The only thing wrong with the world we see today is that this particular insight is not only completely missing, but also actively prevented at every turn. This fact does not need to be consciously intentional in order to be completely true. And if it is actually true, then it does indeed make common culture (along with everyone associated) directly complicit in the greatest single act of self-sabotage ever. It is a truly damning indictment that captures the entirety of human history and civilisation and defines all of that as being essentially futile and circular in a very real and fundamental sense.

And yet, all of that is only true for as long as this underlying pattern continues to achieve its concealed and concealing purpose. More importantly, that function happens to be remarkably easy to defeat once you know what it is. It was only the blindness that gave it power, and in particular the way it has prevented anyone from getting hold of this essential missing bit.

So in this sense the world we see today is a bit like a sailing ship of old, full of sailors who have all developed scurvy. It is not their own fault, and they certainly can't be blamed, and yet the affliction remains a very obvious fact of their sorry existence. But then came Captain Cook, and the discovery of vitamin C, and everything very suddenly changed. The very same sailors suddenly became strong, healthy, and even kept all their teeth! Just a couple of apples, or a bit of sauerkraut, and suddenly everything was as good as new.

This situation is a bit like that. The important insight associated is not an attack on the status quo, any more than handing a sailor a slice of pineapple might be considered an attack. But it is a small change that does indeed stand to disturb the status quo very significantly over time. This change will not be imposed in any sense, however. It is not a revolution, at least not in any forcible sense. It is merely a better outcome, based solely on something being noticed about the current situation that is dramatically wrong, and in particular something that may quite easily be remedied.

Therefore, yes, the current situation is indeed defined as dramatically erroneous in some sense by the emergence of this new insight. This is unavoidable given what that revelation implies, and how deeply impactful it is. But once this small missing piece is added back in, anywhere, and in any sustainable form, then everything we see is immediately redeemed, right from that moment. Because at that point what we see now will go from being a remedy that had previously been preventing the cure, to being a remedy that has now failed completely in that regard, and that has thus been transformed into something that is enabling the cure instead, by giving it time to work.

To be clear, then, the very last thing this newly emerging cultural event wants to do is disturb or disrupt the incumbent culture in any way. The entire idea here is to do good, not harm. And in this case you don't actually need to break any eggs to make that omelette.

We can simply let sleeping dogs lie, etc. That's perfect. The blind and crippled masses don't even need to be informed about all of this, let alone involved in any way. But the two events do always need to be kept separate from each other in order for this complementary principle to remain effective, and to avoid them becoming immediately conflicting and antagonistic in an explosive way.

In this regard, and as we finish up here, it is worth looking back for a moment to try to capture at least some sense of what the essential issue might have been throughout all of recorded human history, and why we are still in this particular bind.

If you trace it right back, following all the various dominos we have now set up here in relation to the event as it rolls forward, we come right back to that first domino and what has always prevented it from being tipped. That first domino was simply the core anatomy, the missing kernel of information required in order to fathom what is really going on inside the black box of human subjective experience. But here's the thing - even when you have that, or see that, it suddenly becomes clear why even that aspect had remained so far beyond our reach. It is the same thing that now prevents such information from being conveyed or explored in any normal and open sense that prevented it from being discovered in the first place - just the fact that people are very persistently unwilling to even talk about this subject.

The paradigm itself predicts this of course, but that does not change the basic fact, as well as the obvious demand associated. We need to have the courage to talk about it, and any failure to do that will perpetuate our suffering, forever.

Previously, there has never been a cultural space where this might not only be possible, but openly supported. But now there is. Indeed, there is not only one such space, but as many as you wish. It is now within the power of anyone to use any of the cultural primers to generate such a context, or even to develop such a primer for themselves.

The point is - this is not mine. It is simply true, or not. The situation being described is either the way things are, or it isn't. There is no middle ground in this sense. And if it is true then the potential indicated exists regardless of whether you believe it, or choose to do anything about it.

It has always been there, waiting for someone - anyone - to figure it out. But that missing information was just the spark, it is the resulting conversation that is the fire. The real heat is the cultural development that will occur as a result of collective power finally making its way into this most hidden of all territories, where before there was only a single individual stumbling around pointlessly.

I'm just saying - don't wait for me. This is not going to be occurring somewhere, it will be happening everywhere. This is what it means for that conversation to begin at this stage, and for this initial sketch to be taking root in the collective at last. It means that it can finally make its way into the hands of people capable of doing it justice at a level far beyond anything I will ever be able to manage.

That collective heat will always need to be contained, however, and hopefully this has been the one message you take away from this brief outline - the power and necessity of providing a very clear threshold across which people might step, knowing full well the implications of doing so. That is the fire box required for this emerging fire, without which that fire will only cause chaos and hostility, but

within which it will all be quite safe. So that was the answer, and it also happens to rest clearly within the grasp of anyone to do this. Actually, doing that is pretty easy now.

So don't look back to see what it was - because what it was is nothing at all. Look forward to what it must become - because that will be everything. And it will not be me who does that, it will be you.

That's why many people won't like this emerging view. It really is very unfair that an insight of this depth and nature might have been so completely overlooked, and especially that it might now be emerging in such a sudden and forceful way. Nothing in common culture has prepared us for such an eventuality, or even indicated the possibility of such. So it is completely out of left field, and we have every right to feel let down by the world as a result, if all of this works out to be correct. It is a very deep critique of the status quo, and all those so conceitedly claiming to be doing 'the right thing'.

It all comes as a bit of a shock. This is the moment where this all opens up quite suddenly, and where all of the freight it is carrying begins to be carefully unloaded. It is all about the generation of that cultural threshold, or at the very least about stepping across a boundary that someone else has established.

What it means is that you now have the power to take back your life, and to bring an entirely new world into being, in your own lifetime.

The only question is - will you?

I guess this is a choice we all need to make sooner or later. And if you don't actually do that, then you will never again be able to look at someone else and point a finger, blaming them for your own unhappiness, or lack of purpose in life.

In video games there is the concept of an NPC - meaning a Non Player Character. This is any character in the game that is merely part of the background context, and not actually being controlled by a player. And this has come to be used as a metaphor for how many people choose to live.

This is the big game, and you are a player, like it or not. And there is a job to do. You didn't know, but now you do. It is happening now. So it's time to wake up, and get on with the task at hand.

Just remember - to be very serious and to be very loud are not the same thing. We always need to leave all those who would rather stay asleep to enjoy their blissful ignorance. They will wake up later, when the big wave eventually arrives. Until then the whole thing needs to be as quiet as a mouse.

Epilogue - **The End of Spirituality**

The metaphor we have been employing here of the computer virus etc obviously does not propose to answer any of the more ultimate and mysterious questions we see people asking at every turn. Why? Simply because it doesn't need to. And this might seem like a distracting detour I suppose, but I will take a moment to address such matters, if only because they are actually relevant in several ways.

This might help to frame the personal and cultural impact of what we are discussing, before we get into the true magnitude of the proposition in the next section.

The situation is this: the conflicted and sorry state we see today, in the typical person, is akin to the internally afflicted computer system we outlined above. It is a complicated and dynamically corrupted situation that is made even more complicated by the fact that people do not even realise this has happened to them. And doubly confusing again given that culture also does not contain this information. It is something we hide from ourselves, and which we also agree to hide from each other. But this concealment does nothing to actually solve the issue, it only pushes it under the rug, so to speak, and in many ways this actually makes it worse, not least because of how it makes what could have been merely temporary into a permanent affliction.

The result, then, is a kind of deeply felt internal void - a bone deep yearning, a hunger for something else, or at the very least a profound sense that 'something just isn't right', even if nobody can quite put their finger on what that is. There is the sense of a problem that needs to be solved, or a continual restlessness that never abates. And out of this primary sense of internal deficit comes all the questions and seeking and vigilant yearning for more, even when all our material needs are fully met - hence the great 'spiritual quest' etc. We search for something to fill this aching void, and to sate this hunger within. Thus all the great questions about the 'meaning of life' and the 'ultimate spiritual destiny' of mankind.

But what if all of that is merely part of the problem, rather than part of the cure? And what would this mean in relation to the removal of that problem?

The bedrock here is what this whole paradigm implies about the human situation in general - which is that there is not just one human state available to every person, but that actually there are two. There exists another entire potential for human experience, a possibility so profoundly different to the one we all assume is normal that it fairly represents another whole state of existence.

It all begs the question, if this event really does exist within us, why haven't we seen this other state before? Surely we should have seen evidence of such a potential, at least occasionally. But I think we have, which once again drops us back into a discussion of spirituality etc.

I am aware that this subject matter is a little sensitive in several different ways - in that for some people it will seem almost bizarre or even deluded, whilst for others it might seem sacrosanct or disrespectful, but once again I suppose I will simply have to offend everyone equally here. Because what am I saying? I am saying that the human potential that has historically been called 'spiritual enlightenment' is entirely real. Indeed, it may turn out to be far more significant than previously realised, although not for the reasons most people might assume. But I am also saying that this potential is not even remotely 'spiritual' in nature.

The event in question (the removal of the virus in our metaphor) has been seen before. History records it many times as having occurred in various individuals, but because nobody has ever truly understood the underlying anatomy of that event it has always been dramatically misrepresented. This failure to truly understand it has also meant that this shift has consistently failed to be repeated in subsequent individuals, no matter how hard people tried.

The problem is this: What things 'feel like' and what they 'actually are' is often very far apart. In the absence of actual understanding, then, and based only on what such a transition might 'feel like' from a purely subjective point of view, what might people end up concluding about it? They would certainly conclude something, right? But what does a computer with no virus have that a computer with a virus does not have? Nothing. So without a deep and comprehensive explanation of the virus itself, how would you possibly explain such a 'miraculous' shift in state? You couldn't. And you also couldn't ever hope to remove the virus from anyone else without such insight.

So yes: Spiritual Enlightenment. Yeah right. Surely that is some deluded fantasy being pedalled by little guys in orange robes just so that they can get other people to feed them? This honestly sounds like the most plausible explanation.

Once you see what is really going on, however, you can also see how people might have gotten the wrong idea about it - especially those who experienced it directly. Strangely, those who experience it directly often know the least of all about it, which is no doubt why they universally fail to pass that experience on to others in any sort of accessible or reliable way. After all, the one thing they would really need to know in order to 'transmit' this realisation to others (the virus itself) is now completely absent from them, so they can't even study it.

Anyway, this will be my promise to you here, if ever you choose to take the journey upstream with us at the next deeper stage: By the end of that more comprehensive outline you will know exactly what spiritual enlightenment actually is. And, as I say, we can start right here with the very first thing to know about that - it is not really 'spiritual' at all.

Basically, if what I am saying here is broadly correct, then the presumed ultimate or highest state of 'spiritual attainment' is not an attainment at all, and certainly not spiritual. It is totally simple. It's just that we had overlooked the true context of our situation - which is that we are actually suffering from a sort of universal affliction, one that can - in certain rare circumstances - be entirely released. And we have not grasped that aspect not only because it is so concealed, but also because that part really is very complex and quite profound.

But let's be clear - if what we are suffering from is what I am outlining above, and if the removal of that event is what has historically been called 'spiritual enlightenment', then it is not only not spiritual, it does not answer any questions at that level at all - if only because those questions are themselves part of the disease that is cured in that transition.

'Spirituality' is all just part of the same disease. And this is what we mean about spiritual enlightenment not actually being spiritual. When that disease is finally cured, all of that yearning simply falls away. I mean, do you think a sparrow is sitting there wondering about the purpose of life? To what end? It is already there. Just doing it..

So the release is not actually the interesting part. The delusional confusion that preceded it was the truly amazing achievement, with all of its dynamic complexity and confused bewilderment. And to lose all of that, what does that mean? All that means is that you have returned to the normal and natural state - your own biological expectation. Nirvana. The garden prior to the fall, etc.

Which is what, in this instance? Just the normal background state of the universe, as it already exists, right now. Un-enlightenment was the achievement, that's what it all means, and that all we need to do is stop 'achieving' that twisted pattern.

It all means that the so-called highest possible attainment is actually just the background state of all things, minus the stimulated and effort based delusion that something else is going on. And I'm not sure if this makes sense to you, but this basic conception changes everything, because what it means is that happiness is fundamental to existence.

And I mean, you didn't know this, right? That's not what you basically experience? But this is simply because we have - quite uniquely - managed to make a completely unnecessary knot out of the straight and simple rope of existence. And we also can't seem to stop doing this.

There is a way, as we will see. The very local mess we have made can be cleaned up, and fixed up, assuming that we can all work together toward that goal. It will only take a few to open that doorway up for all the rest.

At a macro level, however, what this really means is that we are actually quite safe here, and that we cannot lose the game, not in the end. In this context the type of suffering we experience takes effort to maintain, and sooner or later we will always run out of steam. So happiness is hunting you, that's what it means, and eventually it will win.

This is all unduly profound I know, but if the basic strokes of all this are broadly correct, then this is what you will discover when you die. It will be like slipping off a very tight and very uncomfortable shoe. It will not be your 'self' that realises this, however, for that will be part of what falls away. But the point is that you don't actually need to wait until the ride is over before you finally tip this bucket of turds out the window - the 'self' included. It can be done now, along with all of its tortured manifestations. And this is why every description of final spiritual 'attainment' is posed as a death, followed by a resurrection.

This explains how the 'realisation' of spiritual enlightenment can be so permanent. It is because it is not actually an attainment. It is a relinquishment. It is also not a letting go of everything, but of one very particular thing, in one very particular sense, and in the wake of that the simple liberation of our true nature.

This is how a deep understanding of our own delusional tendencies can change the way we see existence as a whole. Our entire view of existence has been deeply coloured by our own internal experience, but it turns out that this experience is not universal at all - it is unique to us as a species. It is only our own little storm in a teacup - very real to us, but not ultimately significant.

It also means that the average cabbage is already there, already 'fully enlightened' and residing in the 'eternal bliss of creation'. Which is probably why they always just sit there, quite happily... fucking bastards!

The point is, the solution will not be the focus here, if only because we are not at the point of delivering that at this stage. The topic here will be the nature and anatomy of the problem itself. Paradoxically, however, once you see that - and I mean really see it - the nature of the final and only possible permanent solution becomes completely obvious. You don't even need to be told.

If we go back to the computer analogy, the subject here will be the virus. And yes we will of course need to know a lot about how the computer works in order to truly fathom how the virus interacts with it, and how it screws it up, etc. But what is the computer ultimately, in this metaphor? Where did it come from? Why are we here? What is all of this about? The meaning of life?

Don't know. Don't care. Because you don't need to know. This is the final truth. Those are far bigger questions, and if you are still asking them by the time you have had this achingly tortuous virus removed, then I will eat my shorts. You simply won't care anymore. Like the sparrow, and the cabbage, and everything else in the universe: Questions like that only ever arise out of a deep and abiding sense of unhappiness. And there simply won't be one.

So, many questions will not be answered here, if only because they will no longer need to be asked. And the state that results from this transition is no more 'spiritual' than the computer that has been restored to its correct working state. Indeed, if the entire 'spiritual quest' is merely part of the problem, rather than any kind of solution, then we can actually keep the original term. But we might also redefine the language here so as to reflect the actual situation.

The solution - as applied in a transformative practice, rather than as any kind of consoling belief system - is to remove the underlying systemic conflict out of which the entire spiritual quest arises. Thus, to lift the (ultimately deluded) spiritual aspect of life from someone - by removing the artificial pit of existential hunger from the core of their being - would be: 'spiritual en-lighten-ment'. Not 'enlight-en' - as in 'illuminate'. En-lighten - as in 'lift a weight off', or 'make lighter', etc. And in particular, the weight that is lifted is 'spirituality' itself. Because if what we will see on the journey that follows is basically correct, then any person who makes this transition from one state to the other has not become more in the process - they have actually become less. They have not gained anything - they have lost something. And they have not fulfilled the spiritual path - they have had the spiritual path entirely lifted from them.

Does it all sound like sacrilege? Can you feel yourself pulling back from such a concept already? I mean, even just the idea that there might be something wrong with you is not easy to confront, right? And here we see the cost of this view. It is quite simple in one sense, but it is also only for those who can make this elementary leap. It's like the deep end of the swimming pool in this sense: it is great fun, but only for people who can swim. For all the rest it is immediately and very obviously intolerable, right from the very start.

Anyway, in the future this is what we will look back and see: few of those people who are presently selling 'spiritual enlightenment' actually embody that potential themselves, and even those who do have almost no significant understanding of what it actually is. And this fact will be made very plain in the wake of where all of this will inevitably end up. Because even a very modest group of people who together embody a core understanding of what is actually going on beneath the surface here will have no problem at all in reliably stimulating that transition on any normal person.

What does that mean? It means that if ever you wished to know what 'spiritual enlightenment' actually is, then you won't even need to be told, because you will simply be able to experience it directly. And not based on any kind of belief or devotional bullshit - but solely based on direct and penetrating understanding, as applied in one of many possible forms of social technology. You will not need to kiss any ring, or lay any lotus blossoms at anyone's feet. This emerging paradigm will deliver power directly into the hands of the end user, and will therefore be the final end to all gurus. And not before time, I hope you will agree. This potential is a very real thing, but not understanding it fully has allowed it to be preyed upon by all manner of parasites.

Which is to say - you will be guided by people who actually know what they are doing, and who can, therefore, actually deliver you to the stated destination. You will not need to follow anyone, or believe anything, or even understand the whole thing. That's sort of the whole point here. Like the computer virus analogy above, it will be something that a few very smart and brave people will develop and deploy for everyone else based on a profound degree of direct personal understanding - but for all those people who actually just want to use the resulting technology in practical terms, they won't need to understand anything. At that level it will simply do a job, and thereby provide an accessible solution to the problem associated, for the very first time in all of recorded human history.

2EQ.ORG